

Tragedy in Delhi Cantt: Thar hits motorcycle, couple killed

PIONEER NEWS SERVICE
■ New Delhi

Their daily ride home from work ended in tragedy on Wednesday when a couple working in the NDMC was killed after their motorcycle was allegedly hit from behind by a Thar in Delhi Cantonment, leaving behind a grieving family.

Anju, around 50, and her husband Sukhbir, around 45, were returning to their home in Sector 1, Dwarka, from their workplace in Lodhi Road when the accident occurred near the IOC red light around 5 pm on Wednesday, police said.

The couple, who had been working together at the New Delhi Municipal Council (NDMC) since 2002 and trav-

elled together daily, were on their way home when their motorcycle allegedly slipped on the road before the SUV came from behind and ran over them, police said.

A staff member of the Delhi Cantonment police station, who was returning from duty, noticed the accident and informed the police. The injured couple was rushed to a hospital, where they were declared dead, police added.

The incident has left the couple's families devastated, particularly Sukhbir's siblings, who said he had recently built a new home and was living happily with Anju, who had entered into her second marriage with him a few years ago.

"I received a call from my

family that an accident had happened. I called his phone multiple times, but it was answered by a police officer. He asked me who I am; I informed him, and he asked me to come to the police station immediately," Chotelal, Sukhbir's younger brother, said.

Chotelal said he went to the police station along with his nephew and was later taken to Deen Dayal Upadhyay Hospital, where they were asked to identify Sukhbir's body. "His jaw was completely broken, and he had injuries on his body. As far as we know, a Thar hit them. They were turning right when the car came speeding from the left," he said. "They have been



working since 2002 and used to travel together daily," Chotelal added.

Anju's son Rohit said the family was informed about the accident around 5 pm.

Police said the Thar driver was caught by locals and handed over to them. The driver was identified as Bhupendra, 26, a resident of Jhajjar in Haryana, they said.

Bhupendra, who runs a milk booth in Rohini, has been booked under sections 281 (rash driving) and 106(a) (causing death by negligence) of the Bharatiya Nyaya Sanhita, police said.

For Sukhbir's family, the accident has also brought back memories of a difficult childhood and the sacrifices made by his sisters to raise him and his siblings after their parents died early.

Ramesh Pal Singh, 65, Sukhbir's brother-in-law, said Sukhbir was particularly close to the family and had recently begun enjoying a married life. "He was like my child. They are five siblings — two brothers and three sisters. Their parents died early. His elder sister raised them,"

Singh told PTI. He said Sukhbir and Anju had met while working at NDMC and eventually fell in love.

"He and Anju had married a few years ago. They were working together in NDMC where they fell in love. Anju left her first husband and started living with Sukhbir," Singh said. "Sukhbir had also made a new home recently. They were very happy together, and it ended like this," he added. Recalling how Sukhbir's elder sisters had brought up the family after their parents' death, Singh said the tragedy had left them heartbroken.

"Think about the three sisters that raised him like a mother," he said.

Singh also appealed to the

government to provide compensation to the family and employment to Sukhbir's younger brother.

"We want the Government to compensate and give his younger brother his job in NDMC. He was working in NDMC since 2002 and recently got permanent," he said.

According to police, a preliminary inquiry has suggested that the motorcycle slipped on the road before they were run over.

Further investigation is

underway to establish the exact sequence of events and circumstances leading to the fatal accident, they said.

Police said the vehicle and other relevant evidence were being examined as part of the investigation.

Delhi CM launches ATS, flags off 50 e-buses

PIONEER NEWS SERVICE
■ New Delhi

Chief Minister Rekha Gupta inaugurated an Automated Testing Station (ATS) at the DTC's Tehkhand Depot and public electric vehicle (EV) charging stations at the Hasanpur and Ghazipur depots. She also flagged off 50 new zero-emission electric buses and launched an interstate e-bus service between Delhi and Rewari. During the programme, the Chief Minister also unveiled a coffee table book on the DTC. The chief minister said the Delhi Government's aim was not merely to discuss problems but to provide lasting solutions.

Addressing the gathering, the chief minister said this is the second Automated Testing Station at Tehkhand. The first ATS has already been started at Nand Nagri Depot. The four-lane automated testing centre at Tehkhand will make vehicle fitness testing more scientific, transparent and technol-

ogy-driven. It will have two lanes for heavy motor vehicles, one for light motor vehicles and one for two-wheelers. The centre will have an annual testing capacity of 72,000 vehicles, including 52,000 heavy and light motor vehicles and 20,000 two-wheelers. This is the second Automated Testing Station at Tehkhand. The first ATS has already been started at Nand Nagri Depot

During the programme, 50 new 12-metre zero-emission electric buses were flagged off after being added to the DTC fleet. The chief minister said the government's aim was not only to increase the number of buses but also to provide better and dignified facilities to passengers. Old and dilapidated bus shelters across Delhi would also be modernised so that, along with modern buses, bus stops too looked attractive and convenient in keeping with the changing face of the city.

Delhi Transport Minister Pankaj Kumar Singh, South



Delhi MP Ramvir Singh Bidhuri, senior officials, public representatives and other dignitaries were present on the occasion.

She said passenger safety was the Government's top priority. Keeping this in mind, the new electric buses have been equipped with CCTV cameras, panic buttons and several other safety features.

Commenting on the previous Government's tenure, the Chief Minister said that at that time, there was more

concern about work and discussion about that concern than actual work. The DTC remained in debt for a long time, employees faced difficulties, and the problems of drivers, conductors and officials remained unresolved.

The Chief Minister also referred to the free bus travel scheme for women. She said 18 lakh women had so far obtained Pink Cards. With their addition, Delhi's total bus fleet has increased to around 6,840 buses, comprising 5,088 electric buses and 1,752 CNG buses. Delhi now has the country's largest electric bus fleet. The Delhi Government aims to increase the city's bus fleet to around 14,000 buses by the financial year 2028-29.

The Delhi Government also launched a zero-emission interstate e-bus service between Delhi and Rewari to strengthen green and convenient interstate connectivity. The service will operate on the Dhaura Kuan-Gurugram-Manesar-Dharuhera-Rewari route.

Transport Minister Pankaj Kumar Singh said the Automated Testing Station at Tehkhand would enable fitness testing of around 72,000 vehicles annually. With the addition of 50 new electric buses, the DTC fleet would reach around 6,840 buses, including approximately 5,100 electric buses. The Delhi-Rewari interstate e-bus service and public EV charging stations at Hasanpur and Ghazipur had also been launched.

Woman stabbed to death by husband in hotel

PIONEER NEWS SERVICE
■ New Delhi

A 28-year-old woman was allegedly stabbed to death by her husband inside a hotel in north Delhi's Lahori Gate area following a quarrel over a family dispute, and later attempted to take his own life, police said on Thursday.

The accused, identified as Prakash, 29, a resident of Phalodi in Rajasthan, allegedly attacked his wife Shivani with a knife inside a room at Hotel Prince before attempting to die by suicide, they said.

The couple married around six months ago and lived together in Rajasthan for about a month after their marriage. Shivani came to Delhi and started working at a beauty parlour, while Prakash, who used to run a tea shop in Phalodi, remained in Rajasthan, according to the preliminary investigation.

Police said Prakash arrived in Delhi a day before the incident and booked a room at Hotel Prince in the Lahori Gate police station area. Shivani later joined him. An argument broke out between the couple inside the room over a family

dispute during the night, following which Prakash allegedly attacked Shivani with a knife, police said.

After allegedly stabbing his wife, Prakash attempted to die by suicide, they said.

The incident came to light on Thursday morning when hotel staff found both of them unconscious. The staff informed the police, follow-



ing which a team reached the hotel and shifted the couple to a nearby hospital. Doctors declared Shivani 'brought dead', while Prakash was admitted for treatment. His condition is stated to be stable, police said.

Deputy Commissioner of Police (North) Niharika Bhatt said the preliminary investigation indicated that the husband had stabbed the woman, but the exact motive was yet to be ascertained.

"Officials are trying to find out what led to the dispute and why the situation turned violent," the DCP said. Further investigation is underway.

PUBLIC NOTICE

Notice is hereby given to the general public that **M/S OKAS GANGA AGRITECH PRIVATE LIMITED**, a company having CIN U10617DL2024PTC434642 and registered office at B-37, A-wing, 1st floor, Lawrence Road, Industrial Area, Keshav Puram (North West Delhi), North West Delhi, Delhi, 110035 ("the **Company**"), is the absolute owner of the land comprised in Khasra Nos. 230, 231, 232, 234, 235, 243, 244, 245, 246, 247, 248, 250, 251, 258, 265min, and 266min, measuring total 90,458 sq. meters, situated at Village Luhari, Tehsil Dadri, District Gautam Buddh Nagar, Uttar Pradesh - 203207 ("**Said Land**").

It is further informed to the public at large that the Company intends to mortgage the Said Land in favour of Punjab National Bank & Punjab and Sindh Bank (collectively, "**Lenders**"), as part of the security for the credit facilities to be availed by the Company from the said Lenders. Any person claiming any right, title or interest in the Said Land or having any objection to the creation of the aforesaid mortgage may submit a representation in writing, together with supporting documents, to the Lenders, within 7 (seven) days from the date of publication of this notice at the following address:

Punjab National Bank, Large Corporate Branch, 8th floor, DCM Building, Barakhamba Road, New Delhi - 110001

Further, it came to the notice of the Company that the original link title documents (including certain Sale Deeds and Court Order) pertaining to certain parcels comprised in the Said Land as specified in **Schedule I** hereunder have been misplaced/lost and remain untraceable despite diligent search.

Notice is hereby given cautioning the public against entering into any transaction, sale, purchase, lease, mortgage, or creation of third-party rights in respect of the Said Land or any part thereof or the missing documents. Any person entering into such transactions shall do so at their own risk, and the same shall not be binding on the Company.

Any person who finds or is in possession of any of the said missing original documents is hereby requested to immediately contact the Company at the address or email ID mentioned below and return the same to the Company. Any information regarding the aforesaid missing original documents may be communicated to:

Sunil Kumar Goyal
(Director)
Okas Ganga Agritech Private Limited
Email: sunil.goyal@okasganga.com
Date: 2nd September, 2026

SCHDEDULE I (DETAILS OF MISSING DOCUMENTS)						
Missing Document	Khasra Number	Area	First Party (Seller)	Second Party (Buyer)	Date of Sale	Details of Sale Deed
Sale Deed	251	Area: 2 Bigha – 17 Biswa – 6 Biswansi.	Ramprasad s/o Yadu	Bijender Singh, Gajraj Singh, Jhabbar s/o Ranjit Singh Satyavir, Jaivir, Karamvir & Subhash s/o Baljit Singh	Not Available	Not Available
Sale Deed	244	Area: 2 Bigha – 12 Biswansi.	Mathan Singh s/o Karan Singh	Ranjit Singh & Baljit Singh s/o Totaram	Not Available	Not Available
Sale Deed	245	Area: 1 Bigha – 1 Biswa – 19 Biswansi.	Prakash s/o Nihal	Mahesh Singh s/o Gopi Singh	Not Available	Not Available
Sale Deed	248	Area: 0.7970 hectares.	Allahuddin s/o Bundu	Rupesh Kumar s/o Jogaram	18.06.2005	Sale Deed Doc. No. 3923 , Book No. I, Jild No. 1586 , Pages 143–147
Sale Deed	232	Area: 0.9640 hectares.	Bhajni, Bheji & Gyana d/o Bhikhan	Omender Bhati s/o Jogaram	11.04.2005	Sale Deed Doc. No. 2185, Book No. I, Jild No. 1569, Pages 141–147
Sale Deed	265	Area: 1 Bigha – 3 Biswa. Sale of share in Khasra No. 265.	Shanti Devi w/o Harishchand	Rajpal Singh s/o Harishchand	Not Available	Not Available
Sale Deed	265	0.0287 hectares out of total 0.2910 hectares,	Vijaypal (adopted s/o Yaadu), Dayawati w/o Vijaypal & Kaladevi w/o Lakshichand	Rajpal Sharma, Kunwar Sen & Prem Chand Sharma s/o Lakshimchand Sharma	18.10.2012	Sale Deed Doc. No. 18306, Book No. I, Jild No. 4763, Pages 139–162
Sale Deed	266	Area: 1 Bigha – 10 Biswa, amongst other lands.	Shanti Devi w/o Harishchand	Rajpal Singh s/o Harishchand	Not Available	Not Available
Sale Deed	266	0.0287 hectares out of total 0.3790 hectares.	Vijaypal (adopted s/o Yaadu), Dayawati w/o Vijaypal & Kaladevi w/o Lakshichand	Rajpal Sharma, Kunwar Sen & Prem Chand Sharma s/o Lakshimchand Sharma	18.10.2012	Sale Deed Doc. No. 18306, Book No. I, Jild No. 4763, Pages 139–162,
Sale Deed	266	0.0501 hectares out of total 0.3790 hectares.	Sunil, Anil s/o Dhanpal & Virmla Devi w/o Dhanpal	Keshav s/o Mahipal	16/08/2014	Sale Deed Doc. No. 16478, Book No. I, Jild No. 7220.
Sale Deed	246	Area: 1 Bigha – 3 Biswa.	Raje s/o Nihal	Om Prakash & Oni s/o Nihala	Not Available	Not Available
Original court order missing-passed by Civil Judge (Junior Division) in Case No. 184 of 1990	265		Shanti Devi w/o Harishchand	Rajpal Singh s/o Harishchand	Not Applicable	Not Applicable

*All khasras are located in Village Luhari Pargana, Tehsil Dadri, District Gautam Buddh Nagar, Uttar Pradesh

NORTHERN RAILWAY
E-TENDER NOTICE
Sr. Divisional Electrical Engineer/Traction Distribution, DRM's Office, State Entry Road, New Delhi for & on behalf of President of India, invites open e-tender for the under noted work:

1	Name of Work with its location : Replacement of G-Jumper & PG Clamps in GZB-SRE & SPR section.
2	Approx. Cost of work : Rs. 49,96,730.00/-
3	Earnest Money Deposit : Rs. 99,900/-
4	E-Tender Bid Online Submission Period : 14.09.2026 (00.00 Hrs.) to 28.09.2026 (15.00 Hrs.)
5	E-Tender Bid Submission End Date & E-Tender Open Date & Time : 28.09.2026 (15.00 hrs.)
6	Fund Allocation : 07041032
7	Website particulars where complete details of tender documents can be seen : www.reps.gov.in

No.: 24A-TRD-NDLS-2026-27 Dated: 01.09.2026 3036/2026
SERVING CUSTOMERS WITH A SMILE| **SAR TELEVENTURE LIMITED** CIN: L45202UP2019PLC213062 Regd. Office: B-16, First Floor, Sector-2, Noida-201301, Uttar Pradesh Mobile No: +91-8587050050 E-mail: info@sartelevventure.com, Website: www.sartelevventure.com **NOTICE OF 7TH ANNUAL GENERAL MEETING ("AGM") OF SAR TELEVENTURE LIMITED (THE COMPANY) TO BE HELD THROUGH VIDEO CONFERENCING ("VC") / OTHER AUDIO-VISUAL MEANS ("OAVM")** Notice is hereby given that the 7th Annual General Meeting ("AGM") of Sar Televventure Limited ("the Company") will be held on Tuesday, September 29, 2026 at 1:00 P.M. (IST), through Video Conferencing ("VC") / Other Audio-Visual Means ("OAVM") without physical presence of the members at the venue in compliance with applicable provisions of the Companies Act, 2013 and Rules issued thereunder and the Securities and Exchange Board of India ("SEBI") (Listing Obligations and Disclosure Requirements) Regulations, 2015 read with General Circular Nos. 20/2020 dated 5th May, 2020 and subsequent circulars issued in this regard from time to time by Ministry of Corporate Affairs (MCA) (collectively referred to as "Circulars") read with SEBI Circular No. SEBI/HO/CFD/CFD-P2-P/CIR/2024/133 dated 3rd October, 2024, along with other applicable Circulars issued in this regard by MCA and the Securities and Exchange Board of India (Listing Obligations and Disclosure Requirements) Regulations, 2015, to transact the business(es) as set out in the notice ("Notice") of the AGM. The venue of the said meeting shall be deemed to be the Registered Office of the Company. In compliance with the above Circulars, copies of the Notice of the AGM along with the Annual Report for the financial year 2025-26 ("**Annual Report**") will be sent to the members, whose names appear in the register of members / register of beneficial owners maintained by the depositories as on Friday, 28th August, 2026 and whose email addresses are registered with the Company/ registrar and share transfer agent/ depository(ies)/ depository participant(s). The same will also be available on Company's website www.sartelevventure.com, website of the stock exchange i.e. National Stock Exchange of India Limited at www.nseindia.com, and also at the website of MUGF Intime India Private Limited (previously known as Link Intime India Private Limited) (e-voting agency) at <https://intimevote.linkintime.co.in/>. Additionally, a letter providing the web-link, including the exact path, where complete details of the Annual Report are available is being sent to those shareholder(s) who have not registered their e-mail addresses with Company / registrar and share transfer agent/ depository(ies)/ depository participant(s). Any member requiring the hard copy of Notice of the AGM and Annual Report may write an email to the Company's email address at info@sartelevventure.com or to the RTA at enotices@in.mpmis.mugf.com. The Company will be providing facility of remote e-Voting and e-Voting at the AGM to its Members in respect of the businesses to be transacted at the 7th AGM through MUGF. Members holding shares either in physical form or in dematerialized form, as on the Cut-Off date, Tuesday, 22nd September, 2026, may cast their vote electronically. The remote e-voting period commences on Saturday, September 26, 2026 at 9:00 A.M. IST and ends on Monday, September 28, 2026 at 5:00 P.M. IST. Those Members, who will be present in the AGM through VC / OAVM facility and who have not cast their vote on the Resolutions through remote e-voting and are otherwise not barred from doing so, shall be eligible to vote through e-voting system during the AGM. Login details for e-voting shall be made available to the members on their registered email address. Members who have not registered their email address/KYC can get the same registered/updated through Registrar and Share Transfer Agent i.e. MUGF Intime India Private Limited (previously known as Link Intime India Private Limited) ("RTA") of the company or their Depository Participant ("DP") and avail remote e-voting facility as well as voting at the AGM as per the manner prescribed in Notice of AGM. All members holding shares in dematerialized or physical form (including the members who have not registered their email addresses) will have an opportunity to cast their vote on the business in the manner as set forth in the Notice of the AGM through remote e-voting or through e-voting system at the AGM. Members are requested to carefully read the Notice of the AGM and in particular, instructions for joining AGM, manner of casting vote through remote e-voting or electronic voting at the AGM. The above information is being issued for the information and benefit of all Members of the Company and is in Compliance with the MCA Circulars and the SEBI Circular(s). **For and on behalf of the Board of Directors** **For SAR Televventure Limited** Sd/- Mayank Jain Company Secretary & Compliance Officer Membership No.: A26620 Date: September 3, 2026 Place: Noida (U.P.) |

**म.प्र. पुलिस आवास एवं अधोसंरचना विकास निगम**
कार्यालय परियोजना यंत्री, इंदौर संभाग क्रमांक-02
जो-13, प्रथम 'तक' एम.आई.जी. कॉलोनी, एम.आई.जी. थाने के पीछे, इंदौर (म.प्र.), मो. नं.- 9425601512
E-mail Id :- mpphidclindore2@gmail.com

निविदा आमंत्रण सूचना - 11/2026-27

म.प्र.पु.आ.एवं अधो.वि.नि., इंदौर संभाग क्र.- 02, इंदौर द्वारा क्रमशः पुलिस लाइन खंडवा में 4 Go's, 24 NGO एवं 96 OR, पातुंडा पुलिस लाइन बुरहानपुर में 16 आरक्षक एवं पुलिस लाइन चूनाभट्टी, बड़वानी में 4 Go's आवास गृहों के निर्माण कार्यों हेतु निविदाएं आमंत्रित की जाती है। निविदा अप्रत दिनांक **22.09.2026 तक** खरीदे जा सकते हैं, जिसकी विस्तृत निविदा सूचना एवं अन्य विवरण <https://mptenders.gov.in> पर देखे जा सकते हैं।

म.प्र. माध्यम/127849/2026
परियोजना यंत्री

SANEH INDUSTRIAL INVESTMENTS LIMITED
CIN: L74899DL1980PLC060079
Regd. Office: Deltion House, 4801, Bharat Ram Road, 24, Daryaganj, New Delhi – 110002
Website: <https://saneh.in/>, E-mail: sanehld@gmail.com Tel: 011-45795859

NOTICE is hereby given that the 46th Annual General Meeting ("AGM") of the Members of Saneh Industrial Investments Limited (CIN: L74899DL1980PLC060079) will be held on Tuesday, September 29, 2026 at 4:00 P.M. at the registered office of the Company at Deltion House, 4801, Bharat Ram Road, 24, Darya Ganj, New Delhi-110002 to transact the businesses as set out in the AGM Notice dated August 11, 2026. The Notice of the AGM and the Annual Report containing, inter-alia, the financial statements for the financial year 2025-26 and the Reports of the Auditor's and Directors' have been sent by electronic mode to the Members of the Company on September 3, 2026, whose email addresses are registered with the Company/RTA/Depository Participant(s) and letters containing the Company's weblink to access the Annual Report of FY 2025-26 have been sent by ordinary post to the Members of the Company whose email addresses are not registered with the Company/RTA/Depository Participant(s). The Notice and Annual Report and other relevant details are also available on the website of the Company at <https://saneh.in/>. Notice is also hereby given pursuant to Section 91 of the Companies Act, 2013 read with Rule 10 of the Companies (Management & Administration) Rules, 2014 that the Register of Members and Share Transfer Books of the Company will remain closed from September 23, 2026 to September 29, 2026 (both days inclusive).

In compliance with the provisions of Section 108 of the Companies Act, 2013 read with Rule 20 of the Companies (Management and Administration) Rules, 2014 and Regulation 44 of the SEBI (LODR) Regulations, 2015, the Company has offered e-voting facility for transacting all the business items as mentioned in the Notice of 46th Annual General Meeting through the CDSL to enable the members to cast their votes electronically. The remote E-voting commences on Saturday, September 26, 2026 (10:00 A.M.) and ends on Monday, September 28, 2026 (5:00 P.M.). No E-voting shall be allowed beyond the said date and time. M/s. Vaibhav Sharma & Associates, Company Secretaries has been appointed as Scrutinizer for E-voting process. The Members who have cast their vote by remote e-voting may also attend the meeting but shall not be entitled to cast their vote again. The members who have not cast their vote by remote e-voting shall be able to vote at the meeting. A person, whose name is recorded in the Register of Members/Beneficial Owners on the cut-off date i.e. September 22, 2026 only shall be entitled to avail the facility of remote e-voting in the AGM. Any person who becomes member of the Company after dispatch of the notice of the meeting and holding shares as on the cut-off date i.e. September 22, 2026 may obtain the user ID and password by following the procedure given in the Notice of the meeting. Any queries/grievances relating to remote e-voting could be addressed to Ms. Kajal Gupta, Company Secretary at the registered office address of the Company; Email ID: sanehld@gmail.com; Phone: 011-45795859 or you could also refer the remote e-voting user manual available for shareholders in the help section at www.evotingindia.com

For Saneh Industrial Investments Limited
Sd/-
Vivek Gupta
Director
DIN: 00035916

Date : September 3, 2026
Place : Delhi

Public Notice
This is to inform the general public that Mrs. Gurcharan Kaur is the owner of the Built-Up Property Bearing no. Wz-G-28, land area measuring 100 Sq. Yds out of Khasra no. 9822, Situated in the area of Village Chauchand in the abadi of Sant Nagar Extn. New Delhi-110018 through GPA, ATS, WILL dated 18.03.1987 executed by Mrs. Naseeb Kaur in favour of Mr. Mangi Singh and Mrs. Gurcharan Kaur in respect of property bearing no. Wz-G-28 area 100 Sq. Yds. Unfortunately, Mr. Mangi Ram expired and left behind his legal heirs. Thereafter, Requisitionment Deed dated 06.07.2023 as doc. no. 8723 executed by S. Rajinder Singh, S. Tajinder Singh, Mrs. Kiranjot Kaur in favour of Mrs. Gurcharan Kaur in respect of said property. Mrs. Gurcharan Kaur is in the process of mortgaging the said property with Hero Finpro Limited. Any objections or concerns regarding this transaction should be raised within a period of 7 days from the date of this public notice. Any objections submitted after the completion of this 7-day period will not be considered binding with respect to the said property or the interests of our client. If anyone wishes to raise an objection, please do so within the stipulated 7-day period by contacting Law Veritas: North (Advocates & Legal Consultants) at Office No. 11, 1st Floor, Building No. A-44A, Sector-16, Noida, Uttar Pradesh-201301; Landline(s): +91012-04499711, e-mail: accounts@lvnorth.in

The Pioneer
Classified
CHANGE OF NAME

I, Gobardhan, Father of- No.1557237H Hav Manoranjan Parida, R/o- Vill- Barigaon, PO- Bailo, Dist- Kendujhar, Odisha- 758020, have changed my name from Gobardhan to Gobardhan Parida, vide affidavit dated 03/09/2026 before Notary Public Delhi.

I, Swaran Lata, Mother of- No.1557237H Hav Manoranjan Parida, R/o- Vill- Barigaon, PO- Bailo, Dist- Kendujhar, Odisha- 758020, have changed my name from Swaran Lata to Swarnalata Parida, vide affidavit dated 03/09/2026 before Notary Public Delhi.

I, JC-473817H NBSUB Dharmendra Singh, R/o- Gayatri Vihar Colony, Pintu Park, Murar, Gwalior, M.P- 474006, have changed my son's name from Abhay Singh to Abhay Rajawat, vide affidavit dated 03/09/2026 before Notary Public Delhi.

I, No.16024788K RFN Jaideep, Unit 7 Raj Rif, R/o- VPO- Ghoghripur, Teh & Dist- Karnal, Haryana, have changed my daughter's name from Charvi to Charvi Maan, vide affidavit dated 03/09/2026 before Notary Public Delhi.

CP decongestion plan triggers debate over business impact

RAJESH KUMAR ■ New Delhi

Traffic and parking hassles notwithstanding, Connaught Place is the must-go-to place for citizens and visitors alike. A suggestion to make the inner circle of this prestigious market traffic-free for fixed hours has sparked a fresh debate about pros and cons. The suggestion to decongest Connaught Place came from none other than NDMC chief Manoj Dwivedi on Thursday. He raised the question of whether the move should be implemented throughout the day or during specific hours. This has prompted the New Delhi Market Association to oppose the plan saying the market is already designed to facilitate pedestrian movement and that restricting vehicles

could affect businesses. Dwivedi's suggestion outreach on X invited appreciation and responses from many social media users who commented on the post. This is not the first attempt to reduce vehicles inside Connaught Place's Inner Circle. Similar plans and trials have been undertaken in the past, but a permanent vehicle-free system has not materialised. "Can we make inner circle of CP vehicle free so that people can walk around freely like on some mall roads or central areas in foreign cities. 2. Should we do it for full day or do it from 6 pm to midnight in summers and 11 am to 4 pm in winters? 3. Some different timing for weekends? 4. What kind of activities would you prefer in

Central Park and inner circle during no vehicle slots. Positive suggestions would be appreciated," he posted on 'X' on Thursday. In another post on X, Dwivedi said, "People would like to be in Connaught Place till late. So, from tomorrow onwards timings for 11 public toilets are being extended up to midnight. More will follow in due course." In a subsequent post later in the day, Dwivedi said the suggestions received would be examined before the proposal is taken forward, including through a SWOT analysis. He said the exercise would require a "good amount of planning" and consultations with traffic police and other stakeholders before any implementation. "I will study all these in



due course at first opportunity (maybe after the BRICS summit is over). Will do a SWOT analysis also. This will need a good amount of planning before we move towards implementation in the best manner possible," he wrote in a post on X. The latest proposal seeks to go beyond simply keeping cars away. NDMC is considering turning the Inner Circle and Central Park into spaces for

public activities, including cultural programmes, music, street performances, art exhibitions, yoga sessions, children's activities and heritage walks. The area has experimented with pedestrian-only periods through "Raahgiri", under which the Inner Circle is opened to people on select Sundays for activities such as walking, cycling, fitness sessions and street performances. The proposed arrangement could give such pedestrian-focused use a more regular place in Connaught Place, while allowing vehicular movement during the remaining hours. Connaught place being a major shopping and hangout hub for Delhiites draws a lot of traffic everyday. The traffic is unusually higher on weekends thus leading to traffic jams.

Responding to a post on X by NDMC Chairman Manoj Dwivedi seeking public views on making the inner circle vehicle-free for fixed hours, the association said there was "absolutely no question" of such a move. "There is absolutely no question of making CP inner circle vehicle-free, as the market is already well designed for enough pedestrian movement," it said. A member of the association said an earlier attempt to make the inner circle vehicle-free had failed. The association also said removing vehicle movement in front of showrooms could affect businesses and the exclusivity of the market and its shops. Dwivedi's suggestion outreach on X invited appreciation and responses from

many social media users who commented on the post. One user appreciated the move, saying it was great to see him "crowd sourcing" suggestions and that it was "wonderful" to see the pedigree behind the institution he is heading. He added that a similar initiative, called Raahgiri, was held in Gurugram several years ago every Sunday, which he said encouraged community participation in sports and other activities. "Time slots is an excellent approach for preliminary stage. Only suggestion is that time slot for vehicle entry ban should not be during peak hours (for examples 8-11 am and 5-8 pm), otherwise the traffic snarls will stretch even further," stated a user on 'X'.

NDMC extends CP toilet hours till midnight

PIONEER NEWS SERVICE ■ New Delhi

The New Delhi Municipal Council (NDMC), as part of a pilot project, will extend the operating hours of 11 public toilets in Connaught Place till midnight from Friday, in a bid to make the popular commercial and leisure hub more visitor-friendly. NDMC chairman Manoj Dwivedi said people often stay in Connaught Place till late and the timings of the public conveniences were therefore being extended. There are 23 public toilets in Connaught Place, of which 11 will, in the first instance, remain open till midnight. Currently, all public washrooms in Connaught Place remain open till 10 pm. "People would like to be in Connaught Place till late. So from tomorrow onwards, timings for 11 public toilets are being extended up to midnight. More will follow in due course," Dwivedi said in a post on X on Thursday.

near RR-2; K Block between RR-4 and RR-5; E Block near RR-7; Central Park opposite D Block and F Block on the inner circle; near Super Bazar parking; ECE House; F Block near RR-1; and at the Panchkuian Road-Chelmsford Road stretch on the outer circle. The move comes on the same day Dwivedi sought public suggestions on measures to make Connaught Place more visitor-friendly, including whether its inner circle should be made a vehicle-free zone. Responding to his post on X regarding the extended toilet timings, some users welcomed the move but sought better maintenance and security at public conveniences. One user suggested that a security guard or cleaning staff should be present at each toilet and that the facilities should be cleaned frequently to maintain hygiene. Another user requested that the public washrooms be kept open round-the-clock. The NDMC has said more public toilets in Connaught Place would be brought under the extended timings in due course.

Delhi to develop multi-utility ducts to end road digging

PIONEER NEWS SERVICE ■ New Delhi

Ugly sights of piled-up debris due to continuous digging of roads, causing traffic disruptions and inconvenience for pedestrians alike, will soon be a thing of the past. Delhi Government is developing multi-utility ducts that will feature shared underground corridors. As part of the important initiative, the Government on Thursday announced a pilot project at two locations in Chandni Chowk to construct Multi-Utility Ducts (MUDs) with shared underground corridors for various essential services. At technically suitable locations, these ducts can be used for electricity cables, water and gas lines, fire-hydrant networks and other essential utility services. Stating this, Chief Minister Rekha Gupta said her Government has taken this important decision to make the capital safer, future-ready, developed and beautiful. Rekha Gupta also said in a

rapidly developing metropolis like Delhi, repeated excavation of roads by different utility agencies according to their individual requirements is a serious urban problem. She said the construction of multi-utility ducts would reduce the need to repeatedly dig up and repair roads, minimise disruptions to traffic, reduce inconvenience to citizens and help maintain the structural strength of roads more effectively. The government took this decision at a recently held Cabinet meeting. As regards the pilot project, Rekha Gupta informed stretches measuring 310 metres on Esplanade Road and 560 metres on Mor Sarai Road in Chandni Chowk have been proposed for selection. Work on both is set to begin soon. Based on the experience gained from these two pilot corridors, multi-utility ducts would be constructed in other parts of Delhi. The pilot project would help assess how different utility services can be better accommodated within a shared underground system and how such



infrastructure can be expanded in the future according to the requirements of different parts of Delhi, she said. The CM said an expert technical committee would soon be constituted for the entire system. The committee would include expert officials from discoms, the Delhi Jal Board, the Public Works Department and other departments. Based on the committee's supervision and recommendations, work related to the construction and expansion of multi-utility ducts in different parts of the capital would be taken forward. The Chief Minister said the

technical design of the multi-utility ducts would include essential provisions for ventilation, fire safety, easy access for maintenance and emergency response. The objective is to ensure that different utility services can operate safely and in an organised manner within a shared underground corridor. Rekha Gupta said Delhi's development vision is not limited to meeting today's needs. "We want to create infrastructure that is safe, well-organised and sustainable, keeping future requirements in mind. The multi-utility duct is part of this vision."

She said the system would enable better coordination among different agencies and create a more organised framework for developing underground utility networks in Delhi. With shared underground corridors available, maintenance of utility networks and their future expansion would become easier and faster. It would also help reduce the possibility of accidental damage to utility lines during excavation and improve coordination among various civic and utility agencies. The CM said the multi-utility duct initiative marks an important shift towards coordinated urban utility planning, replacing scattered underground works undertaken by different agencies according to their individual requirements. It would also create a more organised foundation for the future expansion of new utility services. The Government's objective is to develop infrastructure in Delhi that is safe, clean, strong, well-organised and aligned with future requirements.



सत्यमेव जयते
दिल्ली सरकार



ॐ कृष्णाय वासुदेवाय हरये परमात्मने।
प्रणतः क्लेशनाशाय गोविन्दाय नमो नमः॥

आप सभी को

श्री कृष्ण जन्माष्टमी

की हार्दिक शुभकामनाएं



नरेन्द्र मोदी
प्रधानमंत्री



रेखा गुप्ता
मुख्यमंत्री, दिल्ली

DIP/Shabdarth/Display/082/26-27

IN FOCUS



A child dressed as Lord Krishna interacting with another child as he peeps through a window on the eve of Janmashtami festival in Nadia PTI

Congress questions Govt over GDP estimate revision

PIONER NEWS SERVICE
■ New Delhi

The Congress on Thursday questioned the Government on the latest GDP figures and asked why there was a substantial downward revision in GDP estimates for the last four years and sought a detailed account of how this revision was done.

The Opposition party also asked what methodology was adopted by the Government to bring this revision while seeking an explanation for the reduction of ₹43 lakh crore in the estimated size of the economy. India's economy grew at a faster-than-expected 7.8 per cent in the April-June quarter, showing resilience in the face of concerns that the



Congress general secretary Jairam Ramesh

war in Iran and resulting global economic uncertainty could weigh on growth.

Congress general secretary Jairam Ramesh, in a statement, posed a set of four questions to the Government on what it said is the growing evidence of

"irregularities" in the just-released GDP figures.

Ramesh said the Modi Government has been telling us India's economy grew 7.8 per cent in the April-June 2026 quarter, and predictably, there has been a fair bit of "chest-thump-

ing" about it. But if one actually sits down and looks at how this number was arrived at, the whole thing starts looking rather shaky, he claimed. He said to calculate any growth rate, one needs last year's GDP figure to compare against.

"Now, the figure for the previous April-June 2025 quarter has been revised not once but four times from around ₹86 lakh crore to about ₹80 lakh crore. And here's the catch: if you keep shrinking the base you're comparing against, this year's number will automatically look much bigger than it really is, even if nothing has actually changed on the ground. That is simple arithmetic, not economic growth," he said.

Delhiites get an extended weekend

RAJESH KUMAR ■ New Delhi

Delhiites will have an extended weekend from September 11, thanks to the BRICS summit, with the Union and the State Government offices and establishments closed on Friday.

World leaders including Russian president Russian President Vladimir Putin and Chinese President Xi Jinping will start arriving that day for the two-day conclave starting September 12. Given the elaborate security umbrella for the important event, the decision to close offices was taken to ensure smooth traffic and logistical arrangements. The closure is also aimed at reducing inconvenience for the general public during the event.

"The undersigned is directed to say that the BRICS Business Forum and 18th BRICS Leaders' Summit are scheduled to be held from 11-13 September, 2026 at Bharat Mandapam, New Delhi. The Summit will be attended by leaders from about thirty BRICS members and partner

countries, Heads of International Organisations and business representatives from BRICS nations including India. Recognising the magnitude of this event, the substantial logistical arrangements involved and to minimise inconvenience to the general public, it has been decided to keep the central Government offices in Delhi/New Delhi closed on Friday, the 11th of September 2026 (12th and 13th of September being Saturday and Sunday respectively)," an official memorandum issued by the Ministry of Personnel, Public Grievances and Pensions said.

Delhi Lieutenant Governor has declared holiday for all Government offices, autonomous bodies and public sector undertakings



under the Government of the National Capital Territory of Delhi. " The Lieutenant General of the NCT of Delhi is pleased to declare September 11 (Friday) to be a holiday in all Government offices, autonomous bodies and public sector undertakings under the Delhi Government in view of the BRICS Summit and management connected therewith", according to an order issued by Delhi Government's General Administration Department (GAD).

Meanwhile, Delhi Police held an interstate meeting with senior police officers from neighbouring states and the Union Territory of Chandigarh to strengthen security coordination and ensure an incident-free BRICS Summit in the national capital. The meeting, chaired by Delhi Police Commissioner Anurag Kumar, was attended by senior officers from Haryana, Punjab, Uttar Pradesh, Rajasthan and Chandigarh.

According to a Delhi Police officer, traffic police have planned elaborate arrangements involving restrictions and diversions to ensure smooth movement of VVIP motorcades. The movement is likely to affect vehicular traffic on at least 22 key corridors in central, south and southwest Delhi.

JKLF chief Yasin Malik willing to face death penalty in Sarla Bhat case

MOHIT KANDHARI ■ Jammu

Jammu and Kashmir Liberation Front (JKLF) chief Yasin Malik, who is currently lodged in Central Jail No 7, Tihar, has purportedly read the writing on the wall.

Malik reportedly triggered a furore by submitting before the Srinagar court that he no longer wishes to contest the trial in the 1990 murder case of Kashmiri Pandit nurse Sarla Bhat and is willing to face the death penalty. Pleading not guilty, Malik has also announced his decision to divorce his Pakistani wife, artist and activist Mushaal Hussein Mullick.

Malik submitted a 25-page written statement before the Additional Sessions Court in Srinagar through his lawyer, Abu Adil Pandit. The



court has scheduled the next hearing for September 19.

In his statement, Malik said he would no longer contest the proceedings in the Sarla Bhat murder case.

However, he made it clear that his decision to withdraw from the trial should not be treated as an admission of guilt. I will no longer contest the trial, and the death penalty may be con-

sidered for me," Malik said, in his affidavit attested by the Deputy Superintendent, Central Jail no 7, Tihar, New Delhi on August 27, 2026.

While announcing his decision, Malik maintained that he had been falsely implicated in the case due to political circumstances. In his statement, Malik denied ordering or participating in the 1990 murder of Kashmiri Pandit nurse Sarla Bhat.

Malik also rejected an allegation that Bhat was an informer responsible for a Border Security Force raid in Srinagar in which he was critically injured. Sarla Bhat was neither working for the security forces in any covert capacity nor was she in any manner responsible for the raid conducted at Narwara on 8 April 1990," Malik stated

in his affidavit. The State Investigation Agency filed a chargesheet on June 29, 2026, in connection with Bhat's murder on April 19, 1990, naming Malik as one of the accused more than 36 years after the killing. According to Malik, three SIA officers had questioned him in Tihar jail on June 2 and 3. He says they confronted him with two allegations.

The second allegation, as reproduced in the affidavit, was that the JKLF suspected Bhat, a nurse at Sher-i-Kashmir Institute of Medical Sciences in Soura, of informing security forces about Malik's presence at the house of Hafiz Bazaz in Narwara and that Malik consequently ordered her killing.

Malik disputed both the allegations in his lengthy

statement. He said the decision to withdraw from the proceedings was taken after careful deliberation and after performing Istikhara, an Islamic prayer traditionally offered before making an important decision.

In the same statement, Malik announced his decision to end his marriage to Mushaal Hussein Mullick.

The couple married in 2009 and have a daughter, Razia Sultana, who is 13 years old. "Through this affidavit, I also wish to address my wife and my daughter. For the last eight years, I have not been able to hear your voices or communicate with you, as I was not permitted phone calls or video conferencing with you. I know that my time with you has been limited and uncertain. You

are Twenty (20) years younger than me, and I do not want you to spend the rest of your life carrying the burden of my circumstances or living as a widow. I therefore request you to find the courage to begin a new chapter of your life with dignity and hope.

I shall always love, respect and remember both of you in this world and in the next life. Wherever my destiny takes me, my prayers, affection and blessings will always remain with you. That, before I will be hanged, I have taken the decision to separate you from the bond of our Nikah. I don't know how I will pronounce separation from you – Nelson Mandela helped me to pronounce my true feelings," Malik wrote in the affidavit.

Ram temple's new CEO gets first briefing

PIONEER NEWS SERVICE ■ Ayodhya

On Thursday, Air Marshal (Retd) Jeetendra Mishra, the Chief Executive Officer (CEO) of the Ram temple trust, attended his first meeting in Ayodhya with the trust's members and office-bearers. He received an overview of how the trust works, including its accounting and administrative setup.

The meeting took place at the trust's Shri Ram Janmabhoomi Kshetra office in Ramghat. "This was an introductory meeting at which I met some of the other members of the trust, and I shall need a few more days to get a clear understanding of my role and duties," Mishra said after the meeting.

The sources stated that although Mishra has been appointed CEO, he has not yet officially assumed the post and is expected to do so in the next few days.

Govind Dev Giri, the trust's General Secretary, stated that the trust members held a formal meeting with the new CEO and



Newly-appointed Shri Ram Janmabhoomi Teerth Kshetra Trust's first Chief Executive Officer (CEO), Air Marshal (ret'd) Jeetendra Mishra arrives at the temple in Ayodhya PTI

that standard operating procedures for the CEO, outlining his duties and responsibilities, will be drawn up in the coming days.

Sources added that Mishra attended another meeting in the evening on the trust's accounts,

together with Giri, Krishna Mohan and some other members of the trust at the Ram temple. He was given a briefing on various aspects of the way the trust operates, including its administrative and financial arrangements.

Encounter erupts near tourist hub in Kashmir's Budgam

PIONEER NEWS SERVICE

■ Jammu

A fresh encounter broke out between a joint team of security personnel and a group of terrorists near a famous tourist spot in the Yusmarg area of Central Kashmir district of Budgam late on Thursday evening.

Ground reports said gunshots were reportedly heard during an ongoing cordon and search operation launched by the security forces following reports of the presence of terrorists in the area. A group of two to three terrorists are believed to have been trapped by the security forces in the forest belt of Yusmarg.

To plug gaps, additional reinforcements were rushed to the area to maintain a tight cordon during the night. Till the time of filing the report, the security forces were maintaining a tight cordon in



the general area to prevent the escape of the terrorists pinned down in the area.

The security forces are expected to resume anti-terrorist operations at first light.

In Jammu, a Pakistani intruder was apprehended by the Border Security Force (BSF) along the International Border in the Kanachak sector.

Officials said the intruder was apprehended by personnel of 44 BSF Battalion near Border Out Post (BOP) Sohan in the morning hours.

India-Belgium ties get a boost

India and Belgium are working towards concluding a Migration and Mobility Partnership Agreement, which is expected to support the movement of skilled professionals and talent between the two countries.

The leaders also exchanged views on major international conflicts, including the war in Ukraine and the situation in West Asia. PM Modi reiterated India's support for resolving conflicts through dialogue and diplomacy and said both countries backed efforts aimed at restoring peace. India and Belgium also reaffirmed their commitment to combating terrorism in all its forms. Clean energy and critical minerals featured prominently in the discussions. PM Modi said both countries considered a clean-energy future and reliable supply chains to be shared priorities. A memorandum of understanding on renewable energy signed during the engagement is expected to provide fresh momentum to cooperation in sustainability.

The two countries also decided to enhance collaboration in critical minerals, particularly in processing and recycling. PM Modi highlighted opportunities in the semiconductor sector, saying Belgium's technological expertise and India's manufacturing scale could complement each other. De Wever's visit follows the Belgian Economic Mission to India led by Princess Astrid in March 2025, when around 40 agreements were signed. An Indian official said the latest visit would further reinforce Belgium's role in strengthening India-European Union relations.

De Wever described the conclusion of the India-EU free trade agreement as a significant milestone and said relations between Belgium and India were becoming broader and more

strategic. India and Belgium have maintained diplomatic relations since September 1947, while their historical links extend back more than three centuries. Belgium remains an important economic partner for India in Europe.

Bilateral trade reached around \$13.01 billion in 2025-26. Diamond commerce remains a significant part of the relationship, with Antwerp serving as a major global diamond hub. Belgium has also been an important source of investment for India, with foreign direct investment inflows estimated at approximately \$4.2 billion between April 2000 and December 2025.

The two countries established a ministerial-level strategic dialogue earlier this year. The inaugural Belgium-India Strategic Dialogue was held in Brussels on July 15 and co-chaired by External Affairs Minister S Jaishankar and Belgian Deputy Prime Minister Maxime Prevot.

Cooperation is also expanding in renewable energy, clean technologies and maritime logistics. Belgian company John Cockerill is developing a 2 GW electrolyser manufacturing facility in Kakinada, while Belgium's position as a major European maritime and logistics centre offers opportunities for greater collaboration in ports, shipping and supply chains.

India renews Choksi extradition push

The issue assumes significance as Belgian Prime Minister Bart De Wever is in India for high-level talks with the Indian leadership. Choksi's extradition is expected to be among the matters discussed as New

Belgium arrested Choksi on India's extradition request in April 2025 and he has remained in custody "So as far as the extradition request is

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concerned, you know, it is pursuant to India's extradition request which was made some time back. The fugitive was arrested by the Belgian authorities in April last year and he is in the Belgium jail since then. So the government of India remains committed to ensuring that the fugitives are brought back to India to face the law and justice," he added.

Choksi's arrest in Belgium marked a major development in India's efforts to secure the return of the businessman, who had left India after the alleged banking fraud came to light. Since his arrest, Choksi has remained in a Belgian jail while he pursued legal options against being sent to India. The extradition process gained momentum after Belgian courts ruled in favour of India's request.

Choksi challenged the extradition order through the Belgian judicial system, but his final appeal was rejected by Belgium's top court in December 2025. The decision effectively removed the last major judicial obstacle to his extradition. However, the rejection of the final appeal does not necessarily mean that the physical transfer takes place immediately. Authorities still have to complete the necessary procedures before Choksi can be handed over to Indian officials. The case became one of the biggest banking scandals in India and triggered intense scrutiny of banking procedures and controls.

US puts India-Iran ties on radar

"Well, I don't think there's a trade deal between India and Iran. Obviously, there are — countries all develop their own foreign policy, and many countries around the world talk to the Iranian regime," Rubio said in response to a remark by

Kilmeade that PM Modi and Pezeshkian appeared to set up a trade deal.

"I mean, we've met with elements of the Iranian regime as well, in terms of some of these discussions that have occurred and there's been contact with them," Rubio said.

The US Secretary of State said President Donald Trump has made it clear that no country should help Iran evade sanctions.

"No country should be out there helping them create mechanisms by which they can generate revenue that they will then use to sponsor terrorism and try to build a nuclear weapon. And if countries decide to do that, then we're going to have to sanction them too," Rubio said.

BCI cannot act against law students, orders SC

It set aside two notifications issued by the BCI in connection with the NALSAR row, even though both were withdrawn within hours of their issuance following widespread criticism.

"We declare all communications dated August 13 or subsequent modified communication to be without any authority of law. Interim directions made absolute," the Bench said while disposing of the plea filed by two NALSAR alumni, Mihira Sood and Abhishek Tiwari.

They had challenged the BCI Chairman Manan Kumar Mishra's directions issued on August 13 that NALSAR students be not enrolled as advocates for the time being and an enquiry be held into the entire episode. However, after public outrage, the BCI chairperson withdrew the communications within hours of their issuance.

During the hearing, senior advocate K

Parameshwar, appearing for the law students, said though the BCI chairman's directions were withdrawn, there needs to be an inquiry into the manner in which they were issued, to that extent, the petition survived, he said.

"This is a question of freedom of speech and expression in a university. It is not about just one student. It is about banning freedom of speech and expression across an entire university," he said. Senior advocate and BCI chairperson Mishra said the letters were withdrawn within one hour of their issuance and now the matter be put to quietus.

"We want to know the circumstances in which these orders came to be passed and whether meetings were held. This is, after all, a statutory authority responsible for legal education and for regulating the legal profession," Parameshwar said.

"Everything has already been closed. The (Bar) Council, in its meeting, has said that there is nothing further and that everything has been resolved. The letter was immediately withdrawn," the BCI head said.

"The BCI does not have jurisdiction...after someone passes out...once a law graduate gets registered as an advocate, then BCI is statutory authority to regulate conduct. But not of students," the CJI said.

The controversy had erupted on August 14 after the BCI directed state bar councils not to enrol NALSAR's 2026 graduates as advocates until further orders over allegations relating to a campaign against CJI Kant's proposed visit to the university. When the matter was mentioned earlier before the Supreme Court, the CJI had strongly disapproved of the BCI's intervention, saying, "It's a dialogue between students and me. Who are they (BCI) to interfere? This is totally uncalled for".

Jewar toll plaza free for nearby villagers

PIONEER NEWS SERVICE

■ Noida

Eligible residents of villages affected by and located around the Yamuna Expressway in the Jewar region will be allowed toll-free travel at the Jewar toll plaza from September 17, which was a long-standing demand by local residents and farmers, BJP MLA Dharendra Singh said on Thursday.

The facility will be available after a prescribed verification and registration process. Eligible residents will have to submit proof of local residence, Aadhaar card and vehicle registration certificate at the designated office of the toll plaza manager.

Singh, the Jewar MLA, said the decision followed several rounds of discussions with the Yamuna Expressway Industrial Development Authority and the expressway management, during which the commuting difficulties of local residents and the contribution of farmers were raised.

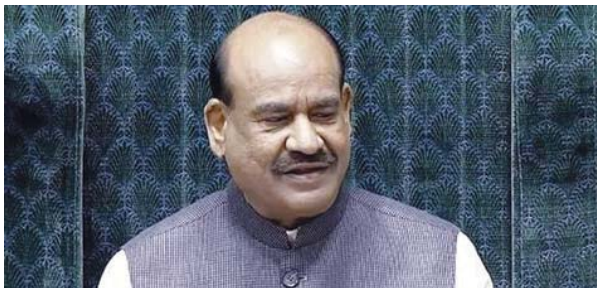
LS Speaker sets September 22 deadline for NCPI MPs on disqualification petitions

PIONEER NEWS SERVICE
■ New Delhi

Lok Sabha Speaker Om Birla on Thursday granted time till September 22 to the 20 MPs of the Nationalist Citizens Party of India (NCPI), following petitions filed by the Mamata-Banerjee-led Trinamool Congress (TMC) seeking their disqualification under the anti-defection law.

The time was granted by the speaker after the NCPI MPs asked for the extended period to reply to his August 26 notices that had sought their responses in seven days.

The speaker has granted time till September 22 to the NCPI MPs to reply to the notices, sources in Parliament said. Birla sent the notices after TMC leader Abhishek Banerjee filed petitions



seeking their disqualification.

The 20 rebel TMC MPs quit the Mamata Banerjee-led party in June following its debacle in the West Bengal Assembly polls and joined the little-known outfit, NCPI.

Birla had served the notices after the Supreme Court on August 25 agreed to hear Abhishek Banerjee's plea seeking an expeditious decision by the speaker on the petitions seeking disqualifica-

tion of the rebel MPs.

A bench comprising Chief Justice Surya Kant and Justices Joymalya Bagchi and V Mohana issued a notice to the 20 MPs on Banerjee's plea, and directed that the disqualification proceedings before the speaker be dealt with expeditiously.

Abhishek Banerjee had approached the top court after filing separate petitions before the speaker in June seeking disqualification of the MPs who

had left the TMC and aligned themselves with the NCPI. The speaker's notices subsequently asked the MPs to submit their responses within seven days. The additional time gives the rebel camp some breathing space as it weighs the legal and political implications of the disqualification proceedings, the sources said.

The MPs are also understood to be seeking legal opinions on the applicability of the anti-defection provisions to their case and the arguments that can be advanced before the speaker.

The dispute over the 20 Lok Sabha seats is the latest flash-point in a broader rupture that has transformed the TMC's internal crisis into a direct institutional and political contest after its defeat in the West Bengal election in May.

Abhishek blames BJP for vandalising his office; 6 held

SAUGAR SENGUPTA ■ Kolkata

The police on Thursday acted swiftly to arrest six people following a pre-dawn attack and vandalism at the office of Trinamool Congress general secretary Abhishek Banerjee.

The vandalism took place in the small hours of Thursday when masked men entered the TMC leaders office at posh Camac Street from where they took away valuables like mobile phones, and other electronic equipment Banerjee alleged accusing the "BJP goons" for the attack.

The BJP promptly denied involvement in the incident saying the saffron party was not like the TMC and never used such filthy ways. "We are not a party of thieves like the TMC dozens of whose leaders are presently in jail... We fight from the front and not take recourse to such



dirty acts ... BJP is by no means linked to this attack," party MLA Sajal Ghosh said.

Earlier accusing the BJP for the vandalism Banerjee said "what happened at camac street this morning was a disgraceful attack on rule of law ... no political party or group of armed hooligans can be above law," demanding strictest action against those who were involved in the attack.

Demanding the resignation of Chief Minister Suwendu

Adhikari for "failing to maintain rule of law" he said, "where during the rule of a Government the sanctity of a political is attacked like this then that Government has no authority to stay in power... He (Adhikari) must resign... This is not democracy... This is political thuggery."

Banerjee had been under tremendous pressure from the BJP facing 16 FIRs against his name since the new Government came to power.

The Thursday's incident came days after the TMC workers led by Banerjee and another party MP Derek O'Brien allegedly got involved in a scuffle with the members of Kolkata Police when a team raided his party office for removing some unauthorised constructions. Both Banerjee and O'Brien have been summoned by the police for questioning in the case.

West Bengal CM warns fund cut if schools do not sing Vande Mataram

SAUGAR SENGUPTA ■ Kolkata

Bengal Chief Minister Suwendu Adhikari on Thursday warned the Government aided schools of the State of losing their grants if they tried to stonewall the complete rendition of Vande Mataram in their respective institutions saying his Government would not allow the agenda of the Left and the Trinamool Congress to continue during his era.

Thanking providence for a timely change in the political leadership in the State but for which the educational system in Bengal would have become the one like Islamic republic of Bangladesh he said, there were some schools who were objecting to the full rendition of Vande Mataram but "I have told them that if they do not follow the Government guidelines then the aid would stop... They

NHRC flags ads on Meta over promoting child abuse content

PIONEER NEWS SERVICE
■ New Delhi

The NHRC has taken cognisance of reports alleging that paid advertisements displayed on a social media platform, owned and operated by Meta, promoted or facilitated access to child sexual abuse material (CSAM) in India, officials said on Thursday.

The National Human Rights Commission (NHRC) has sought specific, point-wise reports within two weeks from the Ministry of Information and Broadcasting (MIB), the Ministry of Electronics and Information Technology (MeitY) and the Delhi Police commissioner, according to the proceedings of the case dated September 3.

"MeitY shall specifically confirm compliance with



Section 19 of the POCSO Act, 2012, or, in case of non-reporting, state the reasons and identify the responsible officer/authority. The above issue shall not be left to a general or omnibus response on intermediary compliance and shall be answered specifically, supported by contemporaneous records," the proceedings said. There was no immediate response from Meta Platforms.

Nation Focus



India's economic growth blends with heritage: Giriraj Singh

Union Textiles Minister Giriraj Singh addressed industry leaders and global delegates at the inaugural imm India 2026 in the national Capital highlighting India's rise as a trusted global manufacturing and sourcing hub.

He said India's resilience through COVID-19 and sustained GDP growth reflect strong policy foundations under PM Modi, with the world increasingly recognising India's expanding global economic role.

Beyond numbers, he said, India's growth follows a "development with heritage" vision, pairing modern infrastructure with its handlooms, crafts and heritage, backed by rising domestic consumption and exports. An India-first approach, he added, will drive India toward becoming a developed nation by 2047.

(PNS)



Defence Minister Rajnath Singh during the release of India's 'RAKSHA' document on defence diplomacy

PTI

Rajnath Singh unveils blueprint for defence diplomacy

Defence Minister Rajnath Singh on Thursday released 'Raksha' – a strategic blueprint on defence diplomacy which carries a "comprehensive framework" outlining India's strategic roadmap and vision for global partnerships over the next decade.

"As defence diplomacy is a core pillar of India's foreign policy, this document provides a clear, actionable vision for the next decade, ensuring that India remains an anchor of peace, stability, and rule-based order in an evolving global landscape," the defence ministry said.

The document marks a shift in India's strategic engagement, aligning national security objectives with proactive global cooperation, fostering long-term stability and mutual growth, it said. Rajnath Singh released the 'Raksha' document on defence diplomacy in New Delhi.

(PNS)

Goa to provide 3 free LPG cylinders to citizens annually

PIONEER NEWS SERVICE
■ Panaji

Goa Chief Minister Pramod Sawant on Thursday announced that the state Government will provide three LPG cylinders free of cost annually to beneficiaries in the state by crediting Rs 3,000 every year into their bank accounts from September 9. He said that forms to avail the benefit of this scheme will be made available at panchayats and with MLAs from September 5.

Addressing an event in Panaji, the CM said the scheme was part of the promise made by him during the 2022 state assembly elections, in which he had assured to provide three free LPG cylinders to people. "From September 9, beneficiaries will start getting Rs



3,000 annually into their bank accounts. The financial assistance would enable eligible beneficiaries to meet the cost of three LPG cylinders under the scheme," he said.

Those residents of Goa who fill up the forms and submit the required documents will start receiving the amount into their bank accounts, he added.

Beneficiaries will have to submit copies of their bank passbook, Aadhaar card and voter identity card to avail the benefit, Sawant said.

Hindutva influencer accused in Jantar Mantar assault boasts links to Kapil Mishra

PIONEER NEWS SERVICE
■ New Delhi

Opposition parties and the Cockroach Janta Party on Thursday targeted the BJP after a video surfaced in which self-styled Hindutva influencer Swatantra Bhardwaj — accused of attacking a student agitator's father during the July protest at Jantar Mantar — purportedly claimed that a phone call from Delhi minister Kapil Mishra helped him avoid jail.

Leader of Opposition in Lok Sabha Rahul Gandhi questioned the lack of action against Bhardwaj, asking Prime Minister Narendra Modi and Union Home Minister Amit Shah why the influencer enjoyed their "protection". In the video, Bhardwaj is heard speaking about his attack on Sanjay Kumar, father of protester Nishu Azad.

"I cracked the skull of



Nishu's father. Do you know which section this crime attracts? Section 307. He needed 60 stitches. The man was being taken away in an ambulance in a serious condition. His daughter was standing outside the police station and saying that she would die by suicide if her father didn't get justice. But I was not even jailed. The world should know this. I was out and about through the night," Bhardwaj is heard saying in the video.

"I have the blessings of Hanuman. Secondly, Kapil Mishra is my elder brother. They say Kapil Mishra called and I was released. Chirag Paswan is my elder brother. How many leaders do you know? Do you know Modi ji? Modi ji is also my elder brother. I have everyone's support," he says.

PTI reached out to Kapil Mishra and Chirag Paswan for their response, but received no response. In the evening, Delhi Police took to

microblogging site X to claim that Kumar sustained a head injury from a kada (bangle) during a scuffle.

"On 23.06.2026, at Jantar Mantar, during the CJP protest, Sanjay Kumar (38), a resident of Ghaziabad, sustained a head injury by Kada worn by one of the alleged during a scuffle.

"He was medically examined by doctors of RML Hospital, and the injuries were opined to be simple in nature. The injuries were made by kada and not by any weapon. The misinformation regarding crack in skull is not supported by facts/MLC and is completely baseless," a post on the official X handle of DCP New Delhi read.

It said a case was registered at the Parliament Street police station on Kumar's statement.

"They were detained from the site and during investi-

gation, Suraj Kumar (24) and Swatantra Bhardwaj (21) were served notices as per law and were interrogated. Due legal action has been taken, and chargesheet would be filed before the competent court soon.

"Any allegation of undue influence or interference in the matter is factually incorrect and baseless. The matter has been dealt with strictly in accordance with law and procedures," the post further read.

Around the time the police issued its statement, Bhardwaj posted a picture of himself on Instagram showing his kada, with the caption "Feel the power!"

Opposition parties, including the Congress, Aam Aadmi Party (AAP) and the Trinamool Congress (TMC) came out in support of the student protester and slammed the BJP Government.

North Odisha flood situation grim; 373 villages inundated



PIONEER NEWS SERVICE
■ Bhubaneswar

The flood situation in north Odisha remained grim on Thursday, even as water levels in major rivers showed a receding trend after inundating parts of Balasore, Jajpur and Mayurbhanj districts, officials said. The Subarnarekha, which inundated 214 villages across five blocks of Balasore district — Bhograi, Ballapal, Basta, Remuna and Jaleshwar — was flowing above the danger mark but showed a falling trend, they said.

Don't walk out, hear my reply on Monday: TN CM Vijay challenges Opposition DMK in House

PIONEER NEWS SERVICE
■ Chennai

Tamil Nadu Chief Minister C Joseph Vijay on Thursday threw down the gauntlet to the opposition DMK in the Assembly, asking its members to remain in the House on Monday for his detailed reply to their allegations, rather than stage a walkout. Intervening during a debate, the Chief Minister requested Speaker JCD Prabhakar to elicit a firm promise from the DMK members that they would remain in their seats throughout his address.

Assuring a comprehensive response, Vijay said he would provide a clear and point-by-point explanation to every question raised by the opposition during the ongoing session. The exchange came amid a heated debate on the state administration's handling of law and order, where the Leader of the Opposition Udhayanidhi Stalin sought to corner the



Tamil Nadu Chief Minister Joseph Vijay speaks during the state Legislative Assembly session, in Chennai on Thursday

PTI

ruling TVK Government.

Leading the charge, Udhayanidhi Stalin questioned the TVK's frequent critiques of the previous DMK administration's handling of drug proliferation.

Pointing to current administrative decisions, the DMK leader argued that if the previous regime's drug control efforts had truly been ineffective, the present Government would not have promoted two senior police officers who headed those very departments during the DMK's tenure. He specifically named the two IPS officials.

He alleged that there was a rise in POCSO (Protection of Children from Sexual Offences) cases in the state, and also an increase in crimes, and highlighted that his Government established special committees and standard operating procedures (SOPs) to support victims and ensured swift justice.

Regarding drug enforcement, he questioned why certain police officers who served during the previous DMK rule were promoted to high-ranking positions by the current TVK Government if their previous efforts were

allegedly insufficient.

Immediately, the Chief Minister got up from his seat and remarked, "Honourable Speaker, for all the questions raised by the honourable members, I will provide a clear explanation when I come on Monday. Even if I am not here, I will receive information about who is asking what questions. I will provide a clear answer to everything. I have one request through you — no one should get up and run away."

Resuming his speech, Udhayanidhi Stalin levelled several allegations against the TVK Government, especially its handling of democratic protests and student dissent. Especially, suppression of protests such as the anti-NEET demonstrations at Marina Beach, alleged political interference, and remarked "we expected the Chief Minister to respond. But he said he would reply on Monday and walked out of the House."

War of words in Manipur Assembly over killing of four Naga civilians

PIONEER NEWS SERVICE
■ Imphal

The ruling and opposition members in the Manipur assembly on Thursday engaged in a war of words over the killing of four Naga civilians in Kangpokpi district in May. Replying to a query, Home Minister Govindas Konhoujam said four suspects had been arrested in connection with the incident.

Asked about allegations by several Naga civil society organisations and legislators that cadres of the Kuki National Front (P) and its leader, who is the husband of Deputy Chief Minister Nemcha Kipgen, were involved in the killings, Konhoujam said there was no concrete information regarding it. "There is no concrete information on whether KNF (P) was involved in the killings or

not," he said. Konhoujam said the case was being investigated by the NIA.

"NIA is a premier agency in the country. We also pursue the case with them from time to time. We will try to ensure that justice is delivered. Anyone involved would be dealt with as per the law. As of now, there has been no communication from the agency on the matter," he said. Responding to the home minister, Congress MLA K Ranjit Singh said, "Please, work hard," and added, "Let's hand over the Government to NIA."

Chief Minister Y Khemchand Singh also intervened, saying allegations made in public and findings of an investigation were two different matters. "There was pressure that the village chief of Leilon Vaiphei be arrested for his alleged involvement in the killing.



GAIL Gas Limited
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NOTICE FOR HIRING OF CONTRACTORS FOR CGD PROJECT

GAIL Gas Limited intends to engage experienced contractors/agencies through an On-the-Spot Walk-In Selection Process for execution of DPNG LMC/GI and MDPE Laying Works in the Puri-Ganjam-Nayagarh, Saraikele-Kharsawan & West Singhbhum, Mirzapur-Chandauli-Sonbhadra, Sonipat and Sundergarh-Jharsuguda Geographical Areas (GAs).

The Walk-In Selection Process shall be conducted as per the schedule given below:

Geographical Area (GA)	Scope of Work	Date & Time
Puri-Ganjam-Nayagarh Saraikele-Kharsawan & West Singhbhum Mirzapur-Chandauli-Sonbhadra Sonipat	DPNG LMC/GI Works	08.09.2026, 09.09.2026 & 10.09.2026, 10:30 AM to 5:30 PM
Puri-Ganjam-Nayagarh Sundergarh-Jharsuguda Saraikele-Kharsawan & West Singhbhum	PE Laying Works	

Venue: Conference Room, 3rd Floor, GAIL, Gas Limited, GAIL Jubilee Tower, B-35/36, Sector-1, Noida – 201301 (U.P.)

Eligibility & Documents Required

Interested bidders are required to submit relevant supporting documents, including but not limited to, Work Experience Certificates/Completion Certificate, Registration Certificate, PAN Card, PF Registration Certificate (wherever applicable), ESI Registration Certificate (wherever applicable), Details of available manpower, machinery, and equipment required for execution of the works.

The bidder shall submit a copy of at least one work order awarded during the last seven (07) years as proof of experience in execution of PNG connection/pipeline-related works in the gas, water supply, drainage, telecom, or any other utility sector for GAIL/GAIL Gas and/or their Group Companies, or for any other company.

The Walk-In Selection Process is scheduled to be conducted over the above-mentioned three days. However, if the selection process concludes earlier, no requests for submission of bids from bidders will be entertained thereafter.

Detailed Terms & Conditions: Available at <https://gailgas.com/eoi/express-intent>.

Contact Persons:

- Mr. Arnab Samanta – arnab.samanta@gail.co.in | Mobile: 7055515333
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- Mr. Saksham Gupta – saksham.gupta@gail.co.in | Mobile: 998092246
- Mr. Anil Kumar – anil.kumar1@gail.co.in | Mobile: 7763807378

Important Note: Any corrigendum, addendum, clarification, or amendment to this Notice shall be hosted only on the GAIL Gas website. Interested bidders are therefore advised to visit the website regularly for updates.

Corporate Identification Number: U40200DL2008GOI178614

■ States Focus ■



PM PAYS TRIBUTE TO UTTAM KUMAR ON BIRTH CENTENARY

Prime Minister Narendra Modi on Thursday paid rich tribute to Bengali film legend Uttam Kumar on his birth centenary, saying his timeless performances connect with people across generations. Born on September 3, 1926, Uttam Kumar, whose original name was Arun Kumar Chattopadhyay, died on July 24, 1980.

“Mahanayak Uttam Kumar... A legend whose timeless performances connect with people across generations. Tributes on his birth centenary,” Modi said in a post on social media.

The prime minister also shared part of his August 30 radio address ‘Mann Ki Baat’ where he described Uttam Kumar as a versatile actor who became deeply embedded in people’s hearts through his performances. (PNS)



VP TO LAUNCH NEW FACILITIES AT PANJAB UNIVERSITY

Vice President CP Radhakrishnan will inaugurate various facilities at Panjab University in Chandigarh on Friday. The vice president is also ex officio Chancellor of the University.

A statement from his office on Thursday said during the visit, Radhakrishnan will inaugurate the Advanced Instrumentation Facility at Sophisticated Analytical Instrument Facility/Central Instrumentation Laboratories.

He will also inaugurate the Panjab University Tech Innovation Forum, marking a major step forward in strengthening the university’s research, innovation and startup ecosystem. (PNS)

Himalayan disaster plan reviewed after Nepal floods

PRAMOD KUMAR SINGH
■ New Delhi

With the unprecedented floods in Nepal sounding a warning for India, Union Home Secretary Govind Mohan on Thursday reviewed the preparedness of the Himalayan States and Union Territories against the risks posed by Glacial Lake Outburst Floods (GLOFs) and snow avalanches. During the meeting, he took stock of early warning systems, monitoring of vulnerable glacial lakes and snow-covered areas, identification of high-risk locations and flow paths, timely dissemination of alerts, evacuation preparedness, and strengthening of response mechanisms.

The message from a high-level review chaired by the Home Secretary was blunt: scientific warnings must no longer sit in files. Institutions that monitor glaciers, lakes and slopes already generate data. The gap, officials said, is the speed with which those

alerts reach district administrations, hydropower operators, road agencies and communities living downstream.

Gaps in early-warning networks and evacuation routes must be identified. Officials said gaps in early-warning systems and evacuation routes need to be found now, not after another disaster. Fixes should not be delayed until the next monsoon or winter.

The Centre issued a clear order to Himachal Pradesh, Uttarakhand, Sikkim, and Arunachal Pradesh, which are part of the National Glacial Lake Outburst Flood Risk Mitigation Programme approved in 2024, to speed up the project. 2023 South Lhonak disaster in Sikkim, when a massive rock collapse into a glacial lake generated a displacement wave that tore down the Teesta valley, destroying a major hydropower dam and settlements. Two years later, officials say progress on monitoring stations, lake-lowering works, downstream warning



Residents pull a newly installed zipline to help people commute across the Trishuli river in the aftermath of flash floods at Bidur in Nepal’s Nuwakot district, Nepal on Wednesday

PTI

systems and community training has been uneven.

The floods in Nepal on August 26 highlighted the dangers in the region. When a glacier collapsed near the border, it sent water rushing down the Bhote Koshi and Trishuli rivers. The flood destroyed bridges, roads, hydropower tunnels, and entire hillsides. Rescue teams are still looking for bodies, and thousands of people remain missing. Rivers flowing into Bihar and Uttar

Pradesh rose rapidly, putting Indian border districts on alert. By the time the flood reached the plains, its worst effects had faded. However, the same geological risks, warming trends, and downstream dangers exist on the Indian side too.

There are about 7,500 glacial lakes in India’s Himalayan region. National agencies have marked nearly 200 as high-risk. The most dangerous lakes are in Himachal Pradesh, Sikkim,

Magnitude a problem but society moving towards inclusivity: KCND president

PIONEER NEWS SERVICE
■ New Delhi

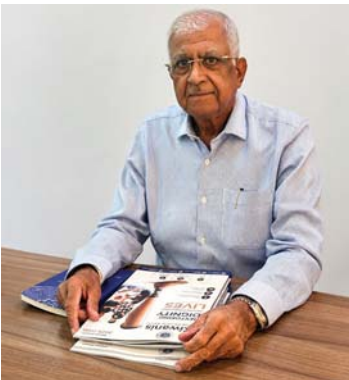
At a time when the nation’s view has been affected by Prime Minister Narendra Modi and the international fraternity changing the description of handicapped to the differently-abled, affecting the attitude of the society towards such citizens, one may be surprised that a healthcare non-Governmental organisation — Kiwanis Club of New Delhi (KCND) has been doing this for the affected and those in need for nearly five decades free of cost.

In an exclusive interaction with *The Pioneer*, KCND president and former managing director of Sakata Inx (India), Vijay Kumar Seth shared his experience of making a difference and the challenges that the nation still faces while progressing gradually towards a better situation.

Speaking about the organisation, Seth said, “A number of achieve

ers including former generals, senior Government officials, industry leaders and subject experts from various fields have been working in this organisation.

The KCND has been working mainly for providing artificial limbs free of cost- to more than one lakh persons so far, pain management/physiotherapy and cerebral palsy assistance. Reputed institutions like AIIMS also refer patients to us. We have a team of dedicated skilled professionals whose passion to work and do something for the society has enabled us to hold camps with the army too. We hold about half a dozen camps in association with the army in border regions of Jammu and Kashmir and Rajasthan especially for those who have lost their limbs due to mines or enemy fire. The KCND focuses on all aspects for those needing artificial limbs, cerebral palsy assistance and pain management help. We



facilitate speech, behavioural and cognitive skills training for patients in need along with teaching their parents too. Our efforts are aimed at restoring the dignity of those who have lost hope and enabling them to lead better lives,” he said.

Regarding factors which lead to situations needing artificial limbs, he said that the problem is big in

magnitude when it comes to factors like road accidents or awareness of health conditions like cerebral palsy. The solution cannot be left to the Government alone as the public being aware and acknowledging its obligation towards safety and factors to prevent such situations is also important. “A positive change in social behaviour and awareness is vital to address such issues. The KCND engages with institutions including the IITS and colleges to raise awareness and elicit positive action on these aspects. The positive change that we all want to experience can be affected by education- it starts there. Incorporating empathy, awareness and more facts in education will lead to improvement. For example, in Japan, the kids are taught from the start in schools to respect those who are not equal due to physical and other aspects and this strengthens social values which benefit the

society as a whole,” Seth said.

Regarding the funding for such activities, he said that voluntary donations from members and funds received under Corporate Social Responsibility play a major role. The organisation is presently working on a 3-D printed artificial limbs project which will cost about ₹25-30 lakh. “The usual artificial limbs are not very comfortable due to various factors so we are working on 3-D printed artificial limbs which will be much more comfortable and practical for the users,” he said,

Having been in the hub of the corporate sector for about five decades, Seth said that he is fuelled to do this work, as is his team, by the motivation to make a positive change in the lives of those who have little hope. Changing a life riddled with hopelessness and helplessness into one filled with hope and empowerment is what Seth and his team are motivated by.

ED strikes southern drug money trail in four-State sweep

PRAMOD KUMAR SINGH
■ New Delhi

The Enforcement Directorate (ED), on Thursday, launched a coordinated money-laundering offensive across Tamil Nadu, Karnataka, Telangana and Kerala, treating narcotics trafficking as a financial enterprise rather than a string of isolated street crimes.

Teams simultaneously covered about 30 premises under the Prevention of Money Laundering Act (PMLA), converting predicate drug cases into a hunt for proceeds, properties and overseas linkages that keep the trade alive.

The geography of the searches mapped the southern supply chain. In Tamil Nadu, teams moved through Chennai, Tirunelveli, Nagapattinam, Velankanni and Ramanathapuram-urban distribution points as well as coastal districts long associated with sea-borne consignments.

In Karnataka, searches

covered Kolar, Malur in Kolar district and Hoskote in Bengaluru North.

In Telangana, the action reached Serilingampally, Nanakramguda and other parts of Ranga Reddy district around Hyderabad. In Kerala, officials searched premises in Kozhikode, Kannur, Malappuram and Thrissur. Inland supply pockets, metropolitan retail hubs, and coastal transit points were treated as a single financial map.

Officials said the Directorate’s case rests on about eight First Information Reports and linked chargesheets filed by state police units and the Narcotics Control Bureau (NCB). Those files concern separate trafficking episodes that investigators now view as connected through money flows. The substances under scrutiny include methamphetamine, marijuana and MDMA.

The networks, officials said, involve more than two dozen Indian and foreign nationals



and show cross-border linkages to Sri Lanka and certain West Asian countries. That mix of synthetic drugs, cannabis and party drugs, plus overseas counterparts, points to a hybrid trade that uses southern India both as a market and as a transit zone. Once a scheduled offence under the Narcotic Drugs and Psychotropic Substances (NDPS) Act is established, the PMLA allows investigators to examine whether the resulting income was concealed, layered or projected as legitimate wealth.

Searches are designed to recover documents, digital

devices, property papers, bank trails and other material showing how drug money was parked in real estate, businesses, cash holdings or informal channels. Early accounts of Thursday’s action did not list confirmed seizures.

Officials indicated that findings would emerge as teams completed searches and analysed recovered material. The timing reflects a larger policy shift. The operation has been placed within the Union Government’s Nasha Mukti Bharat Abhiyan and the enforcement plan set out in the Ministry of Home

Affairs’ Vision Document on Narcotics Control for 2026-2029. That document treats financial disruption as central to narcotics control.

It calls for intelligence-led operations against inter-state and transnational cartels, mandatory financial investigations in major drug cases, the attachment of illicit assets, tighter precursor controls, and stronger coordination among the NCB, state police, customs, and financial agencies. Thursday’s multi-state sweep is an operational expression of that doctrine: Strike several linked files at once, follow the money across state borders, and treat foreign linkages as part of the same case.

Southern India has become a high-priority theatre for this approach. Tamil Nadu’s coastline has repeatedly featured in consignments bound for Sri Lanka. Kerala’s urban and coastal districts have seen MDMA and other synthetics enter student and nightlife

markets. Karnataka’s peri-urban belt around Bengaluru has seen an increase in inquiries for manufacturing and warehousing, Hyderabad and adjoining Ranga Reddy localities have been associated with organised retail of ganja.

By covering all four states in one day, the Directorate is signalling that these will no longer be handled as separate local problems. The investigative logic is simple. Trafficking generates cash that must be hidden. Cash is converted into property, vehicles, firms, hawala transfers, bank deposits or digital assets. If that conversion can be proved, assets can be attached even after the original drug seizure is complete.

Foreign nationals and West Asian, as well as Sri Lankan, linkages raise the further possibility of inbound and outbound value transfers, which investigators typically examine through banking records, travel histories, and informal remittance patterns.

Senior IPS officer Jag Mohan appointed Special Director of IB

PIONEER NEWS SERVICE
■ New Delhi

Jag Mohan, a senior officer of the Indian Police Service (IPS), was named Special Director of the Intelligence Bureau (IB) on Thursday. Mohan, an Indian Police Service (IPS) officer from the 1995 Bihar cadre, is now serving as Additional Director in the IB.

A statement from the Personnel Ministry said that the Appointments Committee of the Cabinet had approved Mohan’s appointment as Special Director, IB, until his superannuation on 30 June 2031. The Special Director General (DG) level has also been assigned to his other five classmates in their respective organisations.

Sandeep Khirwar and Rajesh Kumar have now been appointed as Special Deputy Generals in the Central Reserve Police Force (CRPF); at present, they hold the position



of Additional Directors General (ADGs) in the same force.

Puneet Rastogi and Satosh Shriramaji Khandare will now hold the position of Special DG in the Border Security Force (BSF); at present, they are both serving as ADGs in the BSF.

Padmakar S Ranipse, who is the ADG of the Central Industrial Security Force (CISF), has been appointed as Special DG in the force.

BJP alleges AAP leaders settling rape cases for bribes

PIONEER NEWS SERVICE
■ New Delhi

The BJP on Thursday accused AAP national convenor Arvind Kejriwal, Punjab Chief Minister Bhagwant Mann and his wife of running an alleged corruption syndicate through middlemen in the state to settle rape cases in exchange for bribes of up to ₹5 crore, calling it the “AAP loot model”.

The allegations come in the backdrop of the National Human Rights Commission (NHRC) ordering an inquiry into a complaint that Mann’s wife Gurpreet Kaur allegedly demanded ₹5 crore to quash a rape case.

The NHRC on August 21 directed the Punjab chief secretary and director general of police to inquire into the allegations and submit an Action Taken Report (ATR) within two weeks.

Addressing a press conference here, BJP national spokesperson Pradeep Bhandari played purported audio recordings of the alleged middlemen and cited other evidence, claiming the involve-



BJP national spokesperson Pradeep Bhandari

ment of Mann, his wife, and Kejriwal, whom he described as Punjab’s “super CM”.

“The audio recordings that we are going to play before you, and the evidence that has come before us, point towards the fact that Punjab Chief Minister Bhagwant Mann is running a new loot racket and a new corruption racket,” Bhandari said.

“In this corruption racket, allegations are that he and his wife, through middlemen, are seeking bribes of up to ₹5 crore to get legitimate rape cases settled,” he alleged.

Bhandari alleged that middlemen have been deputed across Punjab on the instructions of the chief minister and his wife to facilitate such deals.

“The chief minister and the wife of the chief minister have deputed middlemen across Punjab. These middlemen, on the instructions of the chief minister and his wife, have innovated a new model of corruption, which we call the Aam Aadmi Party’s ‘loot model’, in which these middlemen are taking bribes of ₹5 crore to settle rape cases,” he further alleged.

Referring to one alleged rape case, he played recordings that he claimed established the charge.

“The middleman is speaking to a relative of the accused and saying that we have also informed ‘CM sahab’ about this and now CM sahab has also become

involved,” he alleged. He also questioned Kejriwal’s alleged role in the purported racket.

“Does the chief minister and his wife run a syndicate in which they are taking bribes and money to withdraw rape cases?” he said.

“Has the chief minister’s office become a syndicate of corruption?” Bhandari asked. “Has the Aam Aadmi Party’s ‘loot model’ now become a model in Punjab where money is being taken for rape cases, just like the corruption and loot model of the ‘Sheesh Mahal’ in Delhi?” he asked.

Referring to the NHRC ordering probe, Bhandari said, “On August 21, 2026, the National Human Rights Commission, taking cognisance of this matter, has already written a letter to the Chief Secretary of the Punjab Government and the Punjab DGP.”

“It has asked to investigate whether the chief minister’s office and the chief minister himself are running a corruption racket in Punjab in which bribes of ₹5 crore are being offered to withdraw cases of rape victims,” Bhandari said.

NCPCR rescues over 3,800 children from child labour under a special campaign

PIONEER NEWS SERVICE
■ New Delhi

The National Commission for Protection of Child Rights (NCPCR) launched a special “Pan-India Rescue and Rehabilitation” Campaign on 12 June 2026, which continued up to 31 August 2026. NCPCR undertook coordinated measures with the concerned State Governments/UT Administrations, District Magistrates, Labour Department, Police authorities and other stakeholders to intensify the identification, rescue and rehabilitation of children engaged in child labour and those vulnerable to trafficking and exploitation.

According to a press release, the NCPCR issued communications to the concerned authorities requesting intensified and targeted rescue operations at child labour and trafficking hotspots, including factories, brick kilns, construction sites, hotels/dhabas, workshops, markets, railway stations and other vulnerable locations.

States/UTs were also requested to furnish regular State-wise and District-wise data on rescue operations, children rescued, FIRs



registered, rehabilitation, restoration, educational mainstreaming, compensation and other follow-up measures.

To monitor implementation and address field level issues, the NCPCR conducted meetings with the District Administrations of 227 districts, across the country.

The meetings focused on reviewing rescue operations, addressing operational bottlenecks, ensuring timely

submission of ATRs and strengthening coordination among the concerned departments and agencies.

Where the requisite information was not received within the stipulated period, the NCPCR issued reminder communications to the concerned authorities.

The NCPCR also undertook awareness and outreach through social media and other communication platforms, disseminating information regarding the campaign, reporting of child labour and the importance of rehabilitation and educational mainstreaming following rescue. With sustained and proactive monitoring of above campaign, NCPCR in collaboration with state authorities successfully rescued over 3,800 children. Further, over 575 FIRs have been registered during the Campaign.

While most of the State Governments participated enthusiastically in the campaign, Uttar Pradesh reported the highest number of children rescued, with 1,480 children, followed by Rajasthan with 804 children and Gujarat with 630 children.

Bihar reported 183 children rescued, while Andhra Pradesh reported 147 children rescued.

Ladakh gets 7 autonomous hill development councils

MOHIT KANDHARI ■ Jammu

Moving one step closer towards decentralisation and strengthening of grassroots governance in Ladakh, the Lieutenant Governor, Vinai Kumar Saxena, on Thursday approved the notification for the creation of seven Ladakh Autonomous Hill Development Councils (LAHDCs).

The Centre, on 13 July 2026, had announced the creation of new LAHDCs in the UT of Ladakh. With the approval, Ladakh Autonomous Hill Development Councils (LAHDCs) will now be extended to all seven districts of Ladakh, namely Leh, Kargil, Sham, Nubra, Changthang, Zaskar and Drass.

The framework of elected local self-governance, which was earlier limited to Leh and Kargil, will thereby also be extended to the five newly created districts in the UT.

The formal announcement was made by the Office of the LG Ladakh in a post on X. "Today, I have approved the notification for the creation of Ladakh Autonomous Hill



Development Councils (LAHDCs) in all 7 districts in the Union Territory.

This landmark move follows the historic creation of five new districts — Sham, Nubra, Zaskar, Drass, and Changthang in April this year, and the Centre's subsequent decision to extend LAHDCs to all 7 districts, on 13 July."

In the same post, LG Ladakh, while thanking PM Narendra Modi and Home Minister Amit Shah, noted that the momentous decision will decentralise and strengthen local governance, ensure true autonomy for our local bodies, and fulfil

the long-standing aspirations of our people, at the grass-roots level.

With the notification in place, the process for elections to these councils shall begin in due course. "I am confident this would empower Ladakh and its people to chart its own path of progress and inclusive development. It reaffirms our collective resolve for building a stronger, developed and more empowered Ladakh. I congratulate every citizen of Ladakh on this historic occasion", LG Saxena said.

Local leaders and civil

society groups have welcomed the step, viewing it as a significant movement toward democratic decentralisation and administrative empowerment of the cold desert region.

The development marks a significant step towards decentralisation and strengthening of grassroots governance in Ladakh.

The creation of the new councils will provide institutional mechanisms for greater participation of people in matters relating to the development and administration of their respective districts.

The notification issued by the Revenue Department, UT of Ladakh, says the elections to the newly constituted Councils will be held in due course after a formal notification is issued under Section 8 of the Ladakh Autonomous Hill Development Councils Act, 1997.

The notification will come into force from the date of its publication in the Official Gazette, an official spokesman said.

NTA taps AICTE to build test centres for NEET-UG

PIONEER NEWS SERVICE

■ New Delhi

The National Testing Agency (NTA) has asked the All India Council for Technical Education (AICTE) to collect information from Government institutions on their IT infrastructure and available space to develop testing centres for computer-based examinations for NEET-UG next year, officials said.

The AICTE has further asked its affiliated Government institutes to provide details of their available information technology infrastructure and vacant or unutilised spaces for an assessment related to the establishment of Standard Testing Centres (STCs) across the country.

"The centres of CBT cannot be outsourced to small private players and have to be chosen after assessment on strict parameters. AICTE, being the technical education regulator, has a lot of tech colleges which are equipped with the infrastructure," a senior NTA official said.

The move comes amid the ongoing overhaul of the NTA — the nodal



autonomous body that conducts NEET-UG and other entrance tests for higher educational institutions — after the paper leak earlier this year.

Following the paper leak, which led to nationwide outrage, the Centre announced that the medical entrance exam, NEET-UG, will be conducted in CBT mode from 2027 instead of a pen-and-paper-based test.

"NTA conducts various national-level exams in CBT mode. With the progressive migration of examination

modes and the requirement for a wider geographically distributed network of testing centres, NTA is assessing the availability of suitable infrastructure in Government institutions across the country," the AICTE said in a letter to heads of institutions.

AICTE has clarified that the information is being sought only from Government colleges and institutions that have received approval from the council. The institutions have been directed to ensure that all details sub-

mitted are accurate, complete and properly verified by the competent authority concerned before submission.

The technical education regulator has also shared a format with the institutions, asking them to provide details of the number of functional computers available and other IT infrastructure, networking and internet connectivity, availability of power backup, CCTV and related facilities. Details about vacant space have also been sought.

India, Belgium hold defence talks, agree to deepen ties

PIONEER NEWS SERVICE

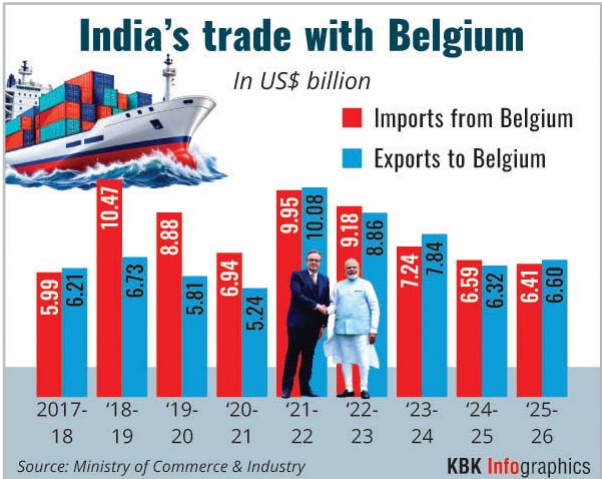
■ New Delhi

India and Belgium reviewed the entire spectrum of their bilateral defence ties here on Thursday during talks between Defence Minister Rajnath Singh and his counterpart Theo Francken.

Giving details, the defence ministry said the two leaders agreed to expand relations through defence cooperation dialogue, high-level visits, training and capacity building.

Both leaders also discussed issues of regional peace and security and acknowledged the need for maritime security collaboration in the Indo-Pacific. They reiterated that the partnership between India and Belgium is based on shared values of mutual trust and respect. Rajnath Singh said the two countries have the potential to further expand their partnership amid a period of "great geopolitical and economic turmoil" globally.

"The world is witnessing a time of great geopolitical and economic turmoil. Most of it is not our doing, but we have to handle the chal-



lenges. In such situations, meeting a friend and partner like you provides a useful opportunity to exchange views and perspectives," he said. The Defence Minister underlined that the recently held India-Belgium Strategic Dialogue had provided a framework for taking the bilateral partnership forward, including in the areas of defence and security.

Rajnath Singh noted that there was significant potential to further expand defence

cooperation between the two countries, particularly by strengthening engagement between their defence industries. He also expressed optimism that the discussions during the meeting would provide strategic direction to bilateral defence engagements.

The meeting was conducted on the sidelines of a meeting between Prime Minister Narendra Modi and Prime Minister of Belgium Bart De Wever.

Over 520 *kanals* of migrant land retrieved in Kashmir, 12,000 grievances logged

PIONEER NEWS SERVICE

■ Jammu

Over 520 *kanals* of land belonging to Kashmiri migrant property holders have been retrieved and secured under Superdari or handed over to the original owners between January and July 2026.

Chief Secretary Atal Duloo, who reviewed the quality and disposal of grievances lodged by Kashmiri migrant property holders across all ten districts of the Kashmir Division on Thursday, was informed that between January and July 2026, a total of 522 Kanals and 15.9 Marlas of migrant land were retrieved and secured under Superdari or handed over to the original owners.

Among the ten districts of Kashmir, Bandipora emerged as one of the leading districts with retrieval of 146 Kanals and 7 Marlas, followed by Baramulla with 82 Kanals and 10 Marlas, Kulgam with 80 Kanals and 0.5 Marlas, Ganderbal with 53 *Kanals* and Srinagar with 50 *Kanals* and 16.9 Marlas.

During the comprehensive review, the Chief Secretary was informed that



the Online Migrant Grievance Portal (RRCM) has so far registered 12,223 complaints, covering various categories of violations, including 5,341 encroachment cases, 2,874 trespassing cases and 442 cases relating to record tampering. Of these, 10,038 cases have been closed by the District Magistrates, while 7,605 cases have received final approval through the RRCM mechanism.

The administration has also instituted an independent Telephonic Quality Verification mechanism through the office of the Divisional Commissioner, Kashmir, to assess the quality of disposal of cases shown as closed. Of the 4,918 appli-

cants successfully contacted during the verification exercise, 4,605 expressed satisfaction with the disposal of their cases.

The remaining grievances have been flagged for further administrative scrutiny and necessary remediation.

The meeting was attended by Principal Secretary, Disaster Management, Relief, Rehabilitation & Reconstruction (DMRR&R), Chandraker Bharti; Secretary, Revenue; Divisional Commissioner, Kashmir; Deputy Commissioners; Relief Commissioner (Migrant), besides senior officers of other concerned departments.

The Chief Secretary direct-

ed the Divisional and District Administrations to ensure quality, thorough and time-bound disposal of every grievance, with particular emphasis on cases pending for long periods. He stressed that every complaint must be examined comprehensively and decided strictly on merit, ensuring satisfactory resolution for the concerned property owners.

Calling for greater use of technology in the management and protection of migrant properties, the Chief Secretary directed the remaining districts to expedite completion of geo-tagged inventories of migrant properties. He observed that comprehensive digital inventories would provide a reliable asset database and strengthen monitoring, protection and management of such properties.

The review also highlighted a series of institutional and technology-driven reforms introduced to improve transparency, monitoring and accountability. The districts of Baramulla, Ganderbal, Kulgam and Kupwara have completed geo-tagged digital inventories of migrant properties,

providing a comprehensive technology-enabled mechanism for identification and monitoring of such assets.

The administration has further strengthened direct engagement with migrant property holders through grassroots outreach camps. Dedicated Additional Deputy Commissioners conducted extensive public outreach camps at Jammu during the first quarter of 2026, through which 1,878 complaints were received directly and 484 offline grievances were brought onto the unified digital platform.

The meeting was also apprised of the reforms introduced following the implementation of a revised Standard Operating Procedure (SOP) from October 2025, resulting in complete migration of the process to the e-Office platform.

The streamlined mechanism has enabled disposal of 129 complex alienation cases in the last 11 months, as against 6,258 cases processed during the preceding 28 years, reflecting a significant improvement in the efficiency and responsiveness of the system.

MP officials Anurag Jain, Vivek Aggarwal to be speakers at Global Fintech Fest 2026

SARMAN NAGELE ■ Bhopal

Prime Minister of India Narendra Modi, Union Minister Jyotiraditya Scindia, Former Chief Secretary of Madhya Pradesh and NITI Aayog CEO Anurag Jain, Vivek Aggarwal, Secretary, Ministry of Culture & Vice President, FATF, Govt of India, will share their thoughts at the Global Fintech Fest 2026.

This event marks the first time a leader and two bureaucrats from Madhya Pradesh have been invited as speakers.

Anurag Jain, an officer of the 1989 batch of the Indian Administrative Service (MP Cadre) and former Chief Secretary to the Govt of MP, became the Chief Executive Officer of NITI Aayog - making him the first bureaucrat from the MP cadre to hold this position.

Similarly, Vivek Aggarwal, an officer of the 1994 batch of the IAS (MP Cadre) and currently serving as Secretary in the Ministry of Culture, Govt of India, is the first officer from the MP cadre to be elected as the Vice-President of the Financial Action Task Force.

This is the first time anyone from India has held the position of FATF Vice-President.

Both officers from the MP cadre are set to participate in the GFF 2026 under this year's central theme: "Trusted, Connected, Global Systems for Inclusive Finance," with a special



Vivek Aggarwal



Anurag Jain

focus on AI, Tokenization, and Quantum Technology. The world's largest event in financial and technological innovation, the GFF 2026, will be held from Sept.8 to 11, 2026, at the Jio World Centre and Trident BKC in Mumbai.

It is being organized by the Payments Council of India, Fintech Convergence Council and leading partner organizations. The core theme reflects a commitment to building a robust and fair financial ecosystem globally.

Agentic AI: This next phase of AI will enable autonomous orchestration of financial workflows. It will provide highly personalized and precise services to customers at scale while enabling real-time financial risk monitoring and fraud detection without human intervention.

Tokenization: Through this technology, all types of

assets -whether public, private, physical, or digital — can be made programmable and divisible. Instant and secure cross-border transfer of these assets on Global infrastructure will elevate financial inclusion to new heights.

Quantum Computing: Redefining financial security, optimization, and complex calculations at a fundamental level, quantum technology will drastically scale processing power, enabling solutions to intricate financial problems within seconds.

Global Policy Dialogue and the Vision for Inclusive Finance

The central highlight of GFF 2026 is fostering global cooperation, policy alignment, and financial inclusion. The presence of policymakers, regulators, and central bank representatives from across

the globe turns this platform into a hub for international regulatory dialogue.

GFF 2026 is set to mark a major milestone for the global fintech ecosystem.

By bringing together startups, investors, policymakers, and tech leaders, the festival lays the foundation for a future where financial systems are more secure, reliable, and accessible to every global citizen. Armed with strong fintech prowess, India is positioned to lead this new global wave.

As Madhya Pradesh CM Dr Mohan Yadav notes, the state works by applying lessons learned directly from the Prime Minister.

With PM Narendra Modi participating in GFF 2026 for the third consecutive time to highlight a decade of UPI, Chief Minister Yadav could also leverage this opportunity to evaluate MP's standing in the fintech ecosystem.

Special attention could be given to using emerging fintech innovations and models for the upcoming Simhash Mahakumbh 2028.

The CM could tap into the experience of both officers from MP by creating a specialized task force under the state Finance Minister.

By attending the GFF 2026 studying the global fintech ecosystem, and showcasing the state's strengths, this task force could attract investors and tech innovators — establishing a strong presence for MP in the fintech sector.

BJP accuses Jharkhand CM Hemant Soren, Rahul Gandhi of corruption in exam contract

PIONEER NEWS SERVICE

■ New Delhi

The BJP on Thursday accused Jharkhand Chief Minister Hemant Soren and Congress leader Rahul Gandhi of corruption in awarding a contract for conducting public examinations in the state.

The Jharkhand Government on August 18 cancelled 22 recruitment examinations and ordered probes into 23 others conducted since 2014 by the Jharkhand Public Service Commission (JPSC), Jharkhand Staff Selection Commission (JSSC) and outsourced agency TDPL, amid a prolonged student agitation over alleged irregularities.

Addressing a press conference here, BJP national spokesperson Pradeep Bhandari alleged that a black-listed company, TDPL, was given responsibility of conducting public examinations by the Jharkhand Government, which subsequently outsourced the work to Picker Technology without a formal tender process.

"You all know that students protested in Jharkhand, and the entire country stood with those students. But the painful part is that as investigation progresses, it is emerging that TDPL, which is a blacklisted company, was given the entire responsibility of conducting the examination by the Jharkhand Government," Bhandari said.

He alleged that TDPL did not even issue a tender and out-



sourced examination-related work to a "shell company" — Picker Technology — without a formal agreement.

"No tender was issued, no bidder was called to conduct the examination, and the agency to which you gave the tender, which we all know was blacklisted, outsourced it to a third agency called Picker Technology. All the dealings in this regard had nothing to do with formal bank transaction. Everything was done in cash," he said.

Bhandari claimed the entire arrangement is prima facie a case of "quid pro quo" and targeted Rahul Gandhi and Hemant Soren alleging corruption in conduct of the examinations. "This is a prima facie case of quid pro quo. And the buck

stops with the chief minister of Jharkhand, which is Hemant Soren," he said.

"And we ask Rahul Gandhi, where is your moral ground today?" Bhandari jibed, saying these revelations raise serious questions about how Gandhi and Soren are "delivering justice to students". He also questioned the alleged involvement of ministers and officials, saying if cash dealings took place, "the money must have gone somewhere".

Bhandari said the allegations are based on a statement made before the Jharkhand CID, claiming that the director of Picker Technology admitted there was no copy of the tender and that the transaction was carried out in cash. He asked

Gandhi and Soren to clarify the Government's stand.

Stating the charges, Bhandari said, "First, we all know that Chief Minister Hemant Soren and Rahul Gandhi gave the tender to a tainted company. Second, because there was no tender in writing, did some corruption money change hands between any Jharkhand minister or the chief minister?"

He also questioned how the contract was awarded to Picker Technology without issuance of a formal tender. "Why was the tender not issued? Did any call come from the chief minister's office or any minister saying that you should give this contract to Picker Technology without issuing a formal tender?"



Editor's
TAKE

Overshoot: The climate warning

The United Nations' stark warning comes as climate disasters linked to the melting Himalayas are causing an immediate human and regional security crisis

This week, the United Nations delivered a verdict scientists have long feared but stopped short of declaring outright: the 1.5°C ceiling set by the Paris Agreement will be breached "within the next few years," not decades. The UN Environment Programme's first "overshoot" report does not ask how to avoid crossing that line - it assumes we already have, and asks instead how briefly and how narrowly the world can stand on the other side. Secretary-General António Guterres called it what it is: humanity, he said, is "speeding past the limit to avoid climate catastrophe."

That the world can still return below 1.5°C by the end of the century, as the report insists, is true. That doing so now requires halving emissions by 2035 and hauling billions of tonnes of carbon back out of the sky - after a decade of broken promises since Paris - is the harder headline.

Nepal did not need a UN report to know this. As UNEP's scientists finalised their charts, rescuers in Rasuwa were still pulling bodies from mud left by a glacier collapse that sent flash floods down the Bhotekoshi-Trishuli river system on August 26. Nepal's death toll has crossed 1,100; nearly 4,500 people remain missing across Nepal and Tibet; a newly forming lake threatens to repeat the flood that burst from the first one. Reporting since suggests warning signs were visible before the glacier gave way.

This is not an abstraction. This is overshoot with a body count. India cannot watch from a distance. The Bhotekoshi feeds into the Trishuli, the Narayani and the Gandak - the river system that put Bihar and Uttar Pradesh on flood alert, and that reportedly carried some of Nepal's dead across the border into India. But Delhi does not need its neighbour's tragedy to see its own risk. Germanwatch's 2026 Climate Risk Index places India ninth among nations hit hardest by extreme weather over three decades - 80,000 dead, a billion affected and \$170 billion lost. Government data shows extreme weather struck India on 99 per cent of days in 2025 alone. One independent study projects that eight in 10 Indians will face high exposure to extreme events by 2036 - a decade away, not a century.

The way forward runs on two tracks, and India must walk both. Globally, it means using whatever leverage remains - at climate negotiations and beyond - to push for the emissions cuts and finance that make a short, shallow overshoot possible rather than a long, brutal one. Regionally, it means what Nepal's tragedy has made urgent: real-time glacial and river monitoring shared across the Himalayas, joint early-warning systems with Nepal and China, and hard investment in floodplain and mountain infrastructure at home - before the next warning is missed, not after.

The situation is grave, but not irretrievable. The UN's own report insists 1.5°C remains recoverable if action starts now. But it is grave enough that India, sitting downstream of a melting Himalaya and inside the world's most climate-battered belt, cannot afford to treat this as someone else's emergency.

India's steel sector and decarbonisation

India's new greenhouse gas emission intensity targets for the iron and steel sector mark a significant step towards industrial decarbonisation. The facility-specific approach recognises technological diversity, while robust monitoring, financial support and stronger compliance will be crucial for success

GOPAL K SARANGI, SUHANI YADAV AND SHUBHI GOEL

There are compelling reasons why the iron and steel sector has become a critical experimental ground for India's compliance carbon market. The steel sector constitutes a critical sector of importance to the economy and positions India as the second-largest crude steel producer globally. Importantly, the steel sector is under policy scrutiny due to its heavy dependence on coal-based production routes and the energy-intensive nature of ironmaking. High carbon intensity has put the sector under stress in the emerging context of global environmental trade measures such as the Carbon Border Adjustment Mechanism (CBAM). Given the strategic importance of India's steel exports, decarbonisation of the steel industry is no longer a policy choice but an implementation necessity for its business viability. The challenge, therefore, is not whether India should produce more steel, but how it can produce more steel with progressively lower emissions.

GEI targets for the iron and steel industry under CCTS

In this context, the recent notification of the emission intensity targets for the iron and steel industry under India's Carbon Credit Trading Scheme (CCTS) merits a deeper examination of its emissions implications for such a critical sector. Greenhouse gas emission intensity (GEI) targets, built on the mechanism of emissions per tonne of equivalent product, are very much in alignment with the developmental aspirations of the country. This strategic approach is designed considering the economic reality of India's developmental trajectory, where absolute emissions reduction could jeopardise the much-needed industrial expansion of the country. An intensity-based approach instead seeks to improve the carbon efficiency of every additional tonne of steel produced, allowing economic development and climate action to advance simultaneously. The framework, therefore, attempts to reconcile two objectives that are often portrayed as competing priorities: sustaining industrial growth while steadily reducing the carbon footprint of production.

The inherent design principles of GEI for the iron and steel sector, based on the facility-specific emission intensity targets, appear to be fitting to the sectoral context, characterised by a large degree of heterogeneity in many operational aspects. India's steel industry is far from homogeneous in its use of technology, fuel and other critical aspects of functioning. Integrated blast furnace-basic oxygen furnace plants, coal and gas-based direct reduced iron (DRI) units, electric arc furnaces (EAFs), induction furnaces, ferro-alloy producers, and rolling mills differ substantially in their production routes, energy sources, raw materials and



AS INDUSTRIES ADAPT TO EMISSIONS REPORTING AND INTENSITY TARGETS, FUTURE COMPLIANCE CYCLES ARE LIKELY TO INTRODUCE MORE AMBITIOUS BENCHMARKS, BROADER SECTORAL COVERAGE, AND A MORE ACTIVE MARKET FOR CARBON CREDIT CERTIFICATES

Gopal Krishna Sarangi is Associate Professor, Department of Policy and Management Studies, TERI School of Advanced Studies. Suhani Yadav is a researcher, Parijata Earth Foundation, New Delhi, and Shubhi Goel is the Founder and CEO, Parijata Earth Foundation, New Delhi

emissions profiles. Hence, applying a uniform emissions benchmark across such diverse technologies would impose a disproportionate compliance burden on facilities. Facility-specific targets instead recognise technological diversity and firm-specific heterogeneities while ensuring that every facility contributes to the sector's decarbonisation journey according to its operational realities. By bringing 255 obligated entities under the CCTS, the government is extending the compliance framework across a substantial share of India's steel sector rather than limiting it to a pilot initiative. Collectively, these facilities account for approximately 149 million tonnes of equivalent product output and 359 million tonnes of CO₂-equivalent baseline GHG emissions based on FY 2023-24 data. According to the proposed targets, the framework could deliver an estimated 20 million tonnes of CO₂-equivalent emissions reductions by FY 2026-27, representing roughly a 5.6 per cent production-weighted improvement in emission intensity. More importantly, the notification marks the gradual evolution of India's industrial climate policy in tune with the overarching goal of 'Viksit Bharat' by 2047.

MRV becomes the key

The real innovation, however, lies not in the numbers themselves but in the institutional architecture governing the GEI. Effective carbon markets are built on trust in reliable and credible emissions data. Facility-specific baselines, transparent methodologies, and robust measurement, reporting and verification (MRV) systems form the foundation of any credible emissions trading mechanism. Without them, carbon credits risk becoming accounting exercises rather than drivers of genuine emissions reductions. Establishing consistent MRV systems across hundreds of facilities with diverse technologies and operational practices will require institutional capacity-building, integration of

digital reporting systems, development of technical expertise, independent third-party verification, and strong regulatory oversight.

Beyond domestic policy, the notified GEI targets carry important international implications. Export-oriented industries are facing growing pressure from investors, multinational buyers, and regulators to demonstrate transparent carbon accounting and measurable emissions reductions. Besides, mechanisms such as the European Union's CBAM indicate that carbon intensity will increasingly shape access to global markets. Improving emissions performance is therefore becoming an economic necessity rather than merely an environmental responsibility. The facility-specific GEI targets, while offering considerable flexibility and reflecting the operational realities of sectoral emissions, could create distinctive impacts for the MSME sector. Many small and medium-sized facilities may face higher compliance costs associated with emissions monitoring, reporting systems, process improvements, and technology upgrades. Without complementary measures such as technical assistance, capacity-building programmes, and targeted financial support, the transition risks widening the competitiveness gap within the sector. Ensuring that decarbonisation remains inclusive will therefore be essential to the long-term success of the framework.

The GEI targets should also be viewed as the beginning rather than the culmination of India's carbon market journey. As industries adapt to emissions reporting and intensity targets, future compliance cycles are likely to introduce more ambitious benchmarks, broader sectoral coverage, and a more active market for Carbon Credit Certificates. The credibility established during this initial phase will therefore determine the effectiveness of future market expansion and India's ability to position carbon markets as a central pillar of industrial climate policy.

This Teacher's Day, give teachers their time back



SAKSHI SETHI

2ND OPINION

Every few months, schools seem to discover something new that instructors must do: a fresh report, another portal, photographs from an activity, updated data, responses to messages and much more. Individually, each request sounds perfectly reasonable. Collectively, they are quietly changing the profession.

With Teacher's Day approaching, educators are frequently honoured as foundational mentors who guide future generations. Nonetheless, a more crucial question is how much of their daily time is genuinely allocated to teaching. A regular school day is a never-ending balancing act for teachers. A teacher walks between classes while juggling a slew of obligations, including tracking a troublesome pupil, remembering an ill child, grading notebooks or assignments, com-

pleting reports and notifying parents. Even the regular lunch break rarely provides relaxation. Instead, teachers use this time to help children, monitor corridors and playgrounds, manage playground conflicts and organise future activities. By the time these immediate responsibilities are completed, the break is over and the next bell rings. The unopened lunch box merely demonstrates a common systemic issue: the belief that a teacher's time is endless. Technological improvements have hastened this expectation.

Although parent communication and administrative efficiency are critical, the convenience of digital messaging has created an expectation of a fast response. As a result, professional responsibilities extend well beyond dismissal. Furthermore, the modern emphasis on compliance paperwork has reached a crucial point where documenting educational achievements actively undermines their delivery. It is teachers who photograph activities, upload evidence, maintain records and prepare reports. Yet some of the most important work in a classroom is precisely what cannot be photographed. Nobody documents the moment when a teacher notices that a normally talkative child has become unusually quiet.

There is no portal entry for the extra explanation that prevents a ten-year-old from deciding, 'I am bad at maths.' No photograph captures a teacher choosing to correct a child privately because public embarrassment

might stay with the child longer than the mistake. These are small decisions. They are also education.

This is why teacher wellbeing should not be treated merely as a workplace benefit. A teacher's attention is part of a child's learning environment. So are patience, preparation and emotional energy. When these are constantly fragmented, the cost does not remain in the staffroom. It eventually reaches the classroom. This is not an argument against accountability. Teachers must be accountable. Parents deserve communication. Schools require systems and records.

However, successful systems should allow teachers to teach more effectively rather than making them busier proving that they have taught.

Perhaps this Teacher's Day, we should avoid expecting teachers to do more. Instead, school officials, policymakers and even parents might address a more difficult question: Which aspects of a teacher's workload truly benefit a child's education, and which have just become routines that we no longer question?

While presents, flowers and speeches on September 5 are well-deserved, the most effective way to thank a teacher is to give them the time and mental peace they need to focus on their children.

The writer is an educator and a counsellor

LETTERS TO THE EDITOR

SCO summit: India's uncertain win

Apologies of the editorial, "SCO Summit: A Win for India in Bishkek" (*The Pioneer*, September 3), the summit cannot yet be described unequivocally as a win for India or other participating nations. Its long-term consequences will become clear only with time. The editorial's concluding observation that "what New Delhi does with it will decide whether this was a turning point or one more ritual repeated on schedule" rightly captures the uncertainty. The larger questions before the international community remain peaceful coexistence, human values and improved living standards. Global groupings such as the G20, G7, Quad, BRICS, NATO and the European Union often appear more focused on national interests than on addressing these concerns. Major powers, including Russia, China and the United States, continue to pursue competing strategic interests.

India, too, needs greater clarity, consistency and diplomatic foresight. Its distinguished role in the Non-Aligned Movement under Jawaharlal Nehru remains a reminder of the influence principled diplomacy can bring. The government must also address questions of accountability over intelligence failures and terrorism. As John C. Maxwell aptly observed, "A leader is one who knows the way, goes the way and shows the way."

PK SHARMS | PUNJAB

US green card queue tightens

Indian professionals face fresh uncertainty in the US green-card queue, with the State Department warning that the employment-based EB-1 category could become unavailable within weeks because of heavy demand. In its September Visa Bulletin, the State Department said demand from applicants chargeable to India could exhaust the country's EB-1 allocation before the US fiscal year ends on September 30. For September, the EB-1 India final action date is October 15, 2022. If the allocation is exhausted, the category could become unavailable until additional visa numbers become available under the applicable annual limits. The situation is even tighter in EB-2, which covers professionals with advanced degrees and people of exceptional ability. EB-2 India remains unavailable in September, after also being listed as unavailable in August.

The EB-3 queue is also heavily backlogged. India's EB-3 final action date is January 1, 2014, leaving many applicants waiting more than 12 years for their priority dates to become current.

The latest warning highlights the intense pressure on Indian applicants, driven by high demand and statutory limits on employment-based immigrant visas.

G DAVID MILTON | MARUTHANCODE

Teachers deserve our highest respect

Every year, we celebrate Teachers' Day on September 5 to honour the revered status of the guru in our lives.

This reminds me of a personal experience shared by one of my relatives, who was a teacher and later retired as a principal. He once said that he used to visit the district collector to teach his son.

One day, when he reached the collector's bungalow, he noticed the collector walking around the lawn while his son was sitting there. On seeing my relative, the collector rushed to open the gate, took his bicycle and placed it in its proper place.

Surprised by the gesture, my relative hesitantly asked, "Sir, what are you doing?" The collector softly replied, "Sir, I am a collector today because of the guidance of teachers like you. I also never want my growing son to believe that his father holds a higher position in society than his teacher. He must always respect you."

Such examples truly celebrate the contribution of teachers to our lives and careers.

Former President S Radhakrishnan, whose birthday falls on September 5, similarly believed that teachers should be remembered for their contribution to shaping our personalities, values and future.

SUNIL OKHADE | INDORE

Daiv Vani

WISDOM FOR A MEANINGFUL LIFE

The Unlikely Journey of a Birth

Krishna - Teacher, Guide and the one most revered as God in our tradition did not arrive into the world the way we might expect greatness to begin. Consider the strangeness of the story before we even reach the Gita's teachings. A child born in a prison cell, in the dead of night, to parents who could not keep him, facing the possibility of death the moment he was born. Carried across a flooding river in secrecy, raised far from where he began, in a home that was never meant to be his. For people like us, such a start would raise doubts, not hope. We understand its greatness only later, when extraordinary work begins with something even less than ordinary circumstances. And yet, from that uncertain, displaced start came the Teacher who gave Humanity one of its most complete philosophies of living - The Bhagavad Gita, a life manual still read and leaned on, thousands of years later, on battlefields far removed from Kurukshetra.

Perhaps that is the real miracle of Janmashtami - greatness arriving not through comfort, but through displacement and uncertainty. If your own beginning felt uncertain or far from where you imagined that is never a proof that greatness isn't still possible. Sometimes, it's the very journey it takes.

Happy Krishna Janmashtami!

-DAIV

The green advantage: Why sustainability could decide the future of India’s MSMEs

Given the scale and contribution of the MSME sector, the sustainability of India’s growth will depend, in no small measure, on the sustainability of its small businesses. The green transition is undoubtedly a challenge, but it is also one of the great industrial opportunities of the next decade



SHISHIR PRIYADARSHI

Then, just before confirming the order, the European buyer sent a new set of questions. What was the carbon footprint of the product? How much renewable energy did the company use? Could it trace its raw materials? How was its waste managed? The company had no ready answers.

There was nothing wrong with its product, quality, price point or delivery record. Yet, for the first time, none of these seemed sufficient. The company had not suddenly become less efficient, but the rules of competition had simply changed. Versions of this story are likely to become increasingly common. For millions of Indian MSMEs, sustainability is moving from the margins of business strategy towards its centre. Increasingly, in global supply chains, the evolving question is whether they can produce responsibly, transparently and sustainably. This is not merely an environmental issue. India’s MSME sector is simply too important to be left behind. MSMEs account for over 30 per cent of India’s GDP, around 35 per cent of manufacturing and close to half of the country’s exports. The green transition of Indian MSMEs is therefore not a niche sustainability agenda. It is a question about the competitiveness of a substantial part of the Indian economy.

From obligation to business strategy

The biggest mistake would be to present sustainability to an MSME as yet another cost of doing business. If approached purely as compliance, it will inevitably look like a burden. A small enterprise operating on narrow margins may have to collect new data, change processes, or invest in equipment. It is therefore understandable that entrepreneurs ask: where is the return?

A more important question is: what is the cost of not becoming more sustainable? For an MSME, sustainability can mean very practical things: using less electricity, reducing material waste, using water more efficiently, improving logistics, reducing packaging and adopting cleaner technologies. These are not merely environmental improvements; they are improvements in productivity. Every kilowatt of energy saved reduces operating costs. Every kilogram of material wasted represents money spent without generating revenue. The green transition is therefore also an efficiency transition.

This is where the conversation needs to change. Sustainability should not be sold to Indian MSMEs primarily as an act of environmental virtue, but as a strategy for becoming a better business. When companies eliminate waste, improve resource productivity and redesign production processes, they reduce emissions while lowering costs and strengthening competitiveness. The choice is not between growth and sustainability. It is between old models of growth and a more efficient model of growth suited to future markets.

The new passport to global markets

For decades, Indian exporters competed on a familiar formula: price, quality and delivery. But a fourth dimension is becoming increasingly important: sustainability and traceability. Global buyers increasingly demand transparency regarding raw materials, energy sources, carbon footprints and labour standards. For Indian MSMEs, this represents both a risk and an extraordinary opportunity. Enterprises failing to meet evolving sustainability standards risk exclusion from high-value supply chains as buyers tighten requirements. This may not happen overnight. But as buyers tighten their standards, suppliers unable to demonstrate credible sustainability performance could lose business to those that can.

That matters enormously for India, whose development strategy increasingly depends on manufacturing and exports. But there is also a significant opportunity. Indian MSMEs are already highly competitive in engineering, textiles, pharmaceuticals, food processing, electronics and a range of other sectors. If these enterprises can become more resource-efficient, transparent and sustainable, they can position themselves for the next genera-

For fifteen years, a small engineering company in Pune had done everything right. It supplied precision components to a European buyer on time, met exacting quality standards, and remained competitive on price. The relationship was strong, and the next purchase order seemed routine.



tion of global supply chains. Ultimately, sustainability is no longer a separate environmental agenda — it is becoming a core export strategy. Global commerce has evolved from asking, ‘Can you make it cheaply and reliably?’ to ‘Can you make it responsibly, transparently and sustainably?’ The MSME that learns to answer that question early could gain a significant first-mover advantage — access to premium markets, global supply chains and longer-term relationships with major buyers. Waiting until compliance becomes mandatory, expensive and urgent is rarely a good business strategy.

Making sustainability affordable

There is, however, a genuine concern. If sustainability becomes synonymous with complex reporting, expensive consultants and layers of compliance, it could create a new competitive barrier — one that large corporations can cross much more easily than smaller enterprises.

Indian MSMEs need ESG intelligence

A small enterprise should not have to produce a 200-page sustainability report. It should be able to answer simple questions: How much energy am I consuming? How much water? How much material am I wasting? Where are my biggest inefficiencies? What do my customers expect? Which improvements will save me money? The objective should be simple, affordable and actionable tools that help MSMEs make better business decisions rather than generate more paperwork.

Technology can increasingly make this possible. Digital energy-management systems, emissions calculators, supply-chain platforms and resource-efficiency tools can bring capabilities once available only to large companies within the reach of smaller enterprises. But technology alone will not be enough. India needs an ecosystem involving government, industry associations, financial institutions, technology providers and large corporations.

Government can establish common standards, simplified measurement frameworks and sector-specific templates. Financial institutions must provide affordable green finance to help smaller companies invest in energy-efficient equipment, while large companies must help build greener supply chains through technical expertise, common standards, transition periods, and access to finance and technology. Sustainability should not become another barrier to entry. It should become a ladder helping Indian MSMEs climb into higher-value domestic and global supply chains.

The race to 2030 starts now

For an MSME wondering where to begin, the starting point need not be complicated. First, measure energy, water and material waste, as it is impossible to manage what cannot be measured. Second, identify key inefficiencies where environmental performance and economics overlap. Third, set measurable targets for energy reduction, waste minimisation and renewable adoption. Fourth, engage with buyers to understand upcoming sustainability expectations. Finally, invest in data-driven digital tools and AI to optimise operations.

India’s journey towards Viksit Bharat requires rapid economic growth, but also growth that is more efficient, resilient and globally competitive. Given the scale of the MSME sector, the sustainability of India’s growth will depend significantly on the sustainability of its small businesses. The green transition is one of the great industrial opportunities of the next decade. The Indian MSMEs that lead in 2030 may not be those that simply produce more cheaply. They are likely to be those that produce better, cleaner, smarter and more sustainably.

That is the real competitive advantage the green transition can create. The question for Indian MSMEs, therefore, is not whether they can afford sustainability. The real question is whether, in the markets of tomorrow, they can afford to be without it.

INDIA HAS SET ITSELF VERY AMBITIOUS EMISSION REDUCTION TARGETS FOR 2030. THE INDIAN MSMEs THAT THRIVE DURING THIS PERIOD OF GREEN TRANSITION WILL PROBABLY NOT BE THE COMPANIES THAT SPEND THE MOST MONEY ON SUSTAINABILITY. THEY WILL LIKELY BE THE COMPANIES THAT UNDERSTAND THE OPPORTUNITY FIRST AND INTEGRATE SUSTAINABILITY INTO THE WAY THEY RUN THEIR BUSINESSES

The writer is the President of the Chintan Research Foundation

The NE’s drug menace needs a coordinated war



SABIR NISHAT

transported towards Assam through the Imphal-Jiribam National Highway. Preliminary assessment suggests that Cachar and Sribhumí were being used as transit corridors for moving narcotics towards mainland India.

Assam Chief Minister Himanta Biswa Sarma recently highlighted the changing nature of the trafficking routes. Speaking to the press in New Delhi on Wednesday (August 26), he said drug traffickers were constantly looking for new corridors to move contraband.

“For a long time, drugs were coming through Moreh. Now a new corridor has emerged from Myanmar through Changlang to Tinsukia,” Sarma said. He also pointed to the earlier use of the Mizoram-Myanmar and Manipur-Myanmar routes, while noting that the Arunachal Pradesh-Myanmar border had not previously emerged as a major route for narcotics. This changing pattern should concern policymakers. A successful operation can disrupt a particular route, but it does not necessarily dismantle the network behind it. The Northeast, therefore, needs to be viewed not as a collection of separate state-level drug markets and routes, but as a single interconnected trafficking ecosystem.

The latest seizure comes amid a series of significant narcotics recoveries in Assam in recent weeks. Earlier this month, Guwahati Police seized 1.4 lakh Yaba tablets and 10 packets of heroin, collectively valued at around ₹39.4 crore, from a truck near the city’s Inter-State Bus Terminal. Two persons were arrested. Cachar has also witnessed repeated seizures. On August 21, police recovered around 70,000 suspected Yaba tablets weighing about 7.6 kg from a rented premises in South Krishnapur and arrested two brothers. The Narcotics Control Bureau has also recently reviewed the seizure of 80,000 Yaba tablets in Sribhumí, along with other major drug cases in Assam. Taken together, these seizures indicate both the scale of the challenge and the growing importance of Assam as a transit state.

The response now needs to go beyond individual seizures and arrests. Assam, Manipur, Mizoram, Nagaland, Arunachal Pradesh, Tripura and other northeastern states must work within a common anti-narcotics framework, with the Centre and central enforcement agencies providing institutional and technological support. Information about a suspected consignment intercepted in one state should immediately reach police and enforcement agencies in neighbouring states. Similarly, details of known traffickers, vehicles, financiers, safe houses and distribution networks should be shared through a secure, real-time intelligence mechanism. A permanent Northeast anti-narcotics coordination mechanism could bring together state police forces, the Narcotics Control Bureau, DRI, Assam Rifles, the Army, border-guarding forces and other relevant agencies. Such a mechanism should maintain an integrated intelligence grid, identify emerging routes, track repeat offenders and coordinate operations that cross state boundaries.

The emphasis also needs to shift from simply recovering drugs to dismantling the financial infrastructure that sustains trafficking. Every major consignment involves money: financing, procurement, transportation, payments to couriers, local distribution and the laundering of proceeds.

Significantly, Guwahati itself hosted the two-day BRICS Heads of Anti-Drug Agencies Meeting on July 6-7, 2026, bringing the international dimension of the narcotics challenge directly to the Northeast. The summit concluded with the adoption of the Guwahati Declaration, committing member nations to deeper operational cooperation and joint action against organised transnational drug crime. The declaration underscored the importance of timely intelligence sharing, stronger operational cooperation, technology-driven enforcement and coordinated efforts against emerging threats, including synthetic drugs and new psychoactive substances. The significance of the meeting goes beyond its diplomatic symbolism. Drug trafficking is inherently transnational. A consignment can originate in one country, cross several borders, pass through multiple states and eventually reach consumers thousands of kilometres away. No single police force or country can effectively tackle such networks alone.

The Guwahati Declaration should therefore translate into practical mechanisms for information exchange, joint investigations, capacity-building and coordinated action against trafficking syndicates. For the Northeast, this international cooperation is particularly important because of the region’s proximity to Myanmar and the wider Golden Triangle, one of the world’s major areas associated with illicit drug production and trafficking. At the same time, enforcement alone cannot win the war against drugs. Every seizure prevents a quantity of narcotics from reaching the market, but the demand that sustains trafficking must also be addressed. Governments need to strengthen awareness programmes, particularly among young people, while ensuring accessible treatment, rehabilitation and reintegration services for those affected by substance dependence. Schools, colleges, families, civil society organisations and local communities must become partners in prevention. Communities located along vulnerable border and transit areas can also play an important role in identifying suspicious activity and supporting law enforcement. The objective should be to create an environment in which traffickers find it increasingly difficult to operate while vulnerable individuals have access to support before addiction becomes entrenched.

The Northeast’s strategic location has made it vulnerable to international trafficking networks. But the same geography can also make it India’s first line of defence against the narcotics trade.

The ₹168-crore Yaba seizure in Cachar should therefore be treated as a call for a larger, coordinated response. The repeated movement of large consignments through the region shows that the challenge is systemic and cannot be addressed by isolated operations. The Centre and the northeastern states need a unified action plan combining intelligence sharing, coordinated enforcement, financial investigations, border surveillance, technology and prevention. The message from the BRICS meeting in Guwahati is equally relevant at the regional level: criminal networks do not respect borders, and neither should the cooperation of those fighting them.



The writer is Deputy Director, Assam Information Centre, New Delhi



SHARMILA DAS

description. Yoga must make us flexible, strong, slim, toned, youthful and, preferably, photogenic. The more complicated the posture, the more impressive the photograph. If one can fold oneself into an improbable shape while standing on a mountain at sunrise, the internet is suitably impressed.

There is nothing wrong with being strong or flexible. There is certainly nothing wrong with looking after the body. But perhaps we have become so occupied with what the body can do that we have forgotten to ask what the body is trying to tell us.

And that is where Yoga becomes interesting. Because the body does not always ask for another workout. Sometimes it asks us to stop. Sometimes it asks us to breathe.

Sometimes it asks for movement after hours of sitting still. Sometimes it asks for rest after weeks of pushing too hard. Sometimes it tells us, quite unmistakably, that something is not right, and we respond by telling it to try harder.

We are remarkably demanding employers of our

Nobody told us that Yoga would one day become so interested in our six-pack.

Some where along the way, a practice that has existed for thousands of years acquired a rather modern job

own bodies. We tell our legs to walk farther, our backs to sit straighter, our muscles to become stronger, our weight to go down, our heart rate to go up and our minds to remain productive through all of it. We count steps, calories, repetitions, minutes and milestones.

But how often do we simply notice?

After years of teaching Yoga, I have watched people arrive on a mat with very different bodies and very different stories. One person may be looking for strength. Another may be trying to recover movement. Someone else may simply be exhausted. There are those who arrive because their doctor suggested movement, those who arrive because life has become overwhelming, and those who arrive because somewhere inside they know they have stopped listening to themselves. The mat does something rather extraordinary to all of them. It removes the audience. There is no competition with the person on the next mat. There is no prize for reaching the floor first. The body does not care how beautiful the posture looks. It only knows whether it is comfortable, uncomfortable, tense, relaxed, balanced or struggling. And gradually, the practice changes. The question moves from, “Can I do this posture?” to, “What is happening while I am doing it?” That is a profound shift. Yoga does not necessarily ask us to make the body obey the mind. It invites a conversation between the two.

A posture becomes less about achievement and more about awareness. A stretch becomes less about how far we can go and more about whether we can recognise the point at which



enough is enough. Balance becomes an experience rather than an Instagram-worthy accomplishment.

And sometimes, wonderfully, we wobble. We fall out of the posture.

We begin again.

Perhaps that is one of Yoga’s quietest lessons: the body does not have to perform perfectly for the practice to be valuable. The modern world, however, has become very fond of performance. We measure almost everything. Fitness has numbers. Sleep has numbers. Exercise has numbers. Progress has numbers. Even relaxation seems to require a score.

Yoga offers a rather inconvenient alternative. Awareness cannot always be measured. Neither can peace. Nor can the quality of a breath that arrives just when we need it.

This is why the real transformation of Yoga may have very little to do with whether we can touch our toes. Perhaps the person who learns to breathe calmly before responding to an angry

email has practised more Yoga that day than the person who has performed the most spectacular posture. Perhaps the person who recognises fatigue and rests instead of pushing through it has understood something essential.

Perhaps the person who notices that the shoulders have been clenched all morning and consciously releases them has already begun to change a habit that the body had been carrying silently. The body is constantly communicating. Tightness, ease, fatigue, energy, discomfort, steadiness and restlessness are all forms of information. We do not have to obey every sensation. Nor should every discomfort be interpreted dramatically. But we can learn to listen before we react.

That may be one of Yoga’s greatest gifts. It teaches us to replace command with conversation, and conversation requires attention.

This is also why Yoga can be so different from the pursuit of a six-pack. The six-pack is visible. Awareness is not. Muscle can be photographed. A calmer nervous system cannot. Flexibility can be demonstrated. The ability to remain composed when life becomes difficult is much harder to display. Yet perhaps those invisible changes are the ones that stay with us longest.

A Yoga practice may begin with the body, but it need not end there.

We stretch the body and discover patience. We hold a posture and discover resistance. We lose balance and discover humility.

We breathe and discover that we have been holding our breath through more of life than we realised. We become still and discover how noisy

the mind has been. None of these lessons requires a perfect body. In fact, perhaps Yoga becomes most meaningful when we stop asking whether our body looks like someone else’s and begin asking whether we are inhabiting our own body with greater awareness. There will always be another posture to master, another degree of flexibility to achieve and another fitness goal to pursue. There is nothing inherently wrong with any of them.

But perhaps they are not the destination.

Perhaps the real practice is learning to recognise what our body needs and having the wisdom to respond. Because the body is not a machine that exists merely to carry us through an endless list of tasks.

It is our oldest companion.

It has been with us through every celebration, every disappointment, every hurried morning, every sleepless night, every journey and every quiet moment we barely noticed.

Maybe it has been speaking all along. Yoga simply teaches us to listen.

And perhaps the next time we step onto the mat, instead of asking, “How much more can I make my body do?” we could ask a gentler question: “What is my body asking me for today?”

The answer may not be another exercise.

It may be a breath. A stretch. A pause. A little patience. Or simply the permission to be exactly where we are. And perhaps that is where Yoga begins, not when the body performs, but when we finally listen.

The writer is a trained Sivananda Yoga teacher

What if your body isn’t asking you to exercise?



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SC dismisses PIL for re-test of NEET-PG 2026 examination

The Supreme Court on Thursday dismissed a PIL that sought to re-conduct the NEET-PG 2026 exam, as it pulled up and imposed a cost on the petitioner and the advocate for filing such a petition.

A bench of Justices PS Narasimha and Alok Aradhe said it will ask the Bar Council of India to take action against the lawyer for misuse of the process of law.

"It appears this person has become a full-time PIL litigant. Wherever exams are conducted, you go on to file petitions. Why did you file a petition earlier to stay? Is it at your instance or the petitioner really interested in filing it? We will ask the Bar Council of India to take serious action against you," the top court told the lawyer. The petitioner sought re-examination for all students, alleging there was a violation of a May 2025 order wherein the court mandated that the NEET-PG be conducted in a single shift. The bench imposed the cost of Rs 25,000 on the petitioner. The lawyer contended that around 2,500 candidates couldn't complete their exams in Jaipur due to an internal power outage, and the National Board of Examinations in Medical Sciences (NBEMS) later announced a second exam for these candidates, which is set to take place on September 5.

The counsel, appearing for NBEMS, told the court that the petitioners are from Noida and Punjab and were not affected at all by the disruption.

(PTI)

Working on CBSE 3-language policy: Government tells SC

The Centre informed the Supreme Court on Thursday that it was working on its suggestions on implementation of the CBSE's policy mandating the study of three languages, including two native Indian languages, for Class 9 students.

Additional Solicitor General Aishwarya Bhati told a bench comprising Chief Justice Surya Kant and Justices Joydalya Bagchi and V Mohana that CBSE is in the process of working out various modalities and sought time.

The top court took note of the submission and deferred the matter by a week.

Observing that children should not come under pressure, the top court on August 20 stressed the need to find a solution to issues arising out of the CBSE's three-language policy for Class 9 students.

It observed that while there was nothing wrong in introducing the policy, the only concern of the petitioners was the manner in which it was being introduced.

"You may revisit some of these problems. There is no doubt that sooner or later, it has to be introduced; there is nothing wrong with that. But how it is to be streamlined so that whatever impediments or blockades are coming up, you may find a solution to those," the bench had said.

One aspect to be considered was how to build adequate human resource infrastructure for the language options available, it had said.

On May 27, the top court agreed to examine a plea challenging the policy and issued notices to the Centre, the CBSE and the NCERT seeking their responses.

(PTI)



₹157 crore Ozempic scam: Court tightens grip on Vicky Ramancha

RANJIT KUMAR SINHA
■ New Delhi

In the latest judicial development in the multi-million dollar pharmaceutical fraud probe, a Delhi Court has dismissed a criminal revision petition filed by key accused Vicky Ramancha as the investigation moves swiftly to catch his absconding co-accused, Swapnadip Roy. The criminal prosecution stems from an international scam in which a US-based firm, Assure Global LLC, was fraudulently induced to pay \$18,834,382 (approx. ₹157 crore) for 125,000 units of Ozempic — a popular diabetes and weight-loss medication. A complaint filed last year by the US firm alleged that Ramancha, CEO of R & R Global Procurement Corporation, created fraudulent certificates of origin and trade documentation to build credibility, initially making partial deliveries to win trust before escalating to larger fraudulent transactions, duping them into buying Ozempic.

Additional Sessions Judge Syed Zishan Ali Warsi on August 31 upheld lower court orders that directed the Economic Offences Wing (EOW) of the Delhi Police to

Dissent is a democratic right, not a licence for disorder

The Supreme Court has protected genuine protesters—but it has not created immunity for those who misuse a protest for unlawful ends



VIKRAM PACHPUTE

The Supreme Court's decision concerning the recent student protests deserves to be welcomed — not selectively, but in its entirety.

For me, this is not merely a question of the ruling party versus the Opposition, nor should every public protest be viewed through that narrow political prism. As a legislator, I have myself raised several issues of public interest, questioned existing systems and sought corrective action from the Government. On issues affecting ordinary citizens, students, farmers, consumers and public health, I have experienced first-hand that raising an uncomfortable question need not make one anti-Government. More importantly, my party and the Government have supported legitimate issues that I have raised and, in several instances, acted upon them.

That experience has strengthened my conviction that a strong Government need not fear questions; it must have the capacity to listen to them, examine them and act where correction is required.

That is also why I welcome the spirit of the Supreme Court's decision. In a constitutional democracy, students and citizens have every right to disagree with the Government. They have the right to assemble peacefully, raise questions, demand accountability and protest within the framework of the



Constitution and the law.

A young student's entire future should not be destroyed merely because he or she participated in a bona fide, peaceful protest.

But this is only one half of the judgment's message. The other half is equally important.

The Court has not converted the right to protest into a blanket immunity from the law. It has left room for lawful action against persons falling within the category specifically carved out in its order. Therefore, nobody should interpret judicial protection given to genuine protesters as a licence for individuals with ulterior or unlawful objectives to enter a legitimate movement and use students as a shield.

● Protect the student who raises a question.

● Protect the citizen who peacefully dissents.

● But identify and act against the person who enters that crowd to pursue an unlawful agenda.

These principles are not contradictory. Together, they constitute responsible democracy.

This distinction has become increasingly important in our public discourse.

A genuine public grievance can bring thousands of ordinary young people onto the streets. But if a few organised elements exploit their anger, provoke confrontation, encourage violence or attempt to turn a peaceful movement towards an entirely different objective, the greatest victims are often the genuine protesters themselves.

The law must therefore be intelligent enough to distinguish

between the two. A democracy that criminalises every dissenter becomes weak. But a State that becomes helpless merely because unlawful activity takes place under the banner of a "protest" becomes weak too. India should accept neither extreme.

As legislators, we too have a responsibility. Our role cannot be limited to defending every decision of the Government merely because we belong to the ruling side. We are elected first and foremost to represent people.

When a genuine public-interest issue reaches us, we must have the courage to raise it. When the Government responds positively, we must acknowledge it. When correction is necessary, we must pursue it. And when a legitimate public cause is deliberately

hijacked for political, criminal or other ulterior purposes, we must have the courage to say that too. My own experience in public life has convinced me that "constructive dissent and good governance are not opponents; often, one strengthens the other."

The Government must listen. The Opposition must question responsibly. Citizens must be free to protest peacefully. The police must protect peaceful protesters. And those who deliberately cross the boundary of law must remain answerable to law.

The Supreme Court's intervention therefore offers a larger lesson beyond the immediate controversy. Let our young people protest if they believe something is wrong. Let them question us. Let them disagree with us. Governments and legislators should have the confidence to hear them. But let nobody—political organisation, pressure group or individual—believe that the Constitution can be invoked as a shield after deliberately violating the law. The Constitution gives you the right to raise your voice.

It does not give anyone the right to weaponise someone else's voice. That distinction must become the new democratic consensus.

Because ultimately, dissent strengthens democracy when it remains constitutional; those who exploit dissent for unlawful ends weaken both the cause and democracy itself.

The author is BJP MLA from Shrigonda Maharashtra

Delhi High Court restrains TRS leader K Kavitha from making allegations against *The Pioneer*

PIONEER NEWS SERVICE
■ New Delhi

The Delhi High Court on Thursday restrained Telangana Rakshana Sena (TRS) leader K Kavitha from making allegations and imputations that *The Pioneer* newspaper was secretly acquired by her brother KT Rama Rao (KTR). Kavitha recently alleged many times that *The Pioneer* news paper was acquired by her brother for ₹188 crore and the newspaper now reflects the views of the Bharat Rashtra Samithi (BRS). Justice Sachin Datta also restrained many YouTube channels, digital platforms, journalists and publishers from making the similar allegations or amplifying them.

"Considering the circumstances, Defendant Number 1 (K Kavitha) is restrained from publishing, republishing, broadcasting or disseminating in any manner, whether directly or indirectly, the defamatory statement and imputations contained in the plaint or any other content containing



the same or similar allegations against the Plaintiff or *The Pioneer* on any platform. Defendant Number 2-15 are also restrained," ordered Delhi HC.

The Court passed the order while dealing with a defamation suit filed by CMYK Printech Limited, the publisher of *The Pioneer* newspaper. Advocate Saurav Agrawal appeared for the paper and argued that the allegations are false and that the shareholding pattern of the company proved this fact. "There is a sibling rivalry going on. She is saying the paper is controlled by her brother. She is saying her

brother KTR has bought the newspaper," argued Agrawal, initiating defamation case against former MP Kavitha.

He added that the allegations are being amplified by other social media handles and channels, causing even more damage. CMYK Printech has sought ₹11 crore in damages over allegations made by Kavitha that the 160-year-old daily was secretly acquired by KTR and now reflects BRS' views. Kavitha who was Lok Sabha MP from the BRS. She was suspended from the party in September 2025 by her father and party president, K Chandrashekar Rao (KCR), over alleged anti-

party activities. The controversy relates to a live-streamed video Kavitha posted on her YouTube channel on July 9, in which she claimed KTR had purchased *The Pioneer* for approximately ₹188 crore and urged the public to distrust its reporting. CMYK Printech argued that the claims are baseless and that no such transaction occurred. It adds that its shareholding and board records can independently verify this.

It alleged that other defendants, which include a mix of YouTube channels, digital platforms, journalists and publishers, went further than merely reporting Kavitha's statement. The suit states that they presented the alleged acquisition as fact through their own headlines and editorial framing, without independent verification.

Advocate Saurav Agrawal was briefed by Lexster Law's Advocates Shantanu Agarwal, Abhinav Tyagi, Vineeth Penmetsa, Aparna Tiwari, Avisha Agrawal, Vikas Tomar, Prachi Dubey, Anadi Mishra and Vikas Tomar.

Gymkhana Club gets relief till September 16

PIONEER NEWS SERVICE
■ New Delhi

The Centre on Thursday said it would not take any coercive action till September 16 against Delhi Gymkhana Club in relation to its eviction from the 27.3-acre premises on Safdarjung Road. The assurance was given before Justice Avneesh Jhingan, who was hearing pleas by club member Vijay Khurana and others seeking a stay on the June 29 show-cause notice issued by the land and development office (L&DO).

The pleas by Khurana and Delhi Gymkhana Club Ltd Staff Welfare Association form part of their pending lawsuit following the L&DO's May 22 order terminating the colonial-era club's perpetual lease deed and asking it to return its land by June 5 on grounds of "strengthening and securing defence infrastructure". "We will not take any action in a coercive manner. The (earlier) statement continues. We will not take any coercive action (till the next date)," Additional Solicitor General Chetan Sharma said.

Senior advocate Abhishek

favour of the club members are low and that any reply before him must be without prejudice to their case in the high court. The court granted time to the counsel for the plaintiffs to take instructions and listed the matter for hearing on September 16.

The Centre had earlier filed a reply in the High Court, asserting that it has no legal power to restrain the government from taking over the Delhi Gymkhana Club land after the termination of the perpetual lease for the club and issuance of a show-cause notice for eviction by the estate officer.

It was submitted that under the Public Premises (Eviction of Unauthorised Occupants) Act, a civil court's jurisdiction over any suit or proceeding in respect of the eviction is barred and the grant of any injunction in respect of the estate officer's action is also prohibited.

Given that the perpetual lease deed was a bilateral instrument between the Centre and the Delhi Gymkhana Club, a member-who was neither a party nor privy to the agreement -



Singhvi, appearing for Khurana, submitted that the pleadings were complete and the issue of interim stay on the eviction notice was "ripe for hearing". Justice Jhingan, however, said he would keep the matter for arguments on another date and suggested that in the meantime, the members file their response before the estate officer for his consideration.

"What I am intending to do is that before I proceed with it (the interim relief), let him (estate officer) visit this issue... Whether he should proceed, whether he can proceed... Whatsoever comes out of it, we are still here," Justice Jhingan said. "Let the authority apply its mind to the fact that once this issue of jurisdiction itself is pending, should he proceed with the notice or not," he added.

Singhvi said the chances of the estate officer ruling in

cannot independently restrain the authorities from exercising their contractual rights, the Centre had said.

On June 29, the L&DO under the Ministry of Housing and Urban Affairs issued a show-cause notice to the club, asking it to explain why an eviction order should not be passed against it under the Public Premises Act.

The notice, issued by estate officer Bipin Kumar Singh, directed the club and all persons concerned occupying the premises to submit their response by July 7 and appear for a personal hearing on the same day at 2.30 pm. The move came more than a month after the Centre told the Delhi High Court on May 26 that it would not take forceful possession of the 27.3-acre premises of the club, which is required for "strengthening and securing defence infrastructure", by June 5.

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India-NZ FTA may come into force next month: Official

The India-New Zealand free trade agreement is likely to come into force next month, an official said on Thursday. On April 27, the two countries signed the free trade agreement (FTA) to boost the two-way commerce in goods and services and promote investments. The pact will be implemented next month on a mutually agreed date, the official said. The FTA provides duty-free access for 100 per cent of India's exports to New Zealand. Earlier, New Zealand maintained peak tariffs of up to 10 per cent on key Indian exports, including ceramics, carpets, automobiles, and auto components. New Zealand has committed to invest \$20 billion over 15 years. INDIA-CHILE FTA: Both the countries are looking at concluding the negotiations for the pact by next month as the talks are progressing well, the official said. "We are moving towards closure now," the official said adding India is looking at commitments on supply of critical minerals from Chile. Chile has interest in agriculture and horticulture sectors. (PTI)

'India-US BTA to be finalised once US offers preferential rate'

Commerce and Industry Minister Piyush Goyal on Thursday said the details of the Bilateral Trade Agreement (BTA) with the US will be announced once Washington offers preferential terms compared to the country's competitors. "As soon as the US is able to give us the preferential rate in comparison to our competition, we will finalise the BTA and announce the final details," he said at a workshop. He said the free trade agreements finalised by India offer huge export opportunities for domestic businesses. India will conclude more trade pacts in the coming months or years with Canada, Mexico, Chile, Mercosur - a Brazil-led group of countries - the SACU (Southern African Customs Union), South Africa-led group of countries, the GCC (Gulf Cooperation Council), comprising six nations in the Middle East, and Israel, he added. (PTI)

Rupee closes at 94.59 against US dollar

PIONEER NEWS SERVICE
■ Mumbai

The rupee extended its gaining momentum for the fifth straight session on Thursday, appreciating 14 paise to close at 94.59 (provisional) against the US dollar, buoyed by the country's improved balance of payment condition following higher-than-expected foreign currency deposits. India mobilised a record \$127.23 billion through FCNR (B), or foreign currency non-resident (bank) deposits under a special central bank programme aimed at bolstering the country's foreign-exchange liquidity. Including overseas foreign-

Date	Rate (₹ per US \$)	Change
Aug 27	94.45	-0.01
Aug 28	95.43	+0.02
Aug 31	95.22	+0.21
Sep 1	94.73	+0.22
Sep 2	94.95	+0.27
Sep 3	94.59*	+0.14

*Provisional
Source: KBK Infographics

stering the country's foreign-exchange liquidity. Including overseas foreign-

Prioritise indigenous battery storage tech for next phase of growth: Industry leaders

PIONEER NEWS SERVICE
■ New Delhi

Industry leaders on Thursday urged the government to prioritise 'Made in India' battery storage technologies for the next phase of growth at the recently concluded India Energy Storage Alliance (IESA) Chennai Connect 2026. India's clean energy ambitions depend on how quickly the nation can scale up domestic battery storage technologies, an IESA statement said. According to the statement, despite major renewable energy expansion, with India reaching over 283 GW of installed renewable capacity, the country still faces significant technology integration gaps. To meet rising power demand

and ensure grid reliability, India will need 888 gigawatt-hours (GWh) of energy storage capacity by 2035-36, it pointed out. In the recently concluded IESA Chennai Connect 2026, industry experts urged the government to accelerate indigenous battery energy storage system (BESS) research, manufacturing and deployment nationwide. Prof Ashok Jhunjhunwala of IIT Madras stated that in the next 5-7 years, technologies like sodium-ion and long-duration solutions, including iron-air batteries, will play a key role in renewable integration and grid flexibility. "We must focus on domestic manufacturing across battery technologies, power electronics, and the clean-energy supply chain to ensure long-term energy secu-

urity. The next phase is about building a stronger, smarter and more resilient electricity system, not just adding renewable capac-

ity," he added. IESA's summit showcased how Indian innovation and manufacturing could close these gaps.

The Pioneer

NEW DELHI | FRIDAY | SEPTEMBER 4, 2026

Cars will face tougher safety checks from 2027: Gadkari

PIONEER NEWS SERVICE
■ New Delhi

If you're planning to buy a car a couple of years from now, it will have to clear a much tougher safety exam. Union Road Transport and Highways Minister Nitin Gadkari on Wednesday told the 66th Annual Convention of the Society of Indian Automobile Manufacturers (SIAM) that from October 2027, India's car safety-rating programme, Bharat NCAP, will get a major upgrade - one that looks well beyond how a car crumples in a crash. The current Bharat NCAP gives cars a star rating (1 to 5) based on crash tests, like global systems such as Euro NCAP. It already rates over 30

models from 11 manufacturers, and it's cheaper for car-makers to test here - about ₹60 lakh a model versus roughly ₹2.5 crore abroad. Bharat NCAP 2.0 will go further. "We are going to evaluate the entire crash chain," Gadkari said - meaning the test will also judge how well a car helps you avoid a crash, how it protects pedestrians outside it, and how quickly help can reach you afterwards, not just how the cabin holds up on impact. Expect more weight on features like automatic emergency braking and pedestrian-detection systems, with manufacturers asked to bring in newer tech, including from Indian start-ups.

It isn't only cars getting tougher scrutiny. Gadkari said the government is working on a points-based system for driving licences, much like merit-point

systems abroad. Break traffic rules repeatedly and you could lose points, and eventually your licence, while safe drivers could get cheaper insurance or other perks.

Hyundai races to add capacity as demand booms but won't bet on hybrids without price fix: Official

KUSHAN MITRA ■ New Delhi

Hyundai India has brought forward a third production shift at its Talegaon plant by a full 18 months, a sign of just how far demand has outrun the company's own planning. Speaking to this reporter, Hyundai India's Chief Executive Officer (CEO) Tarun Garg said the surge left the company with little choice but to accelerate a shift addition that wasn't originally due for another year and a half. The company's current annual capacity stands at 894,000 units, and Garg said Hyundai expects to cross the 1 million mark by FY30, with planned improvements at both its Chennai and Talegaon facilities. It's a capacity build-out that puts Hyundai squarely in expansion mode as India car sales rocket at a pace to cross the five million mark this fiscal. Diesel holds on, EVs pick up pace Diesel, often written off as a

fading technology in the passenger vehicle market, still accounts for roughly 40 percent of Creta sales, Garg said. At the other end of the powertrain spectrum, Hyundai sold almost 1,000 units of the Creta Electric last month, and Garg pointed to a broader uptick in EV penetration that he linked to the period following the Iran war, a fact corroborated by other manufacturers including EV sales leader Tata Motors. Garg also said Hyundai is preparing to launch a "born

electric" B-segment SUV - a vehicle built on a dedicated EV platform rather than an adapted ICE one - before the end of the current fiscal year. And will be "very competitively priced." The hybrid math doesn't add up yet - and Hyundai isn't waiting on Delhi to fix it The most pointed part of the conversation concerned hybrids. Garg confirmed Hyundai has both plug-in hybrid (PHEV) and range-extender EV (REEV) technology in its portfolio, and he was

unambiguous about where he thinks the sweet spot lies: PHEV, he said, is "the best of both worlds." But that technical enthusiasm comes with a commercial caveat. Garg said Indian buyers are simply not willing to absorb the price gap between a conventional ICE vehicle and a hybrid - whether a standard HEV or a plug-in - and, notably, he said he isn't counting on New Delhi to close that gap. He does not expect government support in the form of lower GST or state-level incentives to make hybrids more price-competitive any time soon. That's a meaningfully different bet than the one being made by rivals such as Toyota, Maruti Suzuki, Honda, and even their sister-firm Kia, all of which have leaned into hybrids or plan to launch several hybrid and PHEV models in the coming months, partly on the expectation of favorable tax treatment.

SEBI mulls net settlement of cash market obligations for MFs

PIONEER NEWS SERVICE ■ New Delhi

Markets regulator SEBI on Thursday proposed permitting net settlement of funds for transactions undertaken by mutual fund schemes in the cash market, while continuing settlement of securities on a gross basis, aiming to reduce temporary liquidity requirements. "The proposal is intended to facilitate ease of doing business, improve settlement efficiency and reduce temporary liquidity requirements for mutual fund schemes, while ensuring that existing safeguards relating to delivery-based settlement, scheme-wise accounting, valuation and investor protection

remain unaffected," SEBI said in its consultation paper. The proposal comes after SEBI received representations from market participants highlighting that mutual fund schemes may face temporary liq-

uidity requirements and operational inefficiencies because fund obligations in the cash market are effectively met on a gross basis at the scheme level. These issues may become more pronounced during index rebalancing, which requires portfolio changes in passive funds and large investor subscriptions or redemptions. This follows SEBI allowing the net settlement of funds framework for Foreign Portfolio Investors (FPIs). In its consultation paper, SEBI has "proposed to permit net settlement of funds for outright buy or sell transactions undertaken by a mutual fund scheme in the cash market executed on a recognised stock exchange".

BUSINESS 11

"Those who have good points, they will get incentives from insurers or companies... those who are habitually making mistakes, the penalty is there," he said. For anyone who takes a bus to work or school, there's good news too. Following 3,855 bus-related deaths in 2024, buses can now be registered only after stricter type-approval checks, with physical and video inspections uploaded online before a bus hits the road. Bus builders get a break too - testing charges are roughly halved, from ₹30-40 lakh to about ₹14 lakh, with approvals now taking six weeks instead of four months. Gadkari also wants car-

makers to fund driving schools, fitness centres and scrapping yards, especially in smaller towns, to fix India's shortage of trained drivers - of 1,600 planned centres, only 24 are running so far. And in Delhi-NCR, a new Parivartan scheme offers road-tax waivers, registration exemptions and cheap loans to owners willing to scrap over two lakh old trucks and buses for cleaner BS-VI or electric replacements. The bigger picture, Gadkari suggested, is an auto industry now worth over ₹22.75 lakh crore and central to the economy - but one where the price of that growth, going forward, will be safer cars, safer buses, and safer drivers.

Source: KBK Infographics

Stock market extends losses into 4th day

PIONEER NEWS SERVICE
■ Mumbai

Equity benchmark indices Sensex and Nifty buckled under lag-end selling pressure for the fourth straight session on Thursday as rising crude oil prices and losses in IT stocks weighed on investor sentiment. The 30-share BSE Sensex dropped 417.49 points, or 0.55 per cent, to close at 76,152.86. The index opened higher and rose 354.13 points, or 0.46 per cent, to hit an intraday high of 76,924.48 before pairing gains during the closing session. A total of 2,545 stocks advanced, while 1,778 declined and 223 remained unchanged on the BSE. The 50-share NSE Nifty slipped 41 points, or 0.17 per cent, to settle at 23,873.45. The early market rebound, supported by a recovery in global equities and recent foreign capital inflows, lost steam in the final hour of trade as investors turned cautious amid geopolitical uncertainties. Among the 30 Sensex firms, Titan, Trent, ITC, Mahindra & Mahindra, Bajaj Finserv, HCL Technologies, Tech Mahindra, Sun Pharmaceuticals, Tata Consultancy Services, UltraTech Cement and Bajaj Finance were the major laggards. In contrast, Axis Bank, Adani Ports, Asian Paints, HDFC Bank, Bharti Airtel, Bharat Electronics Ltd and Tata Steel were among the gainers. Shares of PC Jewellers closed 3.54 per cent higher after the company said it has cleared its outstanding debt to one more bank under a settlement agreement dated September 30, 2024. Brent crude, the global oil benchmark, rose 1.57 per cent to \$97.13 per barrel. "Stubbornly high crude oil prices continue to act as key overhangs for the domestic market," said Vinod Nair, Head of Research, Geojit Investments Ltd. He said that the market's recovery attempt lost steam as supportive global cues and renewed FII inflows collided with lingering geopolitical tensions and elevated global yields.

Gold snaps losing streak, rises to ₹1.59 lakh/10g in Delhi

PIONEER NEWS SERVICE
■ New Delhi

Gold broke out of a six-session losing streak, staging a sharp recovery of ₹3,400 to ₹1.59 lakh per 10 grams in the national capital on Thursday, tracking a firm trend in the international markets. The yellow metal of 99.9 per cent purity climbed ₹3,400 to ₹1,59,500 per 10 grams (inclusive of all taxes) from Wednesday's closing level of ₹1,56,100 per 10 grams. Silver also joined the rebound, jumping ₹5,000

to ₹2,40,500 per kilogram (inclusive of all taxes). The white metal had closed at ₹2,35,500 per kg in the previous session. "Gold and silver rebound-

ed as US Treasury yields eased from recent highs, while safe-haven demand remains supported by renewed geopolitical tensions," said Gaurav Garg,

Head of Research at brokerage platform Lemonn. Saumil Gandhi, Senior Analyst - Commodities at HDFC Securities, said the rebound highlights gold's sensitivity to shifts in US monetary-policy expectations. "Weaker-than-expected private employment data challenged the hawkish Fed narrative, pushing the dollar and Treasury yields lower," Gandhi added. In global markets, spot gold gained \$55.76, or 1.27 per cent, to \$4,443.93 per ounce, while silver advanced nearly 1 per cent to 65.77 per ounce.

RBI DEPUTY GOVERNOR URGES NBFCs TO PRIORITISE ASSET QUALITY

PIONEER NEWS SERVICE
■ Mumbai

Reserve Bank Deputy Governor S C Murmu on Thursday asked non-bank finance companies (NBFCs) to ensure that the acceleration in loan growth does not come at the cost of asset quality concerns. Addressing an event by TVS Credit, Murmu asked the non-bank lenders to also focus on other aspects including liquidity management, fair conduct, grievance redressal and responsible lending. "As credit growth speeds up, so does the risk to asset quality... Let me be clear, growth must never come at the cost of underwriting standards," Murmu said. He asked NBFCs to do "rigorous" stress testing, early warning systems, and dynamic provisioning, and also invest in artificial intelligence and machine learning tools for early warnings on borrower stress.

Nepal flood toll reaches 1,259

SHIRISH B PRADHAN
■ Kathmandu

With over 4,000 still missing due to devastating flash floods in Nepal, families perform symbolic funeral rites for their relatives after receiving no information about them for eight days, even as the death toll surges to 1,259 on Thursday.

The flash floods, triggered by

an ice-rock avalanche near the Nepal-Tibet border on August 26, devastated towns and villages in north-ern and central Nepal, leaving a trail of destruction.

According to the data released by Nepal's National Disaster Risk Reduction and Management Authority (NDRRMA), the death toll from the Bhotekoshi River floods surged to 1,252 on Thursday, with 4,216 still missing.

In Paharebesi village of Rasuwa district, residents have begun preparing to perform funeral rites for missing relatives after receiving no information about their whereabouts for eight days, Onlinekhabar news portal reported on Thursday.

In flood-hit areas, families have begun using effigies made of kusha grass to perform the final rites of relatives who remain untraced, amid diminishing hopes of finding them alive. The Kathmandu Post newspaper reported. Families said they were turning to symbolic funerals because there was little hope of recovering all the missing and because identifying bodies had become increasingly difficult, it said.

According to NDRRMA, 355 bodies have been recovered from Chitawan district, 218 from Nawalparasi East, 208 from Nawalparasi West, including 18 recovered from India and handed over to Nawalparasi West, and 177 from Nuwakot.

Similarly, 127 bodies were recovered from Rasuwa district, 69 from Gorkha, 60



Family members perform rituals during symbolic funerals of their loved ones, who are flood victims still reported missing, in accordance with Nepali Hindu rites at Pashupatinath temple in Kathmandu, Nepal

from Dhading and 38 from Tahanu.

On the Chinese side, the death toll in the flash flood that struck Gyirong county in Tibet near the Nepal border has increased to 21, with 541 others still missing as of Wednesday.

As the upstream areas of the Bhotekoshi River are continuously receiving rain-fall on Thursday, there is the possibility of rising water levels in the Bhotekoshi and Trishuli rivers as well as small rivers and rivulets flowing through Rasuwa and Nuwakot districts, said Saraswati Bishta, a technician at the Flood Forecasting Division of the Department of Hydrology and Meteorology. The people residing in the surrounding areas and downstream of the river are urged to remain vigilant, she said.

There is a middle-level risk associated with flash floods in rivers situated in

various districts, mainly those in the hilly region, including Taplejung, Panchthar, Terhathum, Dhankuta, Sankhuwasabha, Okhaldhunga, Udaypur, Chitwan, Gorkha, Tanahu, Lamjung, Manang, Mustang, Myagdi, Kaski, Syangja, Kathmandu, Lalitpur and Bhaktapur, she said. Similarly, rivers situated in mountain regions including Kalikot, Humla, Jumla, Dailekh, Darchula, Baitadi and Kalikot districts are also swelling, resulting in some risks associated to flash floods, she added.

Meanwhile, Nepal Foreign Minister Shisir Khanal on Thursday called the massive floods that caused wide-spread devastation in the country a "Himalayan Tsunami" and thanked neighbouring countries and the international community for their support and solidarity during this difficult period. (PTI)

India ready to help end Ukraine-Russia war: EAM

PRESS TRUST OF INDIA ■ Kyiv

India on Thursday said it was ready to extend "any help in any manner" to end the Ukraine-Russia war, which is now in its fifth year, as External Affairs Minister S Jaishankar held wide-ranging talks with his Ukrainian counterpart Andrii Sybiha in Kyiv. "India has consistently maintained that this is not an era of war, and that solutions will not emerge from the battlefield," Jaishankar said in a joint press statement alongside Sybiha after their talks. He recalled that Prime Minister Narendra Modi just two days ago declared that endless war must now give way to the end of war during a meeting with Russian President Vladimir Putin in Bishkek on the margins of the Shanghai Cooperation Organisation summit.

"Every passing day of conflict only means more deaths and more destruction. Understandably, it is for the parties involved to find a way. But, if India can be of any help in any manner, we are ready," Jaishankar said.

India has been consistently calling for ending the Russia-Ukraine conflict through dialogue and diplomacy.

"In consonance with Prime Minister Modi's call for an end to war, my visit



Indian Foreign Minister Subrahmanyam Jaishankar and Ukraine's Foreign Minister Andrii Sybiha walk in the city center during their meeting in Kyiv, Ukraine

has a focus on the prospects of dialogue and diplomacy. I will be taking back the views and positions shared today by the Ukrainian side," he added. Earlier, the Ukrainian foreign minister welcomed PM Modi's call to move from an endless war towards an end to the war, saying his country "stands ready for diplomacy."

"India is a global power and we welcome Prime Minister Modi's call to move from an endless war towards an end to the war," Sybiha said in a post

on X. Jaishankar, who arrived here amid escalating hostilities between Moscow and Kyiv, said his trip has a bilateral purpose.

"But more important, it takes place in the larger context of the war that has been underway since 2022. Only two days ago, an Indian national was also killed in an attack in Kyiv.

We join in mourning every life lost and convey our deepest sympathy to every affected family," he said.

Dozens missing, 5 dead after migrant boat stalls in Atlantic Ocean

RENATA BRITO ■ Barcelona

At least five people died and dozens more were feared dead after a boat carrying West African migrants ran into trouble in the Atlantic Ocean. Forty-four people were brought to safety in the Canary Islands.

Spain's Maritime Rescue Service said Thursday that one of its planes had spotted a "precarious" boat drifting



some 120 km (74 miles) south of the island of Gran Canaria on Wednesday afternoon. Three survivors were immediately evacuated by heli-

copter to a hospital on the island. The remaining 41 migrants were brought to safety by boat and disembarked early Thursday in the port of Arguineguin, where they were cared for by the Red Cross. All survivors were men, some underage, and came from Mali or Senegal, said Jose Antonio Rodriguez Verona, a spokesperson for the Red Cross in the Canaries. In a phone interview with

The Associated Press, Rodriguez Verona said survivors were disoriented and dehydrated, with many collapsing or vomiting upon reaching land. While it was difficult to get precise information given their fragile state of health, migrants reported leaving Gambia and being stranded at sea for "many, many days." Some estimated they had been at sea for nearly a month.(AP)

COURT NOTICE
IN THE SUPREME COURT OF INDIA
EXTRA-ORDINARY APPELLATE JURISDICTION
SPECIAL LEAVE TO APPEAL
Diary No. 28669 OF 2019 WITH PRAYER FOR INTERIM RELIEF WITH
IA NO. 179534/2026-
APPLICATION FOR SUBSTITUTED SERVICE
MOHAN LAL
.....Petitioner(S) / Appellant (S)
VERSUS
M. TEJA SINGH MANSAHIA and OTHERS
.....Respondent(s)

To:
1 AVTAR KAUR W/O TEJA SINGH MANSAHIA, R/O "DELIGHT" RAJBAHARAD, PATIALA, PUNJAB
PID: 2231223/2026 FOR R[8] IN DIARY NO. 28669/2019 (SEC 1V-B)
2 RUPINDER SINGH CHAHAL S/O DEVINDER SINGH CHAHAL, R/O CHAHAL HOUSE, RAGHO MAJRA, PATIALA, PUNJAB
PID: 223123/2026 FOR R[9] IN DIARY NO. 28669/2019 (SEC IV-B)
3 SHRI GURUDWARA JOTI SARUP, THROUGH S.H. NIRANJAN SINGH, NABHA GATE, SANGRUR, PUNJAB
PID: 223124/2026 FOR R[11] IN DIARY NO. 28669/2019 (SEC IV-B)
4. JAVDEEP KAUR S/O SURINDER SINGH, R/O 2, CURZON ROAD, NEW DELHI
PID: 223125/2026 FOR R[12] IN DIARY NO. 28669/2019 (SEC IV-B)
5. UADI SINGH S/O SURINDER SINGH R/O 2, CURZON ROAD NEW DELHI.
PID: 223126/2026 FOR R[13] IN DIARY NO. 28669/2019 (SEC IV-B)
6. GOPALINDER SINGH S/o LATE SH. SURJINDER SINGH R/O 2, CURZON ROAD, NEW DELHI
PID: 223127/2026 FOR R[15] IN DIARY NO. 28669/2019 (SEC IV-B)
7. SIMRAT KAUR W/O BHARTINDER SINGH SON OF MALWINDER SINGH, R/O 5006/5, AJIT NAGAR, PATIALA, PUNJAB
PID: 223128/2026 FOR R[16] IN DIARY NO. 28669/2019 (SEC 1V-B)
8 SHIVINDER SINGH (MINOR) S/O BHARTINDER SINGH, R/O 5006/5, AJIT NAGAR, PATIALA, PUNJAB
PID: 223129/2026 FOR R[17] IN DIARY NO. 28669/2019 (SEC IV-B)

WHEREAS the Petition for Special Leave to Appeal with prayer for interim relief along with application for CONDONATION OF DELAY IN FILING, ADDITION / DELETION / MODIFICATION PARTIES, APPLICATION FOR SUBSTITUTION, EXEMPTION FROM FILING O.T., SUBSTITUTED SERVICE, INTERVENTION/IMPLEADMENT, APPLICATION FOR SUBSTITUTION, SETTING ASIDE AN ABATEMENT, APPLICATION FOR CONDONATION OF DELAY IN FILING THE APPLICATION FOR SETTING ASIDE THE ABATEMENT above mentioned filed in the Registry by Mr. VIVEK SINGH, Advocate on behalf of the Petitioner(s) above named was listed before Hon'ble Court (In Chambers) on 14th August, 2026, when inter-alia the following order was passed:-

" Dy. No. - 28669/2019 (IA. No. - 179534/2026 - APPLICATION FOR SUBSTITUTED SERVICE

1. For the reasons assigned in the application, duly supported by an affidavit, the same is allowed.

2. Consequently, the petitioner is permitted to serve respondent nos. 8 to 9, 11 to 13 and 15 to 17 through substituted service by way of newspaper publication in "The Pioneer English and Desh Sewak Punjab" having wide circulation in Punjab and "The Pioneer English and the Pioneer Hindi" having wide circulation in Delhi.

3. Learned counsel for the petitioner is granted to take requisite measures and place proof of service within four weeks."

NOW, THEREFORE, TAKE NOTICE that the above petition with prayer for interim relief along with application will be posted for hearing before this Court in due course and you may enter appearance before this Court either in person or through an advocate on record of this Court duly appointed by you in that behalf within 30 days from the date of service of notice. You may thereafter show cause to the Court on the day that may subsequently be specified as to why delay in filing SLP be not condoned and Special Leave Petition and interim relief as prayed be not granted and the resultant appeal be not allowed.

Take Further Notice that the prayer for interim relief after notice will also be listed before the Court in due course.

You may file your affidavit in opposition to the petition as provided under Rule 14(1) of Order XXI, S.C.R. 2013 within 30 days from the date of receipt of notice or not later than 2 weeks before the date appointed for hearing, whichever be earlier, but shall do so only by setting out the grounds in opposition to the questions of law or grounds set out in the SLPs and may produce such pleadings and documents filed before the Court/Tribunal against whose order the SLP is filed and shall also set out the grounds for not granting interim order or for vacating interim order if already granted.

TAKE FURTHER NOTICE that if you fail to enter appearance as aforesaid, no further notice shall be given to you even after the grant of special leave for hearing of the resultant appeal and the matter above mentioned shall be disposed of in your absence.

Dated :29th August, 2026

ASSISTANT REGISTRAR

कार्यालय नगरपालिका परिषद, नीमच जिला नीमच म.प्र.
क्रं. ३०१/ई-टेंडर./०१/लो.नि.वि/२०२६/

नीमच, दिनांक ०३/०९/२०२६

ऑनलाईन (Online) द्वितीय निविदा आमंत्रण सूचना

निम्नलिखित कार्य हेतु केन्द्रीयकृत प्रणाली में पंजीकृत टेकदारों से ऑनलाईन निविदाएं आमंत्रित की जाती है। निविदा का विस्तृत विवरण वेबसाइट website <http://mptenders.gov.in> पर देखा सकते है किसी भी प्रकार के शंशोधन का प्रकाशन ऑनलाईन <http://mptenders.gov.in> रहेगा।

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2026 UAD_525259_2 (Second Call)	नमो उपवन पार्क सोन्दरीकरण कार्य	6 Months 24090178+GST	Rs. 15000 Rs. 120451	18.09.2026

श्रीमती स्वाति गौरव चौपड़ा
अध्यक्ष, नगरपालिका परिषद, नीमच

श्री मनोहर मोतवानी
सभापति, लो.नि.वि.

मुख्य नगरपालिका अधिकारी
नगरपालिका परिषद, नीमच

सेन्ट्रल बैंक ऑफ इंडिया
Central Bank of India
1911 से आपके लिए "केन्द्रित" "CENTRAL" TO YOU SINCE 1911

Regional Office Delhi (South)

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E-AUCTION SALE NOTICE
(Under SARFAESI Act 2002)

APPENDIX- IV-A [SEE PROVISO TO RULE 8(6) & 9(1)] SALE NOTICE FOR SALE OF IMMOVABLE PROPERTIES

E-Auction Sale Notice for sale of Immovable Assets under the Securitization and Reconstruction of Financial Assets and Enforcement of Security Interest Act, 2002 read with proviso to Rule 8(6) & 9(1) of the Security Interest (Enforcement) Rules, 2002.

Notice is hereby given to the public in general and in particular to the borrower(s) and guarantor(s) that the below described immovable property mortgaged / charged to the Central Bank of India (secured creditor), the constructive/ physical Possession of which have been taken by the authorized officer of Central Bank of India(Secured creditors), will be sold on "As is where is", "As is what is" and "whatever there is" basis on date 24.09.2026 for recovery of dues to the Central Bank of India from below mention Borrower(s) and Guarantor(s). The Reserve Price and Earnest money deposit (EMD) is displayed against the details of respective properties.

E-AUCTION SCHEDULED TO BE HELD ON 24.09.2026 (15 DAY'S NOTICE)

S. No.	Name of Branch	Authorised Officer/ Branch Head	Name of the Account	Description of Property & Owner Name	Demand Notice Date & Amount Dues (In Rupees)	Date & Type of Possession	In Rupees Reserve Price EMD Bid Increase
1.	Gulmohar Park New Delhi	Ms. Archana Sharma Mobile: 8448296394	Vipin Kumar Gaur	First Floor Back Side Left Side Portion without Roof Rights, part of Property No RZ-902, Gali No- 23, measuring Area 45.84 Sq Mtr, out of Khasra No 445, Situated at Tuglakabad Extension, New Delhi- 110019, Owner- Mr. Vipin Kumar Gaur S/o Mr. Murari Lal	Rs. 32,83,616.60 on 14.05.2025 + Interest thereafter	26.12.2025 (Physical)	₹ 17,10,000.00 ₹ 1,71,000.00 ₹ 20,000.00
2.	Karol Bagh New Delhi	Mr. Vinay Kumar Mobile: 9999917126	Mr. Ranjeet Singh	DDA built up Residential Flat No. 20 Fourth Floor (LIG) in Pocket- 3, Block- F-8, Sector- G-8, Narela, Delhi- 110040, Area- 472 Sq Ft, Owner- Mr. Ranjeet Singh S/o Mr. Amrik Singh	Rs. 14,20,145.46 on 30.05.2023 + interest thereafter	30.07.2025 (Physical)	₹ 10,73,000.00 ₹ 1,07,300.00 ₹ 10,000.00
3.	Lady Harding Medical College	Ms. Kumari Ritu Mobile: 9319992541	Mr. Imran Khan and Mrs. Rehana	Free hold Residential Flat No.- F.F.- 1 First Floor (HIG) without Roof Rights on Plot No B-1/16, DLF AnkurVihar, Loni, Ghaziabad, Area- 900 Sq Ft, Owner- Mr. Imran Khan S/o Mr. Mohammed Sharif and Mrs. Rehana W/o Mr. Imran Khan	Rs.10,01,634.29 on 14.06.2024 + interest thereafter	29.05.2025 (Physical)	₹ 15,30,000.00 ₹ 1,53,000.00 ₹ 15,000.00
4.	Narela New Delhi	Mr. Mahesh Choudhary Mobile: 9711196480	M/s S S ENTERPRISES	Built Up Property Bearing No.2420 A, Land Measuring 174 Sq. Yards, First Floor with Roof Rights, Plot No.2, Out of Khasra No.285 Min, Situated in the Area of Village Mamoorpur, Narela, Delhi-110040, Abadi known as Mandi Extension Part - I, (Opposite New Anaj Mandi), Main Bawana Road, Narela, Delhi-110040. Owner: Ms. Savitri Devi	Rs. 1,44,55,546.00 on 02.08.2022 + interest thereafter	06.07.2023 (Physical)	₹ 76,50,000.00 ₹ 7,65,000.00 ₹ 50,000.00
5.	Narela New Delhi	Mr. Mahesh Choudhary Mobile: 9711196480	M/s S S ENTERPRISES	Built Up Property Bearing No.2420 A, Land Measuring 62 Sq. Yards, Plot No.2 on Ground Floor without Roof Rights, Out of Khasra No.285 Min, Three Shops bearing Pvt. Shop No.1 to 6, situated in the Area of Village Mamoorpur, Narela, Delhi-110040, Abadi known as Mandi Extension Part - I, (Opposite New Anaj Mandi), Bawana Road, Narela, Delhi-110040. Owner: Ms. Savitri Devi	Rs. 1,44,55,546.00 on 02.08.2022 + interest thereafter	06.07.2023 (Physical)	₹ 47,70,000.00 ₹ 4,77,000.00 ₹ 45,000.00
6.	Paharganj New Delhi	Mr. Rajiv Kumar Mobile: 8847236384	Mr. Rakesh Kumar Sahu	Residential LIG Flat No SF- 3 (Second Floor), back Side with Roof Rights, situated at Plot No M.M.- 43, DLF Ankur Vihar, Village- Loni, District- Ghaziabad, Uttar Pradesh - 201102, Super covered Area 400 Sq Feet, Owner- Mr. Rakesh Kumar Sahu S/o Mr. Laxman Prasad Sahu	Rs. 10,36,988.55 on 04.06.2024 + interest thereafter	19.12.2025 (Physical)	₹ 8,23,500.00 ₹ 82,350.00 ₹ 10,000.00

E-AUCTION DATE: 24.09.2026, TIME: 12:00 Noon TO 04:00 PM WITH AUTO EXTENSION OF 10 MINUTES

Last Date & Time of Submission of EMD and Documents (Online) On or Before: 24.09.2026 Upto 03:30 PM.

Bidder will register on website: <https://BAANKNET.com> and upload KYC documents and after verification of KYC documents by the service provider, EMD to be deposited in **BAANKNET EMD** wallet through NEFT/RTGS/Transfer / Generation of challan from (<https://BAANKNET.com>).

The auction will be conducted through common landing platform **BAANKNET.com Portal (<https://BAANKNET.com>)**. E-auction will be held "As is where is", "As is what is" and "whatever there is" basis. **Property shall be sold only above the Reserve Price. (All other charges/dues to the property will be borne by the purchaser).** For detailed terms and conditions please refer to the link provided in www.centralbank.bank.in Secured Creditor or auction platform (<https://BAANKNET.com>). Helpdesk: (+91) 8291220220, E-mail: support.BAANKNET@psballiance.com

STATUTORY 15 DAY'S SALE NOTICE UNDER RULE 8(6) & 9(1) OF THE SARFAESI ACT, 2002

Borrowers/Guarantors/ Mortgageors are hereby notified to pay the sum as mentioned above along with upto date interest and ancillary expenses before the date of e-auction, failing which the property will be auctioned/sold and balance dues, if any, will be recovered with interest and cost.

DATE: 03.09.2026
PLACE: NEW DELHI

Authorised Officer,
CENTRAL BANK OF INDIA, RO Delhi (South), New Delhi

BABA FARID UNIVERSITY OF HEALTH SCIENCES, FARIDKOT

ADMISSION NOTICE for Post Basic Diploma in Nursing 2026
Online Applications for admission to Post Basic Diploma in Nursing courses, session 2026 at Homi Bhabha Cancer Hospital, Sangrur, Govt. Nursing College, Patiala and University College of Nursing, Faridkot. Aridkot are invited from eligible candidates through University website from 05.09.2026 to 14.09.2026 alongwith requisite fee through University Payment Gateway. Physical Counseling will be held on 16.09.2026 (11:00 AM) in BFUHS, Faridkot. The selected candidates shall pay the tuition fee on the spot at the counseling venue in the shape of Bank Demand Draft in favor of Registrar, BFUHS, payable in Faridkot. For Prospectus, details/Updates visit university website (www.bfuhs.ac.in) Registrar

3108/12/2026-27/14817 Dated CHD :- 03/09/2026

OFFICE OF MUNICIPAL CORPORATION KORBA
e-Procurement Tender Notice
Main Portal: <http://eproc.cgstate.gov.in> KORBA

NIT No.:- 20/2026 Dated:-31.08.2026

SN	System Tender No.	Name of Work/Description of Work	Probable Amount of Contract
1	198518 (2nd Call)	Construction Work of Bridge Over Canal Near Agrasen Tiralia and C.C. Road From Bridge To DDM Road, Expansion Work of Sunaliya Chowk & C.C. Road Along The Canal Bank From Sunaliya Chowk To Ratakhar Joda Bridge VIA Agrasen Tiralia in Korba (C.G.)	Rs. 1850.21 Lakh

The details can be viewed directly from the Government of Chhattisgarh <http://eproc.cgstate.gov.in> from 31.08.2026 at 17.30 Hours. (IST) onwards.

Commissioner

Superintending Engineer

Municipal Corporation Korba(C.G.)

छत्तीसगढ़ पर्यावरण संरक्षण मंडल
पर्यावास भवन, सेक्टर-19, नवा रायपुर अटल नगर, जिला- रायपुर (छ.ग.)

// सर्व संबंधित को सूचना //

भारत सरकार, पर्यावरण वन एवं जलवायु परिवर्तन मंत्रालय, नई दिल्ली की ई.आई.ए अधिसूचना दिनांक 14/09/2006 (यथा संशोधित) के अन्तर्गत सर्व साधारण को सूचित किया जाता है कि ग्राम डिगनगर कलस्टर लार्ज स्टेन मॉर्निंग, तहसील - राजपुर, जिला- बलरामपुर - रा. गंज (छ.ग.) स्थित कुल 04 संचालित चूना पत्थर खदानों क्रमशः (1) श्री धीरज कुमार, ख.नं. 285/3, 285/73, 285/75, 285/79, 285/77 एवं 285/76, कुल लीज एरिया - 1.353 हे. उत्खनन क्षमता - 25,080 टन / वर्ष (2) श्री शुभम बंसल, ख.नं. 299/3, 299/5, 299/16, 299/23, 299/40 एवं 299/41 कुल लीज एरिया - 4.106 हे. उत्खनन क्षमता - 1,50,052 टन / वर्ष (3) श्री नरेन्द्र चौधरी, ख.नं. 285/14 एवं 285/31, कुल लीज एरिया - 1.2 हे. उत्खनन क्षमता - 15,700 टन / वर्ष (4) श्री शुभम बंसल, ख.नं. 285/29 एवं 285/37, कुल लीज एरिया - 1.04 हे. उत्खनन क्षमता - 7,782.75 टन / वर्ष के पर्यावरणीय स्वीकृति हेतु लोक सुनवाई मुख्यालय, छत्तीसगढ़ पर्यावरण संरक्षण मंडल, नवा रायपुर अटल नगर, रायपुर में आवेदन किया गया है। उक्त परियोजना के संबंध में आपत्तियां / सुझाव / विचार, टीका-टिप्पणियां, इस सूचना के जारी होने के दिनांक से 30 दिवस के भीतर क्षेत्रीय कार्यालय, छत्तीसगढ़ पर्यावरण संरक्षण मंडल, कन्या परिसर रोड, शासकीय आयुर्वेदिक चिकित्सालय के पास, नमनाकला गंगापुर, अंबिकापुर, जिला- सरगुजा (छ.ग.) के कार्यालय में मौखिक या लिखित रूप से कार्यालयीन समय में प्रस्तुत की जा सकती है। इस परियोजना के लिए लोक सुनवाई दिनांक 06/10/2026 को समय प्रातः 11:00 बजे स्थल ग्राम पंचायत भवन डिगनगर, तहसील - राजपुर, जिला - बलरामपुर - रा. गंज (छ.ग.) में नियत की गई है।

ई.आई.ए. अधिसूचना दिनांक 14/09/2006 (यथा संशोधित) के प्रावधानों के अनुसार ड्राफ्ट ई.आई.ए. रिपोर्ट, कार्यपालक सार की प्रतियां (हिन्दी व अंग्रेजी में) एवं इसकी सी. डी. (सॉफ्ट कॉपी) जन सामान्य के अवलोकन / पठन हेतु डोंयवेक्टर, पर्यावरण, वन एवं जलवायु परिवर्तन मंत्रालय, भारत सरकार, इंदिरा पर्यावरण भवन, जोरबाग रोड, नई दिल्ली, साईटिस्ट 'डी' एकीकृत क्षेत्रीय कार्यालय, पर्यावरण, वन एवं जलवायु परिवर्तन मंत्रालय, अरण्य भवन, नार्थ ब्लॉक, सेक्टर-19, नवा रायपुर अटल नगर, जिला- रायपुर, कलेक्टर, कार्यालय कलेक्टर एवं जिला दण्डाधिकारी, बलरामपुर, जिला - बलरामपुर - रा. गंज (छ.ग.), मुख्य कार्यालय अधिकारी, जिला पंचायत, बलरामपुर, जिला-बलरामपुर - रा. गंज (छ.ग.), अनुविभागीय अधिकारी (रा.) बलरामपुर, जिला- बलरामपुर - रा. गंज (छ.ग.), कार्यालय कलेक्टर (खनिज खाखा), बलरामपुर, जिला- बलरामपुर - रा. गंज (छ.ग.), महासंयोजक, जिला व्यापार एवं उद्योग केन्द्र, बलरामपुर, जिला- बलरामपुर - रा. गंज (छ.ग.), सरपंच / सचिव, कार्यालय ग्राम पंचायत-डिगनगर, वंडराड, ओखरा, परसगुडी, पतवापारा, चांची, कर्जी, तह.- राजपुर, जिला- बलरामपुर - रा. गंज (छ.ग.), सदस्य सचिव, मुख्यालय, छत्तीसगढ़ पर्यावरण संरक्षण मण्डल, पर्यावास भवन, नार्थ ब्लॉक, सेक्टर-19 नवा रायपुर अटल नगर, जिला - रायपुर (छ.ग.) एवं क्षेत्रीय अधिकारी, क्षेत्रीय कार्यालय, छत्तीसगढ़ पर्यावरण संरक्षण मण्डल, कन्या परिसर रोड, शासकीय आयुर्वेदिक चिकित्सालय के पास, नमनाकला गंगापुर, तह.- अंबिकापुर, जिला- सरगुजा (छ.ग.) में रखी गई है।

सदस्य सचिव

छत्तीसगढ़ पर्यावरण संरक्षण मंडल,

नवा रायपुर अटल नगर, जिला- रायपुर (छ.ग.)

FROM THE WORLD

JAPAN

Nobel prize winner dies at 90
Japanese scientist Hideki Shirakawa, co-winner of the 2000 Nobel Prize in chemistry for discovering and developing conductive polymers, has died. He was 90.

The discovery by Shirakawa and two fellow American scientists, Alan Heeger and Alan MacDiarmid, demonstrated that plastic could conduct electricity like metal and be used in applications such as electronics. Shirakawa died on August 24, according to the University of Tsukuba, where he taught and researched after joining in 1979. The university did not specify a cause of death. Japan's largest newspaper, the Yomiuri, said Shirakawa died at a hospital in Yokohama, west of Tokyo. (AP)

USA

Stocks up, oil price climbs

Stocks rose in morning trading Thursday on Wall Street as bond yields eased further even as oil prices marched higher as the US war with Iran escalates. The S&P 500 was up 0.5 per cent. The Dow Jones Industrial Average added 340 points, or 0.6 per cent, as of 10:01 am Eastern time. The Nasdaq composite rose 0.7 per cent. The indexes are coming off their first gain after a three-day slide.

Nvidia rose 1.9 per cent after the giant chip company said it would buy the artificial intelligence platform Hugging Face for USD 13 billion. Oil prices ticked higher as the six-month long US war with Iran intensified. The fighting between the US and Iran heated up after the US hit Iranian rocket launchers in the Hormuz, saying Iran was planning to use them to send mines into the waterway. (AP)

by the administration. It's likely the case will again end up before the Supreme Court. Trump has long opposed mail voting and falsely blamed it for his 2020 election loss to Democrat Joe Biden. Election officials say there's simply no way they can comply with the Postal Service directives, which could require a complete overhaul of their operations. Before it delivers mail ballots for any state, the Postal Service would have to approve the design of the envelopes that contain them and have the state upload a list of voters receiving them to an online portal.

**Office of Superintending Engineer,
Moradabad Circle, P.W.D. Moradabad
E-Procurement Notice Inviting Tender**

No. 5109 / Nivida-Moradabad/26-27 Dated-25-08-2026

1. On behalf of the Governor of UP, tenders for following work are invited by the Superintending Engineer, Moradabad Circle, PWD Moradabad online on website <http://etender.up.nic.in> and <http://wms.upwd.gov.in/Prahari> from registered contractors from 18-09-2026 at 10:00 am to 24-09-2026 at 12:00 Noon. Technical bid /Prequalification of tenders shall be opened on 24-09-2026 at 12:30 pm in office of undersigned by tender committee in presence of authorised representatives/bidders who wish to be present. Financial bid of the tenders' who qualify in technical bid shall be opened on date and time as specified by a notice in the office of undersigned. In case of Government holiday the required process shall be carried out on next working day.

2.

Sl No.	District	Name of Work	Sanctioned cost (with Bitumen) Rs. in Lacs)	5 Years Maintenance Cost (Rs in Lakhs)	Total Cost (Rs in lakhs)	Bid Security (Rs.in Lacs)	Time of completion of the work (Including rainy season)	Cost of tender documents including GST (RS.)	Category of road contractor eligible
1	2	3	4	5	6	7	8	9	10
1	Amroha	New Construction of Chakbadonia to Haibatpur Salarpur Lin Road	75.00	1.90	76.90	5.85	06 Months	2354.00	"A, & B" Road category
2	Amroha	New Construction Salamatpur Jogkhera Road on Joginder Singh House to Ikonda Road tak.	73.00	1.84	74.84	5.75	06 Months	2354.00	"A, B & C" Road category
3	Amroha	New Construction of Village Haryana to Meerpur Road	146.00	3.66	149.66	9.49	12 Months	2354.00	"A, & B" Road category

3. Rules/conditions & details of the tender are available at website <http://etender.up.nic.in>.

(Girish Kumar Singh)
Executive Engineer
Construction Division, P.W.D
Amroha

(S.P.Singh)
Superintending Engineer
Moradabad Circle, P.W.D.
Moradabad

UP= 255335 Dt. 2.9.26 Ph. – 0591-2414619

विज्ञापन वेबसाइट www.upgov.in पर उपलब्ध है

The forgotten science Krishna gave to Arjuna

VIDHI BIRLA

Every Janmashtami, homes and temples come alive with lamps, music, devotion, and the joyful remembrance of Sri Krishna. As we celebrate His birth, let's also pause to remember what He taught us — and how His timeless wisdom can guide us in the lives we lead today.

The Battlefield Within

We live in an age of remarkable possibilities, yet many of us carry a quiet restlessness within. We are connected by technology, but can feel disconnected from ourselves. We work hard, yet wonder about purpose. We seek success, but struggle to find peace. Relationships, responsibilities, and an endless stream of information can leave the mind tired and scattered.

It was to a human being facing a profound inner crisis that Krishna spoke on the battlefield of

Kurukshetra. Arjuna was confused, anxious, and unable to see clearly. Krishna did not ask him to run away from life.

Instead, He taught him how to live and act with wisdom, courage, and inner freedom.

The battlefield of Kurukshetra can also remind us of the battlefield within each of us — between fear and courage, restlessness and peace, self-interest and love. Krishna's message assures us that we can meet life with strength rather than be overwhelmed by it.

We need not wait for life to become perfect before beginning our inner journey.

A few moments of sincere meditation, a selfless act, or the conscious choice to perform our duty without being consumed by its outcome can become steps towards inner freedom.

A Precious Science, Passed Down Through the Ages

Paramahansa Yogananda, author



Yogeshvara Bhagavan Krishna

Sri Sri Paramahansa Yogananda

of the spiritual classic Autobiography of a Yogi and founder of Yogoda Satsanga Society of India (YSS), described Krishna's teaching as a "golden middle path": fulfilling our responsibilities while remaining inwardly anchored in the Divine.

At its heart is yoga — inner

union with the divine. Krishna speaks not merely of belief, but of direct spiritual experience through meditation.

Kriya Yoga is an ancient science of meditation that Lord Krishna taught to Arjuna and extolled in the Bhagavad Gita. Though this precious knowledge was largely forgotten over

the centuries, Mahavatar Babaji revived it in modern times and passed it through a lineage of great gurus to Paramahansa Yogananda, who brought it to the world. Today, YSS continues to share this sacred path.

Kriya Yoga works with the life energy within us, helping calm the breath and quieten the restless mind so that we can turn inward and experience deeper peace and awareness. It is not merely a philosophy, but a method to be practised and experienced.

Paramahansa Yogananda declared: "It works like mathematics; it cannot fail."

Let Krishna Be Born Within

Janmashtami celebrates the birth of Krishna. As we rejoice in His birth, we can also pray for the birth of His presence in our own hearts — by bringing His wisdom into our daily lives: performing our duties sincere-

AT A GLANCE

- **Krishna's message is timeless:** His teachings can help us meet anxiety, confusion, responsibilities, and life's challenges with wisdom and courage.
- **The real battlefield is within:** We can learn to move from restlessness to peace, fear to courage, and self-interest to love.
- **Yoga means inner union:** Krishna points us toward direct spiritual experience, not merely intellectual belief.
- **Kriya Yoga is an ancient science of meditation:**

Revived by Mahavatar Babaji and carried through the lineage of gurus to Paramahansa Yogananda, it is taught today by YSS.

- **Inner stillness is practical:** Through meditation, we can calm the restless mind and become more inwardly anchored while fulfilling our responsibilities.
- **The deepest Janmashtami celebration is within:** As we celebrate Krishna's birth, we can invite His presence to be born in our own hearts by living His wisdom every day.

The author is a member of Yogoda Satsanga Society of India

From protecting the soldier to building the arsenal India's defence manufacturing journey at 80



MAJ GEN ANIL KUMAR OBEROI

As India celebrated its 80th Independence Day, the meaning of self-reliance has changed. India in 1947 inherited an industrial base not designed for an independent nation and now in 2026 is building an increasingly capable defence manufacturing ecosystem expected to equip its armed forces, innovate, scale and compete globally.

A modern military needs more than aircraft, warships and tanks. It requires body armour, precision ammunition, drones, counter-drone systems, sensors, advanced materials and the industrial capacity to manufacture, replenish and sustain these capabilities during prolonged operations. Strategic autonomy is ultimately the ability to sustain combat capability. This is where India's private defence industry becomes significant.

For instance, SMPP Ltd's journey reflects this transformation. Its initial growth was driven by advanced materials research, particularly high-performance structural ceramics. The company focused on lightweight individual protection and platform shielding, engineering body armour plates designed to mitigate high-velocity, armour-piercing threats.

The supply of 186,000 Bullet Resistant Jackets (BRJs) to the Indian Army, along with the armouring of aircraft and helicopters in India and abroad, established SMPP's capability to manufacture specialised defence hardware at scale.

Using Boron Carbide ceramics, among the hardest man-made materials, SMPP reduced personal protection weight while providing multi-hit protection against hard steel core (HSC) rounds.

This expertise created a pathway into ammunition. SMPP expanded into 155 mm artillery ammunition and became a private supplier of combustible cartridge cases and shells.

The company was the first private enterprise in

India to manufacture combustible cartridge cases for 155 mm, 120 mm and 125 mm main battle tank ammunition. These casings burn completely upon firing, eliminating spent shell casings inside an armoured fighting compartment.

The significance goes beyond the component. Wars are not sustained by platforms alone; they depend on the ability to manufacture, stock, replenish and precisely deliver ammunition. For a technologically sophisticated military, secure access to ammunition is therefore a strategic requirement. SMPP has also reported successful trials and evaluations involving 155 mm ammunition and Bi-Modular Charge Systems. Its Himachal Pradesh facility further strengthens the domestic supply chain. In November 2025, SMPP entered into a teaming agreement with KNDS for the KATANA family of 155 mm precision-guided artillery ammunition. The partnership envisages offering KATANA to the Indian Army within the Make in India framework. The development signals a broader shift in Indian defence manufacturing—from components and conventional systems to increasingly sophisticated, technology-intensive capabilities.

The delivery of jet-powered Peacekeeper (Agnivaig) platforms marked another stage, taking SMPP into high-speed autonomous air systems designed for contested and electronically challenging environments.

Through partnerships including its collaboration with Europe's KNDS, SMPP is also developing next-generation loitering munitions combining GNSS navigation and inertial systems for precision engagement. This evolution illustrates how indigenisation is changing. It does not mean shutting the door to international technology. The next phase depends on combining domestic engineering, manufacturing and supply-chain capabilities with global technology and expertise.

The objective should be to create capability in India — not merely assemble products in India. This distinction matters as defence technology becomes more complex and the strategic value of intellectual property, engineering know-how and resilient supply chains grows.

SMPP's expansion from advanced materials and individual protection into ammunition and

autonomous systems reflects this transformation and aligns with Atmanirbhar Bharat by strengthening indigenous capabilities across critical defence supply chains.

Defence manufacturing cannot be built through policy announcements alone. It requires patient capital, predictable procurement, testing infrastructure, skilled manpower, sustained R&D, strong quality systems and long-term demand visibility. The Indian Armed Forces are increasingly partners in innovation. Operational feedback helps companies understand what works in real-world conditions and where products and capabilities must evolve. Equally important is collaboration among large defence companies, start-ups, MSMEs and global technology partners.

India will not—and need not—develop every technology independently. The objective should be to anchor critical knowledge, manufacturing capability, expertise and intellectual property within the country. India's defence-industrial ecosystem is taking shape. The test is whether the country can develop technologies suited to operational requirements, manufacture them at scale, upgrade them and take them to global markets.

For companies such as SMPP, the journey from ballistic protection to ammunition and unmanned systems mirrors this transformation, demonstrating how an Indian defence manufacturer can evolve with the armed forces—from protecting the soldier to contributing to systems that shape the battlefield. As India looks towards 2047, the question is no longer simply whether India can manufacture more defence equipment, but whether it can build an ecosystem capable of anticipating threats, developing solutions, sustaining production during crises and becoming a trusted technology partner to friendly nations. For the soldier, that means better protection; for the artilleryman, more precise ammunition; and for the commander, greater access to unmanned systems. For the country, it means confidence that critical defence capabilities can be created and sustained at home.

The author is an Artillery Officer of 1975 Batch and has commanded an Infantry Division in Ladakh. He is strategic advisor, SMPP

IFQM to host national quality symposium in New Delhi

PIONEER NEWS SERVICE
■ New Delhi

The Indian Foundation for Quality Management (IFQM) will hold the third edition of its National IFQM Symposium on October 5-6, 2026 at the Taj Palace, under the theme "Quality, Innovation and Excellence - Be the Force Multiplier."

Themed "Quality, Innovation and Excellence — Be the Force Multiplier," the Symposium will bring together India's senior-most industry leaders, global quality experts, policymakers, and academia to address one question: how does India convert its manufacturing ambitions into a credible, trusted global presence. Building on the success of the 2024 and 2025 editions, the 2026 Symposium will spotlight transforma-



tive practices while fostering Government-industry-academia collaboration.

The two-day programme runs 25+ sessions — keynotes, fireside conversations, sectoral deep dives, and thematic tracks covering Automotive, Engineering, Aerospace, Electronics, Textile, Leather, and AI in manufacturing. It is a by-invite event, with over 300 CEOs and CXOs, MSME representatives, and 50+ academic leaders and students expected to attend.

Sustainable initiative for welfare of cows in Solan

PIONEER NEWS SERVICE
■ Shimla

In a unique move towards a sustainable movement, an initiative towards adoption and welfare of cows started at Parwanoo in Solan district of Himachal Pradesh. The initiative is for adoption of a *gaushala* for the well-being of the cows in a Municipal Corporation—managed *gaushala* at the Industrial Township, which is also a gateway to Himachal.



Alcobrew Distillery India Limited in Solan on Thursday entered into an agreement with the executive officer, Municipal Council, Parwanoo, for the adoption of the *gaushala* of Municipal Council,

Parwanoo, in the presence of Sushil Kumar Singla, IFS, Secretary, Department of Environment, Science, Technology and Climate Change of Himachal Pradesh.

Under the agreement, Alcobrew Distillery will provide dry and green fodder for all the cows housed in the *gaushala*. The company will also provide medicines and necessary veterinary support as and when required. The agreement has been executed for a period of two years.

SRM University-AP honours nine faculty on Teachers' Day

PIONEER NEWS SERVICE
■ Amaravati

SRM University-AP observed Teachers' Day 2026 with a ceremony honouring faculty members for their contributions to teaching, research and institutional growth. The celebration was attended by chief guest Professor GP Raja Sekhar, Vice Chancellor of Andhra University, Visakhapatnam, along with Professor VS Rao; Professor CH Satish Kumar, Vice Chancellor, SRM University-AP; and the university leadership, including the deans and directors. The proceedings opened with an invocation, the lighting of the ceremonial lamp, and a cultural performance.

In his address, the Vice Chancellor, Professor CH Satish Kumar, recalled the life of Dr S Radhakrishnan, former Vice Chancellor of Andhra University, tracing his journey from his formative years as a student through to the experiences that gradually shaped his enduring respect for teachers.

Chief guest Professor GP Raja Sekhar, in a wide-ranging address, drew on Dr Radhakrishnan's concept of Abhedha, weaving philosophical reflection into a discussion of contemporary policy.

Professor GP Raja Sekhar then facilitated the presentation of the University Outstanding Faculty Awards 2026 to nine members of faculty: Dr V M Manikandan, Head of the Department of Computer Science and Engineering, recognised for his contributions to artificial intelligence and machine learning research and student mentorship; Dr Ayesha Parveen Haroon, honoured for her contributions to the discipline of Psychology; Dr Manjesh Kumar, recognised for his research in advanced and sustainable manufacturing; Dr Elakkiya E, honoured for her work in machine learning, deep learning and network security; Dr Priyanka, recognised for her research in computer vision, image security and artificial intelligence; Dr Siddhartha Ghosh, honoured for his sustained record of teaching and research; Dr Debajyoti Kundu, recognised for his research in environmental science and sustainable bioprocessing; Dr Anuj Deshpande, honoured for his contributions to teaching and institutional development; and Dr Ramanjaneya Reddy, recognised for his research in power electronics and renewable energy.



NCISM pushes AyurSIM for Ayurveda teaching

PIONEER NEWS SERVICE
■ New Delhi

The National Commission for Indian System of Medicine (NCISM) has advised Ayurveda colleges and institutions across India to explore and suitably integrate AyurSIM (Ayurvedic Virtual Clinical Simulations) as a supplementary teaching-learning resource for competency-based Ayurveda education.

In a circular, NCISM highlighted AyurSIM as a free-access virtual patient simulation platform that can support the practical and clinical learning requirements of Ayurveda education. The Commission has encouraged institutions to use the platform in settings including clinical skill and simulation laboratories, digital libraries, smart classrooms, tutorial groups, clinical case discussions and faculty development activities.

AyurSIM has been jointly developed by Amrita CREATE and Amrita School of Ayurveda, in collaboration with the Institute of Teaching and Research in Ayurveda (ITRA), Jamnagar, through a project supported by the Ministry of Electronics and Information Technology.

Greater Noida Authority clears infrastructure projects



PIONEER NEWS SERVICE
■ Noida

Greater Noida Authority's 144th board meeting approved three major decisions aimed at improving the lives of migrant industrial workers. The board cleared construction of EWS flats in Patwadi and Biraundi villages to provide safe and better housing for construction labourers and their families. Construction is targeted to begin by the end of this year after formalities are completed.

Under the UP Building and other construction workers welfare board's transit hostel scheme, the Authority has identified 3,000 sqm plots each in EcoTech-06 and EcoTech-11. These will be transferred free of cost to the Labour Department for construction of labour hostels.

A public library will also come up in Sector Alpha One on 1,360 sqm, with a three-storey library building on 440 sqm and remaining space for parking and amenities.

The board further approved linking a 130-metre-wide road

with the Delhi-Meerut Expressway and a 105-metre-wide road with the Eastern Peripheral Expressway.

A foot-over-bridge in Rithori village was cleared to ease railway crossing for residents. Plot allottees received a final deadline of June 30, 2028, to complete construction and obtain completion certificates. The Authority will also provide residential facilities for an NDRF Regional Response Centre.

The following officials were present in the board meeting: Chairman Deepak Kumar, Additional Chief Secretary Alok Kumar (virtual), Greater Noida Authority CEO NG Ravi Kumar, Noida Authority CEO Krishna Karunesh, Greater Noida Authority ACEO Soumya Srivastava, ACEO Shrilakshmi VS, ACEO Purna Singh, ACEO Sumit Yadav, YEIDA OSD Shailendra Singh, Greater Noida Authority GM Finance Swatantra Gupta, GM Project AK Singh, Greater Noida Authority OSD Gunja Singh, OSD Abhishek Pathak, OSD Girish Jha, OSD Mukesh Kumar Singh, OSD Ajay Sharma and other officials.



DMRC has been honoured with the Overall Excellence in HR Practices for Greater Good award by XLRI Jamshedpur during the HR for the Greater Good Conclave 2.0, held at the Institute's campus from 31st August to 2nd September, 2026

PIONEER PHOTO

Rapid growth drives GDA revenue

PIONEER NEWS SERVICE
■ Ghaziabad

Ghaziabad is rapidly emerging as a modern and dynamically developing city, carving out a new identity for itself. The growing pace of development activities, residential and infrastructure development, along with the expansion of investment and construction-related activities, is having a clear and positive impact on the revenue collection of the Ghaziabad Development Authority (GDA).

During the current financial year 2026-27, from April to August, the GDA has recorded revenue of ₹7,111.24 lakh (approximately ₹71.11 crore) under the Development Charges head, compared to ₹3,950.33 lakh (approximately ₹39.50 crore) during the corresponding period



of financial year 2025-26. This represents an additional revenue collection of ₹3,160.91 lakh (approximately ₹31.61 crore) over the same period, registering a significant increase of approximately 80.02% year-on-year.

The substantial increase recorded particularly during July and August indicates a strong upswing in development and construction-related activities in

Ghaziabad. It also reflects the expansion of economic activity through development-related approvals and processes.

An increase of more than 80% in revenue from development charges is not merely a revenue-collection achievement; it is also an important indicator of the growing pace of development and activity in the construction sector in Ghaziabad.

BRIEFLY

Indoor shooting range inaugurated in Leh



An all-year-round indoor shooting range has been inaugurated in Leh to provide greater access to the sport and help identify talent in the Union Territory of Ladakh. The insulated facility, equipped for air rifle and air pistol shooting, has been established by the Ladakh Shooting Association (LSA) in collaboration with the Ladakh Police at the newly built Sports Complex of the police. The range will be open to students, members of the public and police personnel, providing shooters an opportunity to train locally throughout the year despite the region's challenging weather conditions. NRAI president Kalikesh Singh Deo said the facility would help take shooting to the grassroots in Ladakh and provide a pathway for local talent to progress into competitive shooting. (PTI)

Queiroz back as Ghana coach after quitting following WC exit



Carlos Queiroz is back as coach of Ghana less than two months after quitting the role following World Cup elimination in the last 32. Queiroz held fresh talks with the Ghana Football Association and the country's Ministry of Sports and Recreation, after which the Portuguese coach was handed another contract in charge. The GFA said in a statement late Wednesday that it "believes Queiroz's extensive international experience, technical expertise and knowledge of the Black Stars position him strongly to lead the team into this new chapter." The 73-year-old Queiroz, who has coached Portugal, Colombia, Iran and Egypt at international level and Real Madrid at club level, left as Ghana coach after a 1-0 loss to Colombia at the first knockout stage. (AP)

Yashvir replaces Neeraj; Tejas, Abhishek out as AFI names 77 athletes for Asian Games



PHILEM DIPAK SINGH ■ Ludhiana

Commonwealth Games bronze medallist javelin thrower Yashvir Singh has replaced injured Neeraj Chopra in the Indian athletics team for the upcoming Asian Games in Japan, while long distance runner Abhishek Pal has been dropped after he was served notice for an alleged doping offence by the NADA.

Athletics Federation of India (AFI) on Thursday announced a 77-member Indian track and field team for the September 19-October 4 Aichi-Nagoya Asian Games at a press conference in Ludhiana which is hosting the National Youth Championships.

Men's 110m hurdler Tejas Shire has also been omitted from the team after he sustained an injury during the recent

Commonwealth Games in Glasgow.

"We have brought in Yashvir who is a CWG medal winner in place of Neeraj Chopra who is currently injured. It was an injury replacement and so there was no problem (in Yashvir coming in)," AFI President Bahadur Singh Sagoo said.

"Long distance runner Abhishek Pal has been dropped because of the issues he is facing. So this is the final team for the Asian Games," he added. Last month, Abhishek was served notice by the National Anti-Doping Agency (NADA) after his dope sample was found to contain a female fertility drug which officials said was "below threshold level".

"It's not a case of (Abhishek) returning dope positive. The presence of the substance is below threshold level. NADA is currently undergoing investigation. But we did not want to take any risk. We don't want anybody to point a finger on us. So, we have dropped Abhishek from the team," former AFI secretary and current planning commission chief Lalit Bhanot said.

Shirre and Abhishek were included in the 73-member Indian athletics team announced by the Sports Ministry earlier this month. The ministry added six more track and field athletes on Wednesday. The athletes added are 200m runner Harita Bhadra, quarter-miler Kiran Pahal, pole vaulter Sindhushree G, triple jumper I Asha Ilango, discus thrower Sanya Yadav and hammer thrower Praveen Kumar. With two athletes - Abhishek and Shirre - dropped from the original 73 and six added on Wednesday, the final entry is 77.

Bhanot said the names of the six added athletes have been accepted by the Aichi-Nagoya Asian Games organisers on the request of Indian Olympic Association (IOA). "These six athletes were not in the long list submitted by us but the IOA made a request for their inclusion and Olympic Council of Asia (OCA) and Asian Games Organising Committee have accepted their entry," Bhanot told. (PTI)



Jamil defends dropping seniors, says picked India squad on merit

SUMAN RAY ■ New Delhi

Indian football team head coach Khalid Jamil on Thursday strongly defended his decision to drop several established players from the squad for the upcoming high-profile friendlies against Brazil, Uruguay and Panama, saying he picked the 26 probabilities purely on merit after giving everyone an "equal and adequate chance".

Former India captain Sandesh Jhingam, along with Rahul Bheke, Lallianzuala Chhangte, FPAI Player of the Year, Mohun Bagan goalkeeper Vishal Kaith, golden glove winner at the recently-concluded Durand Cup, Liston Colaco and East Bengal midfielder Jeakson Singh, were among the notable omissions from the squad announced earlier this week.

"I have selected players according to their merits and performance. It's not like we have selected 26 players. We don't have to take all of them. If



someone isn't performing well, he will go back within two days. It's not like I didn't give anyone a chance. I saw everyone. Whoever deserves to be there, I gave him a 100% chance," Jamil said.

"And whoever got a chance but didn't perform, he will get another chance. Here there are no seniors or juniors. So we have to do a mix. So it is a balanced team. I believe in the players. All the players are mature enough," he observed. (PTI)

Satwik-Chirag win, Srikanth stuns Lai, Tanvi Sharma loses in China Masters



PRESS TRUST OF INDIA ■ Shezhen

Veteran Indian shuttler Kidambi Srikanth stunned world Number 9 Victor Lai of Canada in straight games to enter the men's singles quarterfinals of the China Masters Super 750 badminton tournament on Thursday. The 33-year-old Srikanth, who had reached the US Open Super 300 final earlier this year, rallied his way to notch up an upset 21-18 21-19 win over Lai, who won his second World Championships bronze in Delhi last month.

"I wasn't really thinking about the score. I was only thinking about what I have been doing throughout the match and what I need to do going forward, that's the only thing I was thinking about,"

Srikanth said.

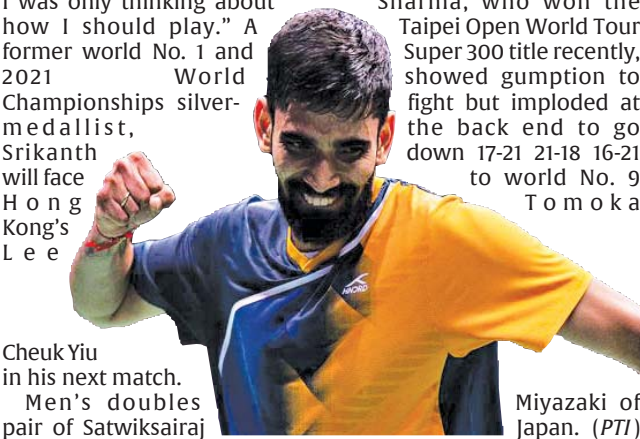
"He has been playing really well for last 12-14 months but I just feel like it is a new day and if I can play my best, I will have my chances. I wasn't thinking about how he has been playing. I was only thinking about how I should play." A former world No. 1 and 2021 World Championships silver-medallist, Srikanth will face Hong Kong's Lee

Rankireddy and Chirag Shetty overcame a mid-match wobble to beat French brothers Christo and Toma Junior Popov 21-15 22-24 21-9 and progress to the quarterfinals.

In women's singles, Tanvi Sharma, who won the Taipei Open World Tour Super 300 title recently, showed gumption to fight but imploded at the back end to go down 17-21 21-18 16-21 to world No. 9 Tomoka

Cheuk Yiu in his next match.

Men's doubles pair of Satwiksairaj



Miyazaki of Japan. (PTI)

Vishesh Sharma opens up four-shot lead at Telangana Golconda Masters

PRESS TRUST OF INDIA ■ Hyderabad

Local favourite Vishesh Sharma moved four shots clear of the field after producing a six-under 64 in the third round of the ₹1 crore Telangana Golconda Masters golf tournament here on Thursday.

The 19-year-old, who began the day tied for the lead with Amardeep Malik, made seven birdies and a solitary bogey to reach 20-under 190.

Vishesh (60-66-64) has now held at least a share of the lead after each round. Playing at his home course, he followed his course-record-equaling opening 60 with rounds of 66



and 64 to establish a commanding advantage ahead of the final day.

Malik (61-65-68), a two-time winner on the PGTI, remained the closest challenger at 16-under 194. The 41-year-old from Noida made three birdies and dropped his only shot on the par-three ninth for a two-under 68. Delhi's Honey Baisoya (64-64-68) moved up one place to third at 14-under 196.

Baisoya, who began the round two shots behind the joint leaders, mixed four birdies with two bogeys in another 68.

Opening-round co-leader Dhruv Sheoran (60-67-70) of Gurugram made three birdies and three bogeys in even-par 70.

Mairaj targets maiden Asiad medal, predicts big rise for Indian shooting

PRESS TRUST OF INDIA ■ New Delhi

At 50, Mairaj Ahmad Khan is still chasing his first Asian Games medal, but the veteran skeet shooter is equally excited about what lies ahead for Indian shooting, predicting the country will have "the best team" across trap, skeet, rifle and pistol over the next four years. Mairaj believes Indian shooting is poised for a big rise, crediting government-backed programmes such as Khelo India for creating a stronger pathway for the next generation of athletes.

Mairaj, who is part of India's 12-member shotgun preparatory camp for the Asian Games in



Japan, will be making his third appearance at the continental event.

"Every athlete expects to win. But as far as I believe, if you go into a competition with fewer expectations, it is better

for you," Mairaj told SAI Media. "Because, if you go with expectations, you are already in the future; you are not in the present. You have to focus on what you need to do at that very particular moment."

DAILY SUDOKU

	3				9			1
	1				5	6		7
	7	9						2
9				3				5
			5		4		9	
	4				6			2
	8						7	1
1		4	8					6
2			6					4

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DIFFICULTY RATING: ★★★★★★

HOW TO SOLVE IT

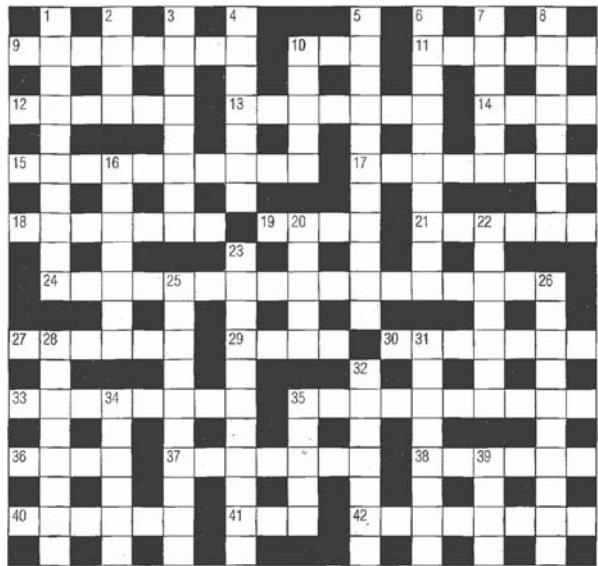
Sudoku is a logic puzzle where you fill a 9x9 grid so that numbers 1 to 9 appear once in every row, column, and 3x3 box, using elimination and logical deduction - no maths involved.

SOLUTION (3.9.26)

3	5	4	2	6	7	1	9	8
6	1	9	5	8	3	7	4	2
8	2	7	9	4	1	3	5	6
5	7	3	8	9	6	2	1	4
4	8	1	3	7	2	9	6	5
9	6	2	1	5	4	8	7	3
7	3	6	4	2	9	5	8	1
1	4	5	7	3	8	6	2	9
2	9	8	6	1	5	4	3	7

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DOUBLE CROSSWORD
FRIDAY | SEPTEMBER 4, 2026



ACROSS

- 9 Reveal that the day is near (8)
10 A back numbers issue (3)
11 Used one to turn left? (6)
12 To keep from talking, intern (4,2)
13 Wrecked when drunk (7)
14 Said having me around gives confidence
15 How the blinking rocket was launched? (7,3)
17 Many a chap, should he be getting on in years (8)
18 Put the man's name in red (7)
19 Tip you rely on (4)
21 Having alighted at the stop, create resentment (6)
24 Going through all the red lights is unprincipled (8,2,7)

DOWN

- 1 Where you have friends when your friends are mountaineers? (4,6)
2 Go away, small furry animal! (4)
3 Holding fifty, you contend, to be full (8)
4 Is over-working, at one point, in form (7)
5 To be, during production (2,3,6)
6 Learning, on coming upon unconscious
7 Blow round to change the date to a later one (3,3)
8 Happened to have been round about autumn (8)
10 Club for the workers (5)
16 Lions prowling around Ireland for a cut

- 27 And in ways still holds good (6)
29 Gathered I had returned for the thing
30 The agent is working, to a degree, for the tycoon (7)
33 Only after one's money and stuff (8)
35 It's responsible for the hold-up on the line (7,3)
36 Frank is the one playing the piano inside (4)
37 Result of opening the exit doors? (7)
38 With rest and exercise, back in the pink (6)
40 Make certain, before the sun breaks through (6)
41 Plant - and you'll wish you hadn't (3)
42 One fated, perhaps, never to know the appeal of music (4,4)

of beef (7)

- 20 A tempo that's fast (5)
22 TV programme Saturday begins with?
23 The facts from a prison inmate? (6,5)
25 Disregarded, when one flew above (6,4)
26 Understand it will rock as one gets up speed (7,3)
28 Catching by knocking right inside (8)
31 Follower who has a bash at embracing her (8)
32 Then so terribly young, in all candour
34 Put untidy clothes away, having a thing about it? (4-2)
35 It's one spice of many, dear (5)
39 Stuffs with paper (4)

SOLUTION (3.9.26)

ACROSS	21. Disco - very	DOWN	18. As - sail
4. A-L-fred	23. To-NS	1. Chaff	20. Crete
7. Half hour	24. Made	2. Clare	21. Dot
8. Sp-RA-in	26. Tut	3. Shot	22. Van
10. FI-R-st	27. Avon	4. Arson	23. Turtle
13. S-oak	29. Thus	5. Fork	25. Bur
14. Free	32. Li-on	6. Edison	28. V-oles
15. Sons	33. Rear-M	9. Passed	30. Hatch
16. Jog	34. St.-roll	11. Ire	31. S-ma's-h
17. Tail	35. Ex-tracts	12. Set in	32. Loco
19. Scan	36. Her-oes	13. Solo-Mon	33. R-are
		15. Sic	
		16. Jay	

BCCI vows more rest for Team India

PRESS TRUST OF INDIA ■ Mumbai

BCCI secretary Devajit Saikia on Thursday said the board will be working in the direction of ensuring proper rest, acclimatisation and practise matches for Indian cricketers ahead of any major series in SENA countries.

Following a review meeting in BCCI headquarters, Saikia said there is no lack of communication within Indian cricket as far as injury management is concerned but the board will try and ensure to have a better Future Tours Program (FTP) to give the players ample time to prepare.

“Everybody is on the same page. BCCI is working in a very well like a well oiled engine,” Saikia told reporters.

“There is proper coordination amongst all the wings of BCCI, whether it is women’s teams committees or their technical staff or their coaches, vis-a-vis the COE, vis-a-vis the Indian men’s team’s coaching staff and the head coach. There is no difficulty in the coordination, everything is moving in the right direction.”

“The only challenge which we are facing is that there are too many matches



in the year and that is why in next FTP we will do certain things, we will take measures.

“We have instructed our FTP persons who will

be meeting very soon in various international forums that our FTP should be in such a way it should be scheduled that there is proper rest for the players as well as some kind of acclimatisation or some kind of friendly matches before any major series in SENA countries (South Africa, Australia, England and New Zealand),” Saikia added.

The review meeting was attended by India Test and ODI skipper Shubman Gill, T20I skipper Shreyas Iyer, head coach Gautam Gambhir, director of cricket at Centre of Excellence VVS Laxman along with officials of the Indian cricket board. The chairman of

selection committee Ajit Agarkar, however, could not join the meeting even via video conferencing.

“We discussed (about) our team performed in England and Ireland and also about what we are going to do about the next one year. The road map has been prepared and we will be doing some exercises so that we have a very good performance in 2027 (ODI) World Cup,” Saikia added. Acknowledging that the team did not do well in limited-overs tours of Ireland and England, Saikia said the team needed to do some “soul searching” but said strategy has been chalked out in that regards.

Jadeja’s adaptability, Pandya’s composure fuel Kartik’s ambitions

HARDIK SHARMA ■ New Delhi

Young spinner Kartik Yadav may have played only three Ranji Trophy matches so far, but he is already looking to emulate Ravindra Jadeja’s adaptability and Hardik Pandya’s composure under pressure to become an all-format cricketer.

The 19-year-old from Uttar Pradesh claimed a five-wicket haul on his Ranji Trophy debut against Tamil Nadu last year. Though he went wicketless in the matches that followed, Yadav said the experience of playing at the senior level proved to be an important learning curve.

“Debuting at this age is a dream for everyone. You are debuting at such a young age, contributing to the team and doing well. Taking a five-wicket haul was a great experience,” Yadav, who is currently representing Kashi Rudras in the UP T20 League said. “As far as learning is concerned, learning will always be there. I went to that level for the first time, so I faced different conditions, different players and tough situations.”

The left-arm spinner from Prayagraj, who sees himself as an all-rounder, said he draws inspiration from Jadeja and Pandya to become an all-format player.



“I have always seen myself as an all-rounder. From the beginning, I have looked up to Ravindra Jadeja and Hardik Pandya,” he said.

“The key things that I have observed in Hardik Pandya are his mindset, self-confidence and the way he handles pressure. No matter how intense the match is, he stays cool and calm. His belief that ‘I am the best’ also impresses me a lot.” (PTI)

Rohit is playing superbly: BCCI secretary

PRESS TRUST OF INDIA ■ Mumbai

BCCI secretary Devajit Saikia on Thursday strongly defended Rohit Sharma amid speculation over the former India skipper’s future in the ODI team, saying the veteran batter has been “playing superbly” and there is no reason to question his place in the side.

Rohit, who now plays only one format after retiring from Test cricket last year and T20Is in 2024, has faced constant scrutiny over his position in the Indian ODI side.

“He is playing superbly in all matches. So what more do you want? In the last match (against England), he scored 138 runs, so why is there speculation? I do not want to give some fodder for the speculators,” Saikia told reporters after the BCCI’s review meeting here.

Saikia said there was no discussion on the extension of chief selector Ajit Agarkar’s contract, with the chairman of selectors unable to attend the review meeting.



The meeting was attended by Test and ODI captain Shubman Gill, T20I skipper Shreyas Iyer, head coach Gautam Gambhir and the director of cricket at the Centre of Excellence (COE), VVS Laxman.

“Today he (Agarkar) was out of station, he could not be a part of the meeting because this meeting was called at a very short notice. Our head of the selection committee, Ajit, was

not in town, so he could not join it. He was in such an area that he could not join online also, in spite of our best efforts,” Saikia said of Agarkar’s absence.

Asked if there was any discussion on extension for Agarkar as chairman of selectors, Saikia replied, “There was no such discussion in today’s meeting.”

Saikia also quashed rumours surrounding Laxman’s appointment as the BCCI’s director of

cricket.

“I do not comment on new rumours. We did not have any such kind of discussion, (and) neither do we have such (an) intention,” he said.

Saikia said the BCCI would step in to provide the “best facilities” to the Indian men’s and women’s teams bound for the Asian Games later this month if the situation arises.

“There is no such issue which we have discussed or which was in our agenda today or prior to today,” he said when asked about the facilities at the Asian Games, set to be held in Aichi-Nagoya in Japan from September 19 to October 4.

“We are not going to have any difficulties in Japan. If any kind of situation arises, we will take an appropriate call at the right time, so that we ensure that our players and the support staff will get the best of facilities in Asian Games, whether it is from organisers, or if required, BCCI will have its own system in place to provide the best facilities to our players,” Saikia added.

‘Dhoni has ruled out continuing as impact player’

PRESS TRUST OF INDIA ■ New Delhi

Mahendra Singh Dhoni has told former Chennai Super Kings batter Subramaniam Badrinath that he does not intend to continue as an Impact Player, adding another twist to the uncertainty surrounding his participation in the 2027 Indian Premier League.

The Impact Player rule could potentially have offered the veteran wicketkeeper-batter a way to prolong his IPL career further by reducing his workload, but Dhoni has made it clear that he wants to remain a full-time wicketkeeper if he continues playing.

Badrinath, however, feels the Impact Player rule could actually suit Dhoni at this stage of his career, considering his limited involvement with the bat and the physical demands of keeping wickets for 20 overs.

“He has personally told me that he won’t play as an Impact Player. He sees himself as a full-time keeper, and that means he has to be on the field



for the full 20 overs. So he won’t play as an Impact Player, but I feel if he does, it’ll tactically benefit CSK.

“His body cannot withstand long durations, which even Fleming has said. He is only going to bat after the 16th over and keep wickets. When his participation is so less, he would be ideal as an Impact Player,” Badrinath said on his YouTube channel.

The 45-year-old Dhoni has been grappling with fitness concerns in recent seasons and his future in the IPL remains a subject of speculation.

Badrinath believes the Impact Player rule could ease the workload on Dhoni while allowing CSK to make use of his experience and finishing ability.

However, Dhoni’s preference to continue as a wicketkeeper means CSK may have to wait for a decision on whether their long-time captain will return for another season. Dhoni, who led CSK to five IPL titles, stepped down as captain ahead of the 2024 season and has since played a more limited role with the bat.

Hockey teams set for double title defence as Junior Asia Cup begins in China

PRESS TRUST OF INDIA

■ Moqi (China)

The Indian under-21 men’s hockey team will eye a record-extending sixth title, while the women will chase a hat-trick of trophies when the defending champions in both categories begin their AHF Junior Asia Cup campaigns here on Friday.

The women’s team, which lifted the Asia Cup trophy in the last two editions, will be led by mid-fielder Khaideem Shileima Chanu this time.

The team has undergone a structured training programme



under coach Tim White, who assumed charge earlier this year.

As part of their preparations, an extended squad undertook an

exposure tour of the United Kingdom, where they played matches against Scotland Senior Women, USA U-21, England U-21

and Belgium U-21.

India, placed in the Elite Pool, will begin their campaign against South Korea on September 5. The

team will then face Malaysia on September 6, before taking on Japan on September 8 and hosts China on September 9.

“Our first game is against South Korea on Saturday, so we are preparing for that. The team has acclimatized well. The weather is a bit cooler (in Moqi), but conditions are good and we are really looking forward to Match 1,” said White in a press release issued by Hockey India.

“In terms of our expectations, we prepared well in Bengaluru over a number of months, including a tour of UK and some games against a combined team.”

Back in TT contingent after Tokyo controversy, Soumyadeep offers to help



BHARAT SHARMA ■ New Delhi

Former India international turned coach, Soumyadeep Roy, is back with the national table tennis squad for a multi-sport event, albeit in a personal coach’s capacity, five years after being embroiled in a major controversy at the Tokyo Olympics.

Roy would be travelling to the upcoming Asian Games in Japan as a personal coach to Payas Jain, Suthirtha Mukherji and Syndrela Das. His name was approved by the Sports Ministry in the support staff list on Wednesday. He is unlikely to get field of play access as he is not part of the dedicated support staff led by Italian Massimo Costantini. Roy, who was the national coach in the Tokyo Olympics, found himself in the eye of a storm after star player Manika Batra refused to be coached by him during her matches at the Summer Games.

Manika had alleged that Roy asked her to fix a match in the lead up to the Olympics so that the latter’s protege could qualify for the mega event. That controversy led to the suspension of TTFI in 2022. The federation, in fact, was suspended again last

month due to governance issues.

Speaking to PTI, Roy, a Commonwealth Games gold medallist, said he would try to help the Indian contingent and not just his three players in anyway he can. He also doesn’t see his presence in the Asian Games contingent as comeback of sorts into the national fold following the Tokyo controversy.

“Three of my players are there and I would be able to guide them there. I have been to four Asian Games as a player and multiple times to Commonwealth Games.

“Of late I have been travelling with Syndrela, Suthirtha and Payas for WTT events and considering the Olympics in 2028, I would be doing more of that going forward. “I just wanted to be there for them in Japan. I am not thinking on those lines at all,” said Roy when asked about the incident in Tokyo and the sequence of events that led to the suspension of the national body. Roy also said he would be more than happy to share his knowledge with the other players in the squad.

“I am an Indian national. There is a national coach Massimo.

Pak team being criticised by those who never achieved anything: Naqvi



PRESS TRUST OF INDIA ■ Karachi

Livid with the criticism that Pakistan’s cricket team has faced after its heavy Test losses to England, PCB Chairman Mohsin Naqvi said the side is being lambasted by those “who have never achieved anything in their lives”.

Speaking to the media in London, Naqvi cited other teams’ losses to weaker opponents, including India’s recent T20 defeats at the hands of Ireland, to assert that a few set-backs do not define an outfit.

Naqvi and the Pakistan Cricket Board came under fire after they decided to replace seven players in the touring squad in England and with mostly young names. Pakistan are trailing 0-2 in the three-match series.

RASHID SUGGESTS AQIB AS PAKISTAN’S NON-PLAYING CAPTAIN IN IRONIC SWIPE



PRESS TRUST OF INDIA ■ Karachi

Former Pakistan all-rounder Rashid Khan has sarcastically advised the Pakistan Cricket Board to make senior selector Aqib Javed the non-playing captain for all formats.

Rashid made this comment on a podcast after Aqib publicly criticised the team’s captain, coaches, and recent player selections.

“Since Aqib apparently knows more about Pakistan cricket I see no reason why he can’t be a non-playing captain,” Rashid said sarcastically on a podcast on hamariweb.com website. He was responding to the recent comments by Aqib on why the board had decided to replace seven players in England and also on the former seamer’s criticism of the head coach, bowling coach, and captain on selection of team for the Tests in England.

Alcaraz recovers after dropping first set to reach third round at US Open



ASSOCIATED PRESS ■ New York

Carlos Alcaraz was already in the final by the time he dropped a set last year in the U.S. Open. When it happened in his second match this year, Alcaraz tried to look at the positives. After missing four months with a right wrist injury, the extra work might help.

“I wanted to be quick, to be honest. I’m not going to lie,” Alcaraz said. “But at the end, I realized that just playing four sets, it was really good for me to test everything physically, to test my body, how I feel, and tomorrow how I’m going to feel after this match.”

The defending champion rebounded from a quick deficit by winning eight straight games and beat Jaime Faria 4-6, 6-0, 6-3, 6-2 on Wednesday night. The No. 2-seeded Alcaraz dropped his serve midway through the first set but soon was back to playing long stretches of flawless tennis.

“After that I just tried to be focused, tried to stay calm and I’m thinking that good things are going to happen again,” Alcaraz said. He didn’t drop a set last year until the final against Jannik Sinner, becoming the first man since Roger Federer in 2015 to go through his first six matches without doing so.